



SEC

GAME GRADER	2025 SEASON			LAST 3 YEARS (2023-2025)			LAST 5 YEARS (2021-2025)			LAST 10 YEARS (2016-2025)		
	P4 RANK / 68	TEAM	GRADE	P4 RANK / 68	TEAM	GRADE	P4 RANK / 68	TEAM	GRADE	P4 RANK / 68	TEAM	GRADE
	7	GEORGIA	74.9	4	GEORGIA	78.1	1	GEORGIA	84.5	1	ALABAMA	84.5
	8	OLE MISS	74.8	5	TEXAS	75.6	3	ALABAMA	75.6	3	GEORGIA	79.6
	9	TEXAS A&M	73.1	6	OLE MISS	74.3	7	OLE MISS	69.3	6	OKLAHOMA	71.0
OFFENSE	11	VANDERBILT	70.2	9	ALABAMA	69.7	8	TEXAS	69.2	9	TEXAS	64.6
	13	OKLAHOMA	66.3	11	MISSOURI	64.6	10	TENNESSEE	64.0	12	LSU	63.8
	14	ALABAMA	66.1	12	TEXAS A&M	64.1	11	OKLAHOMA	62.2	15	TEXAS A&M	59.1
	21	MISSOURI	62.8	14	TENNESSEE	63.7	17	TEXAS A&M	59.3	20	OLE MISS	57.5
	22	TEXAS	62.7	15	OKLAHOMA	62.8	21	LSU	58.8	23	FLORIDA	55.2
DEFENSE	24	TENNESSEE	59.1	21	LSU	61.3	24	MISSOURI	55.6	24	AUBURN	54.6
	38	AUBURN	52.3	32	SOUTH CAROLINA	50.5	34	ARKANSAS	50.4	29	MISSOURI	52.3
	39	LSU	51.3	37	AUBURN	48.9	39	KENTUCKY	48.9	30	TENNESSEE	52.0
	44	ARKANSAS	46.0	40	FLORIDA	47.5	40	FLORIDA	48.9	39	KENTUCKY	48.5
	46	KENTUCKY	45.1	43	ARKANSAS	45.5	41	SOUTH CAROLINA	48.1	41	MISSISSIPPI ST	48.1
OFFENSE	48	SOUTH CAROLINA	44.4	47	VANDERBILT	44.9	44	AUBURN	47.3	51	SOUTH CAROLINA	43.6
	50	FLORIDA	42.9	49	KENTUCKY	44.6	54	MISSISSIPPI ST	44.6	56	ARKANSAS	41.4
	53	MISSISSIPPI ST	41.8	65	MISSISSIPPI ST	34.6	64	VANDERBILT	37.1	66	VANDERBILT	34.5
DEFENSE	1	VANDERBILT	2.0	4	LSU	1.3	4	GEORGIA	1.1	2	ALABAMA	1.3
	2	ARKANSAS	1.7	6	MISSISSIPPI	1.2	5	MISSISSIPPI	1.1	3	OKLAHOMA	1.3
	7	MISSISSIPPI	1.3	10	GEORGIA	0.8	6	TENNESSEE	1.0	4	MISSISSIPPI	1.0
	9	TEXAS A&M	1.1	11	TEXAS	0.8	7	ALABAMA	1.0	5	GEORGIA	1.0
	14	TENNESSEE	0.9	13	ALABAMA	0.7	8	LSU	1.0	8	LSU	0.9
OFFENSE	23	TEXAS	0.5	14	TENNESSEE	0.7	12	TEXAS	0.7	16	FLORIDA	0.5
	28	ALABAMA	0.5	19	TEXAS A&M	0.6	15	ARKANSAS	0.7	17	TENNESSEE	0.5
	33	MISSOURI	0.2	21	ARKANSAS	0.6	22	FLORIDA	0.5	18	TEXAS	0.5
	34	SOUTH CAROLINA	0.2	25	VANDERBILT	0.4	25	OKLAHOMA	0.4	21	TEXAS A&M	0.4
	36	GEORGIA	0.2	26	FLORIDA	0.4	26	TEXAS A&M	0.4	27	ARKANSAS	0.3
DEFENSE	42	FLORIDA	0.1	30	MISSOURI	0.4	36	AUBURN	0.2	34	MISSOURI	0.2
	45	MISSISSIPPI ST	0.1	35	SOUTH CAROLINA	0.2	38	MISSOURI	0.1	36	AUBURN	0.2
	50	OKLAHOMA	-0.1	38	KENTUCKY	0.1	39	KENTUCKY	0.1	45	KENTUCKY	0.1
	53	LSU	-0.1	39	OKLAHOMA	0.1	44	SOUTH CAROLINA	0.1	49	MISSISSIPPI ST	0.0
	56	AUBURN	-0.2	45	AUBURN	0.0	47	MISSISSIPPI ST	0.0	57	SOUTH CAROLINA	-0.1
OFFENSE	59	KENTUCKY	-0.3	48	MISSISSIPPI ST	0.0	56	VANDERBILT	-0.1	61	VANDERBILT	-0.3
	3	OKLAHOMA	1.5	3	OKLAHOMA	1.1	1	GEORGIA	1.2	1	ALABAMA	1.3
	8	MISSOURI	1.1	4	TEXAS	1.1	3	ALABAMA	1.1	2	GEORGIA	1.2
	10	TEXAS	1.0	6	GEORGIA	1.0	8	TEXAS	0.9	9	AUBURN	0.8
	12	GEORGIA	0.9	10	ALABAMA	0.9	10	TEXAS A&M	0.7	12	TEXAS	0.7
DEFENSE	13	LSU	0.9	13	MISSOURI	0.7	12	OKLAHOMA	0.7	14	TEXAS A&M	0.6
	17	AUBURN	0.8	14	TEXAS A&M	0.7	16	AUBURN	0.6	19	LSU	0.5
	21	ALABAMA	0.7	17	SOUTH CAROLINA	0.6	18	TENNESSEE	0.5	21	OKLAHOMA	0.4
	22	TEXAS A&M	0.7	18	AUBURN	0.6	22	MISSOURI	0.5	24	SOUTH CAROLINA	0.4
	28	SOUTH CAROLINA	0.5	19	TENNESSEE	0.6	24	OLE MISS	0.5	25	TENNESSEE	0.4
OFFENSE	33	KENTUCKY	0.4	23	OLE MISS	0.5	25	SOUTH CAROLINA	0.5	27	FLORIDA	0.3
	38	OLE MISS	0.3	30	KENTUCKY	0.4	26	LSU	0.4	30	MISSISSIPPI ST	0.3
	40	FLORIDA	0.2	37	LSU	0.2	28	KENTUCKY	0.4	31	MISSOURI	0.3
	50	TENNESSEE	-0.1	47	FLORIDA	0.1	41	FLORIDA	0.2	35	KENTUCKY	0.2
	51	VANDERBILT	-0.1	53	ARKANSAS	0.0	44	MISSISSIPPI ST	0.2	51	OLE MISS	0.0
DEFENSE	56	MISSISSIPPI ST	-0.2	54	MISSISSIPPI ST	-0.1	52	ARKANSAS	0.0	60	ARKANSAS	-0.2
	61	ARKANSAS	-0.4	64	VANDERBILT	-0.4	68	VANDERBILT	-0.6	68	VANDERBILT	-0.5

ALL-TRANSFER TEAM

QB	SAM LEAVITT	Arizona State	→	LSU	DL	PRINCEWILL UMANMIELEN	Ole Miss	→	LSU
RB	HOLLYWOOD SMOTHERS	NC State	→	TEXAS	DL	ANTO SAKA	Northwestern	→	TEXAS A&M
RB	RALEEK BROWN	Arizona State	→	TEXAS	DL	MALIK BLOCTON	Auburn	→	LSU
WR	CAM COLEMAN	Auburn	→	TEXAS	DL	XAVIER GILLIAM	Penn State	→	TENNESSEE
WR	ISAIAH HORTON	Alabama	→	TEXAS A&M	LB	RASHEEM BILES	Pittsburgh	→	TEXAS
WR	EUGENE WILSON	Florida	→	LSU	LB	KEATON THOMAS	Baylor	→	OLE MISS
TE	HAYDEN HANSEN	Florida	→	OKLAHOMA	LB	ROBERT WOODYARD	Auburn	→	MISSOURI
OL	JORDAN SEATON	Colorado	→	LSU	LB	TJ DOTTERY	Ole Miss	→	LSU
OL	LANCE HEARD	Tennessee	→	KENTUCKY	LB	AMARE CAMPBELL	Penn State	→	TENNESSEE
OL	COLETON PRICE	Baylor	→	KENTUCKY	DB	EDWIN JOSEPH	Florida State	→	OLE MISS
OL	JACARRIUS PEAK	NC State	→	S. CAROLINA	DB	KAYIN LEE	Auburn	→	TENNESSEE
OL	MELVIN SIANI	Wake Forest	→	TEXAS	DB	KHALIL BARNES	Clemson	→	GEORGIA



SEC

1 GEORGIA



2(TIE) OKLAHOMA



2(TIE) TEXAS



4 OLE MISS



5 LSU



6 TEXAS A&M



7(TIE) TENNESSEE



7(TIE) ALABAMA



9 AUBURN



10(TIE) MISSOURI



10(TIE) S. CAROLINA



12 FLORIDA



13 MISS. ST.



14 KENTUCKY



15 VANDERBILT



16 ARKANSAS



ALL-SEC: OFFENSE

1st TEAM		2nd TEAM		3rd TEAM	
QB	TRINIDAD CHAMBLISS	OLE MISS	QB	GUNNER STOCKTON	GEORGIA
RB	KEWAN LACY	OLE MISS	RB	DeSEAN BISHOP	TENNESSEE
RB	AHMAD HARDY	MISSOURI	RB	JADAN BAUGH	FLORIDA
WR	ISAIAH SATEGNA	OKLAHOMA	WR	BRAYLON STALEY	TENNESSEE
WR	CAM COLEMAN	TEXAS	WR	MARIO CRAVER	TEXAS A&M
WR	RYAN WINGO	TEXAS	WR	VERNELL BROWN	FLORIDA
TE	TREY'DEZ GREEN	LSU	TE	WILLIE RODRIGUEZ	KENTUCKY
OL	CAYDEN GREEN	MISSOURI	OL	MICHAEL CARROLL	ALABAMA
OL	TREVOR GOOSBY	TEXAS	OL	DONTRELL GLOVER	GEORGIA
OL	PATRICK KUTAS	OLE MISS	OL	EARNEST GREENE	GEORGIA
OL	DREW BOBO	GEORGIA	OL	JORDAN SEATON	LSU
OL	DAVID SANDERS	TENNESSEE	OL	LANCE HEARD	KENTUCKY
QB	ARCH MANNING	TEXAS	QB	HOLLYWOOD SMOTHERS	TEXAS
WR	JEREMIAH COBB	AUBURN	WR	DEUCE ALEXANDER	OLE MISS
WR	R. COLEMAN-WILLIAMS	ALABAMA	WR	MIKE MATTHEWS	TENNESSEE
WR	NYCK HARBOR	S. CAROLINA	WR	BRAELIN MOORE	LSU
OL	JACARRIUS PEAK	S. CAROLINA	OL	MARK NABOU	TEXAS A&M
OL	MICHAEL FASUSI	OKLAHOMA	OL	WENDELL MOE	TENNESSEE

ALL-SEC: DEFENSE

1st TEAM		2nd TEAM		3rd TEAM	
DL	COLIN SIMMONS	TEXAS	DL	TAYLOR WEIN	OKLAHOMA
DL	DYLAN STEWART	S. CAROLINA	DL	P. UMANMIEN	LSU
DL	WILL ECHOLES	OLE MISS	DL	ANTO SAKA	TEXAS A&M
DL	DAVID STONE	OKLAHOMA	LB	RAYLEN WILSON	GEORGIA
LB	XAVIER ATKINS	AUBURN	LB	CHRIS COLE	GEORGIA
LB	RASHEEM BILES	TEXAS	LB	OWEN HEINECKE	OKLAHOMA
LB	KIP LEWIS	OKLAHOMA	LB	SUNTARINE PERKINS	OLE MISS
DB	BRAY HUBBARD	ALABAMA	DB	TY BRYANT	KENTUCKY
DB	KJ BOLDEN	GEORGIA	DB	ELI BOWEN	OKLAHOMA
DB	ELLIS ROBINSON	GEORGIA	DB	ZABIEN BROWN	ALABAMA
DB	PEYTON BOWEN	OKLAHOMA	DB	JELANI McDONALD	TEXAS
DL	JAYDEN WOODS	FLORIDA	DL	QUINCY RHODES	ARKANSAS
DL	YHONZAE PIERRE	ALABAMA	DL	ISSA OUATTARA	VANDERBILT
LB	ARION CARTER	TENNESSEE	LB	KEATON THOMAS	OLE MISS
LB	WHIT WEEKS	LSU	LB	KELLEY JONES	MISSISSIPPI ST
DB	ISAAC SMITH	MISSISSIPPI ST	DB	TY REDMOND	TENNESSEE
DB	DJ PICKETT	LSU			

PICK SIX PREVIEWS		SEC - UNIT RANKS							
TEAM	QB	RB	WR/TE	OL	DL	LB	DB		
GEORGIA	2	4	9	1	2	1	2		
OKLAHOMA	5	12	6	5	1	6	1		
TEXAS	3	3	1	3	3	5	5		
OLE MISS	1	2	5	4	5	2	7		
LSU	7	7	4	6	4	7	6		
TEXAS A&M	4	10	2	7	6	12	4		
ALABAMA	9	8	8	9	8	10	3		
TENNESSEE	13	9	7	2	9	3	8		
AUBURN	8	6	13	14	10	4	9		
MISSOURI	11	1	10	10	13	8	10		
S. CAROLINA	6	15	12	11	7	13	11		
FLORIDA	15	5	3	12	11	9	15		
MISS. STATE	10	11	14	16	15	11	12		
KENTUCKY	14	13	11	8	16	14	14		
VANDERBILT	12	14	15	13	12	15	13		
ARKANSAS	16	16	16	15	14	16	16		





GEORGIA

BRETT CIANCIA @PickSixPreviews

#1

SEC

#5

OVERALL



GEORGIA				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
15 (CG) Alabama	(NC) TCU	(CG) Alabama	(P) Notre Dame	(P) Ole Miss
14 (NC) Alabama	(P) Ohio St	(B) Florida St	OLE MISS	ALABAMA
13 (P) Michigan	(CG) LSU	Georgia Tech	ALABAMA	(CG) Alabama
12 Georgia Tech	Georgia Tech	TENNESSEE	(CG) Texas	Georgia Tech
11 Charl. S. (FCS)	KENTUCKY	OLE MISS	Georgia Tech	Charlotte
10 TENNESSEE	MISS ST	MISSOURI	UMass	TEXAS
9 MISSOURI	TENNESSEE	MISSOURI	TENNESSEE	MISS ST
8 FLORIDA	VANDERBILT	FLORIDA	FLORIDA	FLORIDA
7 KENTUCKY	AUBURN	KENTUCKY	TEXAS	OLE MISS
6 AUBURN	MISSOURI	AUBURN	MISS ST	AUBURN
5 ARKANSAS	Kent St	UAB	AUBURN	KENTUCKY
4 VANDERBILT	S. CAROLINA	S. CAROLINA	KENTUCKY	TENNESSEE
3 S. CAROLINA	Samford (FCS)	Ball St	Tenn Tech (FCS)	A. Peay (FCS)
2 UAB	Oregon	UT-Martin (FCS)	Clemson	Marshall
1 Clemson				
2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
KIRBY SMART				

GEORGIA				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
MARSHALL W 45-7	281	0	84.6	
Austin Peay (FCS) W 28-6	225	-1	63.6	
TENNESSEE W 44-41	6	0	61.4	
ALABAMA L 21-24	-40	-1	46.1	
KENTUCKY W 35-14	155	0	83.1	
AUBURN W 20-10	19	1	76.5	
OLE MISS W 43-35	159	0	98.1	
FLORIDA W 24-20	80	-1	67.5	
MISS. ST W 41-21	245	0	81.1	
TEXAS W 35-10	83	0	108.5	
CHARLOTTE W 35-3	280	1	73.2	
GA TECH W 16-9	10	0	66.3	
(CG) ALABAMA W 28-7	88	1	101.5	
(P) OLE MISS L 34-39	-130	0	37.2	
OVERALL: 7th / 68	SEC: 1st / 16		74.9	

GEORGIA		UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK	NATIONAL		
(of 16)	TOP 15		
QUARTERBACK	2	6	
RUNNING BACKS	4	8	
RECEIVERS & TE	9		
OFFENSIVE LINE	1	4	
DEFENSIVE LINE	2	6	
LINEBACKERS	1	1	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	2	3	

GEORGIA		RANK
Scoring Offense	32.1 ppg	28
Points per Play	0.45	42
Total Offense	402 ypg	51
Yards per Play	5.7	71
Rushing Offense	182 ypg	35
Yards per Carry	4.4	64
O-Line Run Push	4.2	66
Explosive Rush	4.7	98
Passing Offense	220 ypg	78
Yards / Attempt	7.4	56
QB Rating	147	33
TD / INT Ratio	3.6	18
Sacks / Attempt	5%	33
Explosive Pass	6.5	82
Return. Production	63%	32
Returning Snaps	11,010	50
28.3 SECONDS/PLAY #58 of 68 P4		
BOBO (2025 GEORGIA)		SLOW

In their SEC opener, Georgia trailed Tennessee by eight in the final minutes when Gunner Stockton hit London Humphreys on a 28-yard fade – on a do-or-die fourth down – for a touchdown. Georgia converted the two-pointer and eventually survived in overtime.

Their second-half comeback and last-minute resiliency wound up being the theme of the 2025 season.

Georgia trailed in seven of their eight SEC games, but still went 7-1 in league play. The goal-line fumble forced by CJ Allen saved the Auburn game, the defense suffocated Ole Miss in the fourth quarter, and against Florida it was a Chauncey Bowens 36-yard burst that clinched another one.

In total, four were fourth-quarter comeback wins.

“I don’t write the scripts,” joked head coach Kirby Smart.

Their lone loss was to Alabama, when the Crimson Tide came into Athens and snapped their nation-best 33-game home win streak. Georgia got another shot at them in the SEC title and dominated the rematch, 28-7, to clinch the program’s fourth SEC title in five years.

Georgia earned a first-round bye, but just like 2024, they were bounced in the quarterfinals. Trinidad Chambliss made countless highlight reel plays for Ole Miss, who seemed to rally internally after the Lane Kiffin drama.

On the Dynasty Tier, it is national title or bust. After consecutive crowns in 2021 and 2022, Georgia now has a three-year title drought – and Playoff win drought – heading into 2026.

They return 14 starters, and the newcomers to the starting lineup and two-deep are most likely five-stars or Top100 blue-chippers. Georgia’s last four recruiting classes: #2, #1, #2, #6. On top of that, they signed seven more four-star transfers to post the #2 transfer class on a per-player average.

OFFENSE

Stockton thrived in his first full-year as the starter. He earned third-team All-SEC after passing for 2,894 yards, 24 touchdowns (just 5 picks) with another 462 yards and 10 scores on the ground. He ranked fourth in QB Rating within the SEC and is now a proven, championship-caliber quarterback.

Georgia’s running back pair returns and both Nate Frazier and Chauncey Bowens took on the lead role at various points in the season. Frazier overcame his fumble issue with zero over the final 11 games. He led with 947 yards (5.5 per carry) and Bowens added 526 (5.1). Short-yardage bowling ball Josh McCray graduated but the staff found an SEC replacement in Dante Dowdell (Kentucky).

Their best offensive weapon Zachariah Branch went to the pros, and three more graduated: Colbie Young, Dillon Bell, and Noah Thomas. That means only one of their top five receivers returns with London Humphreys back on the outside. The staff signed a rising star in 6’3 Isiah Canion (Georgia Tech) who earned a four-star transfer grade after posting 480 yards and a high 14.6 per-catch average last season. Most schools would have added another round of transfers, but Georgia is confident in their elite recruiting here. Six more four-stars pack the rotation with five-star Talyn Taylor and Top100 CJ Wiley as the most likely breakout candidates. Kaiden Prothro is a 6’6 Top50 true freshman who was a spring hero.

Georgia also loses starting tight end Oscar Delp but the room remains packed with talent. Co-starter Lawson Luckie is back as a proven receiving threat, especially in the red zone, and he had a three-touchdown game in the first Ole Miss matchup. Jaden Reddell brings the speed, 6’7 Elyiss Williams is the blocker, and Ethan Barbour is an H-back, fullback type.

Similar to the wide receiver room, the staff avoided the transfer portal and doubled down on their stockpile of blue-chip offensive linemen. Monroe Freeling was a first-round draft pick, guard Micah Morris was also drafted, but the other three starters return. Drew Bobo earned second-team All-SEC at center, Earnest Greene excelled at tackle, and guard Dontrell Glover was named a Freshman All-American.

The open tackle spot will likely be former Top100 Juan Gaston, who earned some starts as a true freshman and will get a second-year bonus this fall. He’ll be challenged in fall camp by incoming five-star Ekene

GEORGIA										OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)	
O	36	20	4	3	2	19	19	4	5	48	5th
F	BOBO		MONKEN		COLEY		CHANEY				
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
D	SCHUMANN		SCHUMANN/MUSCHAMER		LANNING		TUCKER				
E	12	11	4	4	1	1	2	15	4	26	2nd
F											

GEORGIA		RANK	
Scoring Defense	17.6 ppg	10	
Points per Play	0.29	16	
Total Defense	298 ypg	14	
Yards per Play	4.9	23	
3rd Down Conv%	35%	32	
Rushing Defense	82 ypg	4	
Yards per Carry	2.9	8	
Negative Play %	7%	114	
Explosive Rush	3.2	1	
Passing Defense	217 ypg	60	
Yards / Attempt	6.6	42	
QB Rating	122	40	
Completion %	60.8%	55	
Explosive Pass	5.0	45	
Return. Production	72%	5	
Returning Snaps	12,735	29	

GEORGIA		RANK / 68
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play		
Offense Overall		36
Rushing Offense	0.4	23
Passing Offense	15.7	21
Defense Overall		12
Rushing Defense	1.4	7
Passing Defense	19.9	15

and he played like it, earning FWAA Freshman of the Year. Top100 DeMello Jones will battle Gentry Williams (Oklahoma) at the other corner spot.

KJ Bolden returns at safety after earning second-team All-SEC and last year Rasean Dinkins surged up the depth chart as a true freshman. Zion Branch also returns, plus the staff signed two four-star transfers in All-AAC ballhawk Ja'Marley Riddle (East Carolina) and three-year starter Khalil Barnes (Clemson). That's a ton of firepower to fill out the secondary.

OUTLOOK

Georgia won the SEC last year with the league's #1 rank in Game Grader, they return 14 starters, and the two-deep is overflowing with former five-stars. They will be back in Atlanta to defend their crown and benefit from the SEC's easiest schedule as the only team to face only three of the top eight.

Georgia is my pick to win the SEC title, but the Dynasty-Tier is graded on their performance in January. Kirby Smart has a championship-caliber defense yet again, but to make a deep Playoff run he'll need some of those five-star receiver recruits to rise up as game-changers.

Ogboko and Smart has shown he's willing to play true freshmen linemen recently. The open guard spot was a battle between two Top100's Daniel Calhoun and Michael Uini until true freshman Zykhe Helton emerged as a spring hero.

For Georgia to make a deeper Playoff run, the offensive line needs to get a more consistent, Top 25 run push. The past two lines have ranked #65 and #66 in my OL Run Push stat.

DEFENSE

After Smart's transition season in 2016, his next nine defenses were all Top 25 units in my opponent-adjusted rankings. Only Alabama and Notre Dame can match that streak.

The 2025 defense finished #12 and was especially stout against the run holding opponents to just 82 rushing yards/game (#4) and 2.9 per carry (#8).

Eight starters are back, along with the vast majority of the two-deep which holds more weight here because no other defense rotates their players more.

In the trenches, Christen Miller went pro but the other eight linemen in the three-deep are all back. Elijah Griffin and Jordan Hall are at defensive tackle, Xzavier McLeod and Nnamdi Ogboko rotate at nose tackle, while Gabe Harris and Joseph Jonah-Ajonye are at end. Georgia signed the #1 edge recruit of 2025 Isaiah Gibson, meaning this room packs *four* five-stars and four more former Top100's.

Brian Hartline had his conveyor belt of five-star receivers at Ohio State, but defensive coordinator Glenn Schumann has the linebacker equivalent here. First-team All-SEC CJ Allen went pro, but the three 2026 starters are all former five-stars. Raylen Wilson is back after a dominant 2025, Chris Cole returns at inside backer, and Justin Williams is the third backer.

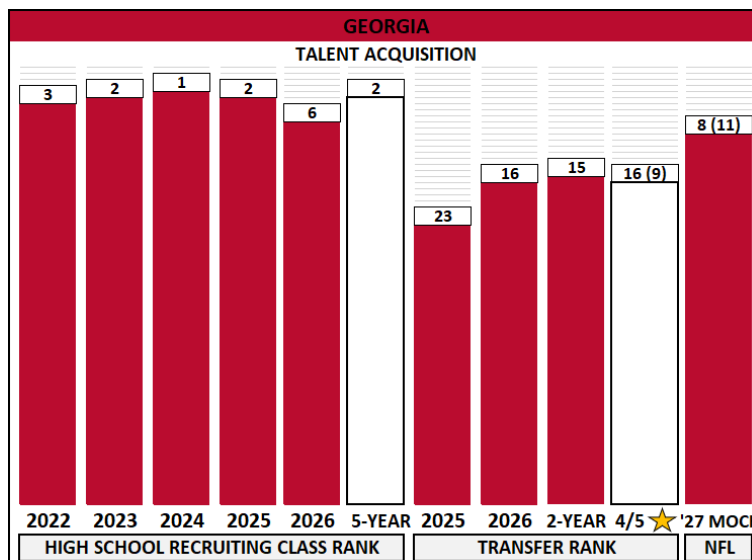
Quintavius Johnson is a returning starter at the "Jack" position, an outside backer/end hybrid, and the staff signed the #4 ranked transfer edge Amaris Williams (Auburn) but he suffered a spring ACL injury.

Four starters are back in the secondary with cornerback Daylen Everette as the lone departure. Ellis Robinson was ranked the #1 cornerback of the 2024 class

GEORGIA	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	TENN. ST (FCS)
S. 12	W. KENTUCKY
S. 19	@ Arkansas
S. 26	OKLAHOMA
O. 3	VANDERBILT
O. 10	@ Alabama
O. 17	AUBURN
O. 24	--- BYE ---
O. 31	*FLORIDA (ATL)
N. 7	@ Ole Miss
N. 14	MISSOURI
N. 21	@ S. Carolina
N. 28	GA TECH

GEORGIA		RANK / 68
All-Time Wins	904	9
All-Time Win %	0.669	11
Wins (Last 100)	778	4
Wins (Last 50)	462	3
Wins (Last 25)	263	2
Wins (Last 10)	117	2
Wins (Last 5)	65	1
Game Grader (10 yr)	79.6	3
Game Grader (5 yr)	84.5	1
Game Grader (3 yr)	78.1	4
Draft Picks s' 2000	178	3
Draft Picks s' 2010	122	3
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		35
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		35

GEORGIA		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
74.9 (7)	68.7 (11)	90.7 (1)	96.9 (1)	91.3 (1)	74.1 (7)	78.1 (6)	81 (3)	83.6 (3)	56.7 (23)	79.6 (3)	



WEEKLY, IN-SEASON FEATURE -- ADVANCED STATS & INFO

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OKLAHOMA

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#2(TIE)

#6

SEC

OVERALL



OKLAHOMA				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13 OKLA ST	(B) Florida St	(B) Arizona	(B) Navy	(P) Alabama
12 BAYLOR	TEXAS TECH	OKLA ST	LSU	OLE MISS
11 (B) Oregon	WVU	KANSAS	MISSOURI	TEXAS
10 IOWA ST	BAYLOR	TCU	OLE MISS	LSU
9 TEXAS TECH	TEXAS	BYU	S. CAROLINA	MISSOURI
8 KANSAS	TCU	WVU	TEXAS	ALABAMA
7 TCU	KANSAS ST	UCF	TENNESSEE	TENNESSEE
6 TEXAS	OKLA ST	TEXAS	ALABAMA	S. CAROLINA
5 KANSAS ST	IOWA ST	IOWA ST	Maine (FCS)	Kent State
4 WVU	KANSAS	CINCINNATI	AUBURN	AUBURN
3 Nebraska	Nebraska	Tulsa	Tulane	Temple
2 W. Carolina (FCS)	Kent State	SMU	Houston	Michigan
1 Tulane	UTEP	Arkansas St	Temple	Illinois St (FCS)
2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
RILEY	BRENT VENABLES			

OKLAHOMA				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
Illinois St (FCS) W 35-3	344	-2	71.0	
MICHIGAN W 24-13	120	-2	88.6	
TEMPLE W 42-3	411	-1	85.5	
AUBURN W 24-17	16	-1	70.0	
KENT ST W 44-0	220	2	77.3	
TEXAS L 6-23	-44	-3	26.3	
S. CAROLINA W 26-7	95	2	91.7	
OLE MISS L 26-34	-72	-1	34.0	
TENNESSEE W 33-27	-105	1	60.5	
ALABAMA W 23-21	-194	3	48.5	
MISSOURI W 17-6	-25	2	78.4	
LSU W 17-13	195	-2	79.4	
(P) ALABAMA L 24-34	102	-1	50.3	
OVERALL: 13th / 68	SEC: 5th / 16	66.3		

OKLAHOMA		UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK	NATIONAL		
(of 16)	TOP 15		
QUARTERBACK	5	14	
RUNNING BACKS	12		
RECEIVERS & TE	6	9	
OFFENSIVE LINE	5		
DEFENSIVE LINE	1	2	
LINEBACKERS	6	11	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	1	2	

OKLAHOMA		RANK	
Scoring Offense	26.2 ppg	79	
Points per Play	0.39	75	
Total Offense	354 ypg	92	
Yards per Play	5.3	97	
Rushing Offense	118 ypg	113	
Yards per Carry	3.5	118	
O-Line Run Push	3.7	124	
Explosive Rush	4.2	113	
Passing Offense	236 ypg	60	
Yards / Attempt	7.1	72	
QB Rating	129	81	
TD / INT Ratio	1.5	91	
Sacks / Attempt	7%	86	
Explosive Pass	6.6	74	
Return. Production	75%	3	
Returning Snaps	17,353	5	
25.7 SECONDS/PLAY #26 of 68 P4	ARBuckle (2025 OU)		

bid since 2019.

Though the first-round rematch with Alabama went the wrong way, the 10-win season with half against ranked teams, was a statement season.

Oklahoma returns 14 starters, seven on each side, and gets a second-year coordinator bonus on offense. Venables landed the breakthrough season, and 2026 presents a shot to prove staying power in the SEC.

OFFENSE

Last offseason Venables hired rising-star coordinator Ben Arbuckle to install his Air Raid offense that shattered records at Western Kentucky and Washington State. It was a package deal too, with Arbuckle bringing his quarterback Mateer who led FBS with 44 total touchdowns in 2024.

It simply didn't click in 2025. Maybe it was the transition year and new scheme installation, or the freshman-filled offensive line, or Mateer's hand injury. But while the defense ranked #3 in my opponent-adjusted metric, the offense was just #50 of 68 Power 4.

Before Mateer hurt his hand in the Auburn game, Oklahoma's opponent-adjusted passing was #42, but post-injury it fell slightly to #52 of 68. Mateer placed 13th in the SEC in QB Rating with 14 touchdown passes and 11 picks.

This offseason Mateer focused on fixing his mechanics and footwork – less sidearm, off-balance throws – and appeared improved throughout spring ball. Stats aside, he always has that uncanny playmaking ability and should get an efficiency boost in his second SEC season.

The run game was "pathetic" in Venables' words. The 3.5 yards/carry was Oklahoma's worst since 2010 and the 118 yards/game was their worst since 1999. He hired ace running backs coach Deland McCullough who had just coached Heisman finalists in back-to-back years with Ashton Jeanty and Jeremiyah Love. Tory Blaylock led with 480 yards as a true freshman, Xavier Robinson added 421 and both return for 2026.

The offensive line was part of the issue, as the extremely young unit ranked in the national bottom ten of my OL Run Push metric (#124). Three freshmen moved up the depth chart to combine for 24 starts last year. Michael Fasusi started all year as a true freshman five-star, while Top100 Ryan Fodje and Eddy Pierre-Louis started six each. Those young reps and starts should pay dividends with a second-year bonus here in 2026. Starting center Jake Maikkula also returns, and while they do lose an All-SEC draft pick in Febechi Nwaiwu, the staff signed two-year Arkansas starter E'Marion Harris who earned a four-star transfer billing. Six upperclassmen transferred out to other Power 4 rosters, but all were three-star transfers who fell behind the youngsters on the depth chart.

Sategna earned first-team All-SEC after placing in the league's top three in receiving yards and touchdowns. He returns in the slot, and while their next three departed, the staff landed two highly-touted Power 4 starters through the portal. 6'3 Parker Livingstone (Texas) was in the starting rotation as a freshman and posted an explosive 17.8 per-catch average good for fourth in the SEC. Trell Harris

OKLAHOMA					OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	50	64	11	23	10	8	3	1	1	1				
F	ARBuckle	LITRELL	JEFF LEBBY	GUNDY / BEDENBAUGH					RILEY					3rd
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR			
D	BATES	ALLEY	TED ROOF	ALEX GRINCH			McNEILL	MIKE STOOPS						
E	3	10	13	42	44	27	32	55	41	41				21st
F														

OKLAHOMA		RANK
Scoring Defense	15.5 ppg	7
Points per Play	0.24	7
Total Defense	273 ypg	6
Yards per Play	4.3	4
3rd Down Conv%	28%	3
Rushing Defense	77 ypg	3
Yards per Carry	2.4	2
Negative Play %	15%	1
Explosive Rush	3.9	4
Passing Defense	195 ypg	32
Yards / Attempt	6.2	21
QB Rating	116	22
Completion %	59%	31
Explosive Pass	5.1	49
Return. Production	55%	57
Returning Snaps	9,736	67

OKLAHOMA		RANK / 68
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play		
Offense Overall		50
Rushing Offense	(0.4)	51
Passing Offense	(3.3)	47
Defense Overall		3
Rushing Defense	1.9	2
Passing Defense	24.3	10

Thomas and Gracen Halton were drafted, but All-SEC Taylor Wein returns after leading with seven sacks, 15 TFL, and 35 QB pressures off the edge. Wein is poised for an All-America campaign and at the other end spot former five-star Adepoju Adebawore and Top200 Danny Okoye are the next duo up. Oklahoma also signed a Top100 prospect in Jake Kreul. At the tackle spots, five-star David Stone has been dominant, and Jayden Jackson earned Freshman All-America in 2024. Another Top200 pair rounds out the two-deep: Nigel Smith and Trent Wilson.

Owen Heinecke got a bonus year of eligibility, so Oklahoma returns its top two tacklers at linebacker. Heinecke and Kip Lewis combined for 22.5 tackles-for-loss, and while their backups transferred out, Oklahoma signed four-star Cole Sullivan (Michigan) who started the final three games last year and was looking like a Michigan rising star.

The elite corner duo returns with All-SEC Eli Bowen paired with SEC All-Freshman Courtland Guillory, plus the third corner is another blue-chipper in Top100 Jacobe Johnson. Peyton Bowen is yet another all-leaguer at safety, Michael Boganowski is a hard hitter in run support, and Reggie Powers is their hybrid "cheetah" role.

OUTLOOK

Oklahoma has a championship-caliber defense again. The passing attack will be improved thanks to two key transfer additions at receiver, a second-year coordinator bonus, and a healthy Mateer.

Oklahoma will return to the Playoff in 2026, and they are my pick to play Georgia in the SEC title game.

(Virginia) earned All-ACC with a productive 59 catches for 847 yards last year. It's already a proven starting trio, but Mackenzie Alleyne (Washington State) emerged as a spring hero and has past experience in Arbuckle's offense.

The tight end room is a total rebuild after All-SEC Jaren Kanak went pro. The converted linebacker Kanak was solid but now the staff added in a pair of four-star transfers, plus Hall-of-Famer Jason Witten to coach the position. Hayden Hansen (Florida) was a three-year starter and ranked second in the SEC with 44 catches last year. Hansen was ranked the #2 transfer tight end this cycle, and Jack Van Dorselaer was a four-star in the 2025 class. They showed off more 12 personnel (one back, two tight ends) in spring.

DEFENSE

When he took over, Oklahoma had posted six straight below-average defenses. Venables' third defense ranked #10 in my opponent-adjusted number. His fourth defense was a masterpiece.

Oklahoma led the nation in sacks/game and TFL/game, ranked 4th in yards/play, and 7th in scoring defense. Aside from the stat sheet, the defense made the game-winning plays against Tennessee and Alabama to help punch their Playoff ticket.

The elite depth in the trenches stood out -- they rotated eight-deep and never missed a beat.

Half of that defensive line group returns, and in total seven starting defenders are back. That includes four All-SEC stars and two All-Freshmen.

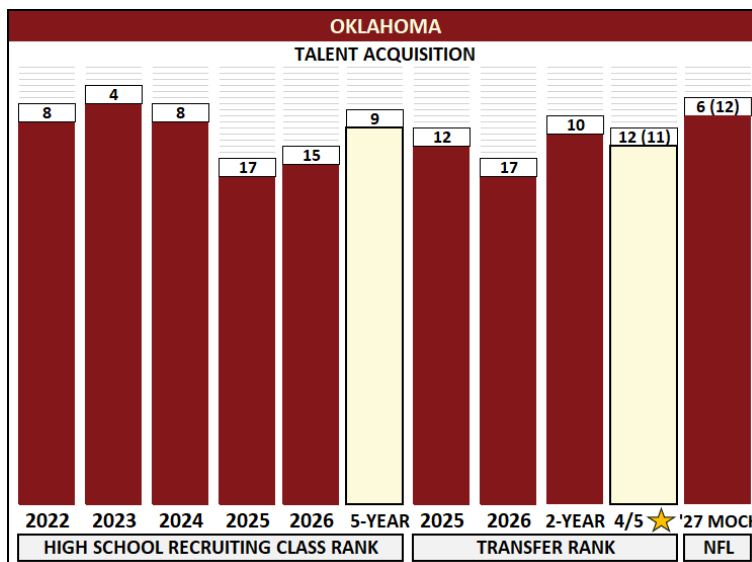
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OKLAHOMA	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 4	UTEP
S. 12	@ Michigan
S. 19	NEW MEXICO
S. 26	@ Georgia
O. 3	--- BYE ---
O. 10	*TEXAS (DALLAS)
O. 17	KENTUCKY
O. 24	@ Miss. State
O. 31	S. CAROLINA
N. 7	@ Florida
N. 14	OLE MISS
N. 21	TEXAS A&M
N. 28	@ Missouri

OKLAHOMA		RANK / 68
All-Time Wins	960	6
All-Time Win %	0.723	5
Wins (Last 100)	814	2
Wins (Last 50)	464	2
Wins (Last 25)	258	3
Wins (Last 10)	99	6
Wins (Last 5)	43	17
Game Grader (10 yr)	71.0	6
Game Grader (5 yr)	62.2	11
Game Grader (3 yr)	62.8	15
Draft Picks s' 2000	129	9
Draft Picks s' 2010	87	8
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		52
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		49

OKLAHOMA				GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)						
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
66.3 (13)	47.4 (44)	74.7 (8)	56.4 (26)	66.3 (12)	86.4 (2)	78.2 (5)	75.2 (6)	84.3 (2)	75 (7)	71 (6)



PICK SIX PLUS

WEEKLY, IN-SEASON FEATURE -- ADVANCED STATS & INFO

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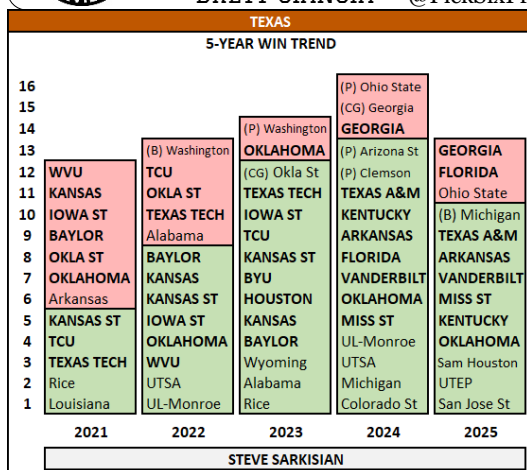


TEXAS

BRETT CIANCIA @PickSixPreviews

#2(TIE) #7

SEC OVERALL



Fresh off consecutive Playoff runs, Texas entered 2025 as the preseason AP #1 team for the first time in school history. They also had the preseason Heisman favorite at quarterback with five-star super-recruit Arch Manning.

The hype was short-lived as they ran into a brick wall in the opener. #3 Ohio State stuffed Texas twice inside the 10 yard-line and took away Manning's deep ball. The 14-7 loss didn't change any team goals, but their SEC opener loss to unranked Florida did. Manning was sacked six times, missed two wide-open touchdown throws, and the running backs were held to 15 yards rushing.

Ryan Niblett saved the season with game-changing punt returns in three straight games, the 23-6 win over Oklahoma, and then overtime-survival wins against Kentucky and Mississippi State. Texas was able to beat three Top 10 teams – Oklahoma, Vanderbilt, Texas A&M – to get back into the Playoff hunt, but a total meltdown in the fourth quarter against Georgia dealt them an eliminating third loss.

With the bowl win, Steve Sarkisian got Texas to 10+ wins in three consecutive seasons for the first time here since 2009. But with such high preseason expectations, and nation-leading roster funding, a Playoff miss makes it a missed opportunity.

TEXAS				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
OHIO ST L 7-14	133	-1	61.1	
SAN JOSE ST W 38-7	199	2	74.7	
UTEP W 27-10	81	1	56.2	
SAM HOUSTON W 55-0	494	1	78.8	
FLORIDA L 21-29	-116	0	26.7	
OKLAHOMA W 23-6	44	3	96.0	
KENTUCKY W 16-13	-216	1	34.8	
MISS. ST W 45-38	-17	0	52.8	
VANDERBILT W 34-31	5	1	65.6	
GEORGIA L 10-35	-83	0	18.8	
ARKANSAS W 52-37	-22	2	66.7	
TEXAS A&M W 27-17	60	2	89.8	
(B) MICHIGAN W 41-27	83	2	92.5	
OVERALL: 22nd / 68 SEC: 8th / 16 62.7				

After finishing #4 and #3 in Game Grader the previous two seasons, Texas slid down to #22 in 2025 for their lowest rank since Sarkisian's debut in 2021.

To turn the momentum back around, Sarkisian made a coordinator switch on defense, and then Texas reloaded with the #3 transfer haul this cycle. This class brings an instant boost of talent to offensive skill positions and in total adds an incredible 10 Power 4 starters into the program.

At Texas, the standard is always Playoff or Bust, but that is even more true after a hiatus.

OFFENSE

Sometimes the national media locks in on a topic and it drives extreme viewpoints. The preseason hype for Manning was clearly too high, but conversely the negative overreactions in September went too far the other way. Manning's 2025 season was common: a first-time starting quarterback had some growing pains and then showed clear improvements as the season progressed.

He was booed after 10 straight incompletions against UTEP but then in the season-finale he out-dued a Heisman contender and ruined A&M's perfect season.

My opponent-adjusted passing stats show the in-season development. Texas ranked #42 of 68 Power 4 over the first half of the season, but rose to #15 over the final six games. Manning threw for 3,163 yards, 26 touchdowns and just seven picks, and also added 399 rushing yards and 10 scores on the ground – and he even caught one against Arkansas.

Texas bolstered the skill positions around him and they enter 2026 with a top running back duo and arguably the best receiver room.

The top three running backs all transferred out, but Texas signed the #3 and #6 ranked transfers and both were all-conference in 2025. Hollywood Smothers (NC State) led the ACC with 85 yards/game and Raleek Brown (Arizona State) has been described by coaches as a "Tasmanian Devil, a bowling ball, and a pitbull." Both backs are explosive, with high 6.0 yard/carry averages last year.

The receiver room struggled with dropped passes and lead target Ryan Wingo was often double-teamed. The other two starters DeAndre Moore (Colorado) and Parker Livingstone (Oklahoma) transferred out but Texas signed the nation's #1 receiver Cam Coleman (Auburn). Wingo and Coleman are both former five-stars, and Coleman is a future first-round draft pick who wins 50/50 balls and adds a red zone boost. Defenses can't double-team them both. Emmett Mosley returns in the slot and is joined by Wake Forest starter Sterling Berkhalter and former Top100 Daylan McCutcheon. As if that wasn't enough, another pair of five-star freshmen pack the rotation: Kaliq Lockett and Jermaine Bishop.

Jack Endries went pro, but the staff signed Michigan State starting tight end Michael Masunas, who earned four-star transfer grades, to battle Top100 Nick Townsend.

The limiting factor on offense, and maybe the overall 2026 team, is their offensive line development. Last year they failed to get consistent rushing production, ranking #82 in my OL Run Push for the second straight year. They broke down in pass protection in their losses.

TEXAS	UNIT RANKS
SEC RANK (of 16)	NATIONAL TOP 15
QUARTERBACK	3 7
RUNNING BACKS	3 4
RECEIVERS & TE	1 3
OFFENSIVE LINE	3 13
DEFENSIVE LINE	3 8
LINEBACKERS	5 10
DEFENSIVE BACKS	5 11

TEXAS	RANK
Scoring Offense 30.5 ppg	41
Points per Play 0.47	36
Total Offense 389 ypg	70
Yards per Play 6.0	41
Rushing Offense 138 ypg	90
Yards per Carry 4.2	84
O-Line Run Push 4.1	82
Explosive Rush 5.2	72
Passing Offense 251 ypg	44
Yards / Attempt 7.7	46
QB Rating 145	38
TD / INT Ratio 4.0	12
Sacks / Attempt 5%	46
Explosive Pass 8.1	33
Return. Production 73%	4
Returning Snaps 13,308	27
25.6 SECONDS/PLAY #22 of 68 P4	
SARKISIAN (2025 TEXAS)	

TEXAS					OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)								
O													
F	23	14	13	19	26	7	14	54	62	42	18th		
F	KYLE FLOOD					YURCICH	TIM BECK				GILBERT		
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR		
D	PETE KWIATKOWSKI					ASH	TODD ORLANDO				BEDFORD		
E	10	2	15	5	47	17	43	20	12	25	12th		
F													

TEXAS		RANK	
Scoring Defense	20.3 ppg	28	
Points per Play	0.29	20	
Total Defense	339 ypg	40	
Yards per Play	4.9	21	
3rd Down Conv%	34%	21	
Rushing Defense	104 ypg	14	
Yards per Carry	3.1	12	
Negative Play %	9%	35	
Explosive Rush	5.4	35	
Passing Defense	235 ypg	97	
Yards / Attempt	6.6	44	
QB Rating	124	41	
Completion %	62.6%	78	
Explosive Pass	4.5	14	
Return. Production	63%	19	
Returning Snaps	13,812	19	

TEXAS		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		23	
Rushing Offense	0.1	40	
Passing Offense	10.7	31	
Defense Overall		10	
Rushing Defense	1.4	5	
Passing Defense	10.7	25	

Their best lineman, All-SEC DJ Campbell was drafted but three starters return. Left tackle Trevor Goosby is drawing high draft projections himself and should get All-America hype. Connor Robertson is back at center, and Brandon Baker is shifting from tackle to guard. Two incoming transfers fill out the other two spots with FBS veteran Laurence Seymore (Western Kentucky) at left guard and Wake Forest starter Melvin Siani – who allowed zero sacks on 900 snaps last year – at right tackle.

DEFENSE

Texas posted a Top 10 overall defense in my opponent-adjusted metric, but they struggled against the pass and Sarkisian decided to make a change. He fired coordinator Pete Kwiatkowski and hired Will Muschamp, a top defensive mind who has had more success as a coordinator than a head coach. Muschamp aka “Coach Boom” has been with the Georgia program the past five years as an analyst and co-coordinator.

Muschamp led the defense here for three years from 2008-2010 and during that span Texas led the nation in sacks and placed in the top ten of all major stat categories. The 2009 team made it all the way to the national title.

Three starters return along the defensive line with All-SEC Colin Simmons as the headliner. Simmons led the conference with 12 sacks and is a sure-fire All-America pick for 2026. Muschamp mentioned moving Simmons around in various spots and roles to confuse offenses. At the other end Lance Jackson returns after an SEC All-Freshman debut. Muschamp likes huge space-eating nose tackles to control two gaps, and he’s got two giants here with 330-pounder Maraad Watson and Arkansas starter Ian Geffrard who checks in at 6’5 380. Hero Kanu and Alex January are both back at the other tackle spot.

All-American linebacker Anthony Hill went pro, starter Lione Lefau transferred out, but Ty’Anthony Smith is the next rising star. Brad Spence is another returning starter though incoming Top100 Kosi Okpala could earn reps right away. The staff signed two four-star transfers who were Power 4 starters last year: Justin Cryer (Florida State) and Rasheem Biles (Pittsburgh) who is a two-time All-ACC selection with three Pick Sixes the past two years.

The secondary needs the most improvement after falling from elite (#2) in 2024 down to average last year (#42) in opponent QB Rating. Both All-SEC picks are gone with corner Malik Muhammad and captain Michael Taaffe both getting drafted. Texas has a pair of five-stars as projected starters at corner with returning starter Kobe Black and redshirt freshman Kade Phillips – plus they added Bo Mascio (Rutgers) who has shown strong coverage skills in the Big Ten.

Top100 Graceson Littleton impressed as a true freshman and will start at nickel, Jelani McDonald should get All-SEC hype, and a pair of five-stars – Derek Williams and Xavier Filsaime – battle at the other safety spot.

OUTLOOK

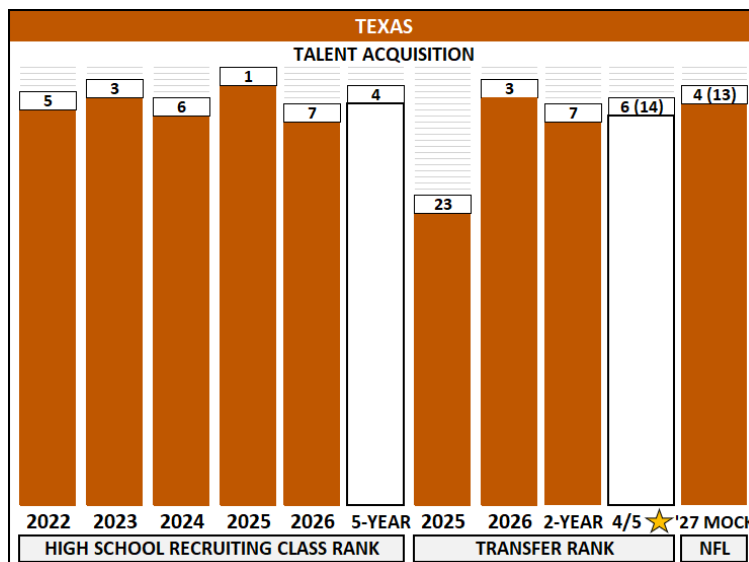
Texas went all-in this offseason with a top five transfer haul that packed in 10 Power 4 starters to a roster already overflowing with five-star talent. They are also in the top five in high school recruiting average, and are #4 in projected NFL Draft picks.

Like most quarterbacks, Manning will get a second-year boost – he already showed improvement as the 2025 season progressed. Texas is a Playoff pick, though the SEC crown stays with Georgia until someone takes it.

TEXAS	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	TEXAS STATE
S. 12	OHIO STATE
S. 19	UTSA
S. 26	@ Tennessee
O. 3	--- BYE ---
O. 10	*OKLAHOMA (DAL)
O. 17	FLORIDA
O. 24	OLE MISS
O. 31	MISSISSIPPI ST
N. 7	@ Missouri
N. 14	@ LSU
N. 21	ARKANSAS
N. 27	@ Texas A&M

TEXAS		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	971	5	
All-Time Win %	0.704	6	
Wins (Last 100)	769	5	
Wins (Last 50)	417	12	
Wins (Last 25)	227	8	
Wins (Last 10)	85	13	
Wins (Last 5)	48	8	
Game Grader (10 yr)	64.6	9	
Game Grader (5 yr)	69.2	8	
Game Grader (3 yr)	75.6	5	
Draft Picks s' 2000	110	14	
Draft Picks s' 2010	71	14	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		34	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		41	

TEXAS		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
62.7 (22)	81.8 (3)	82.4 (4)	68.9 (11)	50.2 (40)	69.4 (12)	61.9 (21)	61.2 (19)	57 (27)	50.4 (36)	64.6 (9)	



WEEKLY, IN-SEASON FEATURE -- ADVANCED STATS & INFO

SAMPLE PDF, INFO, AND ORDERS AT PICKSIXPREVIEWS.COM/PLUS



OLE MISS

BRETT CIANCIA @PickSixPreviews

#4

SEC

#10

OVERALL



OLE MISS 5-YEAR WIN TREND				
15				(P) Miami GEORGIA
14				(P) Georgia (P) Tulane
13	(B) Baylor AUBURN	(B) Texas Tech MISS ST	GEORGIA ALABAMA	(P) Georgia (P) Tulane
12	ALABAMA	ARKANSAS	(B) Penn St KENTUCKY	MISS ST
11	MISS ST	ALABAMA	MISS ST	FLORIDA
10	VANDERBILT	LSU	UL-Monroe	Citadel (FCS)
9	TEXAS A&M	TEXAS A&M	TEXAS A&M	S. CAROLINA
8	Liberty	AUBURN	ARKANSAS	OKLAHOMA
7	LSU	VANDERBILT	OKLAHOMA	Wash. St
6	TENNESSEE	KENTUCKY	ARKANSAS	LSU
5	ARKANSAS	Tulsa	LSU	Tulane
4	Tulane	GA Tech	GA Tech	ARKANSAS
3	Austin Peay (FCS)	C. Ark. (FCS)	Tulane	KENTUCKY
2	Louisville	Troy	Mercer (FCS)	GA State
1				
2021 2022 2023 2024 2025				
LANE KIFFIN				

OLE MISS 2025 RESULTS				
	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
GEORGIA ST	W 63-7	435	-1	79.4
KENTUCKY	W 30-23	96	-2	64.1
ARKANSAS	W 41-35	-51	1	50.7
TULANE	W 45-10	266	0	105.4
LSU	W 24-19	226	-1	85.1
WASH. ST	W 24-21	94	-1	59.1
GEORGIA	L 35-43	-159	0	29.2
OKLAHOMA	W 34-26	72	1	87.9
S. CAROLINA	W 30-14	187	1	95.0
Citadel (FCS)	W 49-0	497	-1	76.8
FLORIDA	W 34-24	212	0	86.5
MISS. ST	W 38-19	105	1	74.2
(P) TULANE	W 41-10	76	2	92.8
(P) GEORGIA	W 39-34	130	0	88.2
(P) MIAMI	L 27-31	-61	1	47.4
OVERALL: 8th / 68 SEC: 2nd / 16 74.8				

OLE MISS		UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK		NATIONAL	
(of 16)		TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	1	1	
RUNNING BACKS	2	2	
RECEIVERS & TE	5	14	
OFFENSIVE LINE	4		
DEFENSIVE LINE	5	11	
LINEBACKERS	2	5	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	7		

OLE MISS		RANK	
Scoring Offense	36.9 ppg	10	
Points per Play	0.5	19	
Total Offense	490 ypg	2	
Yards per Play	6.7	16	
Rushing Offense	176 ypg	44	
Yards per Carry	4.6	46	
O-Line Run Push	4.2	79	
Explosive Rush	5.4	60	
Passing Offense	313 ypg	3	
Yards / Attempt	9	10	
QB Rating	154	18	
TD / INT Ratio	3.3	24	
Sacks / Attempt	4%	10	
Explosive Pass	10.1	7	
Return. Production	61%	42	
Returning Snaps	15,982	11	
21.8 SECONDS/PLAY #1 of 68 P4			
BAKER (2025 E. CAROLINA) FAST			

Lane Kiffin called himself the Portal King and backed up the title by signing top-rated transfer classes every offseason. He used the transfer portal as an equalizer to catch up to the five-star recruiters atop the SEC, and after a close call in 2024, his sixth Ole Miss team broke through to the Playoff.

For all the four-star transfers and national stars he signed, it was actually a Division II quarterback who was the difference-maker. The staff found Trinidad Chambliss, an under-sized, under-recruited winner whose only other offer was from Temple. When starter Austin Simmons suffered an injury two weeks in, Chambliss stepped up and held the job for good.

Ole Miss survived one-score battles against Arkansas and Washington State, and then Chambliss threw for 315 yards on an elite Oklahoma defense. They sealed their best regular season in school history with a 38-19 Egg Bowl win to get to 11-1 and clinch the school's first-ever Playoff spot.

Off the field, a whole different circus was underway, as Kiffin considered taking other head coaching jobs amid the biggest coaching carousel of all-time. No matter your opinion of Kiffin's actions and decision, this ridiculous schedule forces head coaches to decide between coaching a Playoff team or accepting a heavily-desired job elsewhere. No other sport has overlapping deadlines like that.

Kiffin ultimately took the LSU job, wanted to coach Ole Miss through the postseason, but the Ole Miss admin rejected that proposal. Instead of a drawn out head coaching search of their own, athletic director Keith Carter knew "we had a guy in our building" already in defensive coordinator Pete Golding.

Golding and the Ole Miss team rallied together and blew out Tulane 41-10, got revenge on Georgia 39-34, and earned a spot in the national semifinals. The Rebels held a lead in the final seconds but Miami's Carson Beck scrambled in for the decisive touchdown.

13 wins marked a school record, and Ole Miss finished ranked #3 in the AP for their best finish in over 60 years. The fact they did so despite a tremendous amount of outside noise and distractions speaks volumes.

The next fear was that Kiffin would raid the Ole Miss roster by stealing all the star players, and though he did convince a handful of starters, it was not the wrecking ball some expected. In fact, Ole Miss punched back harder and signed the #2 transfer haul in America.

OFFENSE

Chambliss took advantage of his opportunity and thrived into a national star. He quickly drew Kyler Murray comparisons, threw for nearly 4,000 yards, rushed for 527, totaled 30 touchdowns, and finished eighth in the Heisman. Then in the Georgia playoff game his wild scrambles helped convert and extend drives and lead the win.

He won a court case to return for a bonus year of eligibility and enters 2026 as a legit Heisman favorite. Original starter Austin Simmons transferred out to Missouri but the staff landed former five-star, MS legend Deuce Knight (Auburn) as their quarterback of the future.

Kiffin and his coordinator Charlie Weis are gone, but Golding wanted to continue with their successful, productive, up-tempo scheme. He hired John David Baker, who was here at Ole Miss as Weis' co-coordinator until 2023, then improved East Carolina from #127 scoring to #34 and #24 the past two seasons. Baker says his 2026 scheme is "80% the same" as what has worked here.

Kewan Lacy earned first-team All-SEC, FWAA All-America, and returns after an Ole Miss record-tying 1,567 yard season (Quinshon Judkins 2022). He punched in a Power 4-best 24 touchdowns last year and is now complemented by Michigan State starter Makhfi Frazier and former Top200 JT Lindsey (LSU).

Ole Miss was overflowing with talent on the outsides, and five pass-catchers placed in the SEC's Top 25 of receiving stats. Four of those are gone – Harrison Wallace, De'Zhaun Stribling, Cayden Lee (Missouri) and tight end Dae'Quan Wright – but as always Ole Miss restocked the room. Deuce Alexander is a returning starter and their new #1 weapon, 2025 five-star Caleb Cunningham is ready for a breakout season, and then the staff added another round of five Power 4 receivers. Johntay Cook and Darrell Gill combined for over 1,000 yards as Syracuse starters, Horatio Fields (Auburn) earned a four-star transfer grade, and Traylon Ray (West Virginia) and Isaiah Spencer (Virginia Tech) bring Power 4 experience.

OLE MISS						OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)											
O																	
F	7	3	20	15	15	12	28	5	9	18	4th						
F	WEIS		BAKER / WEIS		LEBBY		RODRIGUEZ		LONGO		LUKE						
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR						
D	GOLDING			PARTRIDGE		DURKIN		MacINTYRE		McGRIFF		WOMMACK					
E	38	9	32	36	29	64	39	61	63	55	51st						
F																	

OLE MISS		RANK	
Scoring Defense	21.1 ppg	37	
Points per Play	0.32	33	
Total Defense	348 ypg	48	
Yards per Play	5.2	41	
3rd Down Conv%	37%	50	
Rushing Defense	149 ypg	69	
Yards per Carry	4.2	65	
Negative Play %	8%	63	
Explosive Rush	6.1	54	
Passing Defense	199 ypg	37	
Yards / Attempt	6.5	34	
QB Rating	120	30	
Completion %	56.8%	20	
Explosive Pass	5.1	47	
Return. Production	62%	25	
Returning Snaps	16,812	5	

OLE MISS		RANK / 68
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play		
Offense Overall		7
Rushing Offense	0.9	14
Passing Offense	20.3	14
Defense Overall		38
Rushing Defense	(0.1)	54
Passing Defense	17.2	17

hits like a truck, Luke Ferrelli was named ACC Defensive Rookie of the Year after leading all freshmen with 91 tackles, and Tah'j Butler started some games for Georgia Tech. This a top national unit.

The cornerback starters Antonio Kite and Jaylon Braxton are both back, plus they added Auburn starter and four-star transfer Jalyn Crawford. Their safeties are gone but they added three more starters in Edwin Joseph (Florida State), Sharif Denson (Florida), and Joenel Aguero (Georgia).

OUTLOOK

Ole Miss is right back in SEC title contention with Chambliss back and operating in a similar scheme. The receivers may not be as proven as last season, but there is enough firepower – plus an All-American running back – to keep the offense in the top ten.

Golding focused on the defense this transfer cycle and added an amazing *eight* four-star defenders. Ole Miss is a Playoff at-large pick, and Chambliss already showed he can work magic in January.

Wright went pro, but a pair of former five-stars form an elite tight end pair for 2026. Luke Hasz is finally back healthy, and Caleb Odom is a receiving matchup nightmare who could also play some receiver.

The offensive line returns its interior with guards Patrick Kutas and Delano Townsend and center Brycen Sanders all back. They did lose two great ones at the tackle spots with All-SEC Diego Pounds and NFL draft pick Jayden Williams both gone. And then their rising star at tackle Devin Harper followed Kiffin to Baton Rouge. Ole Miss stole one back from LSU with their starting tackle Carius Curne who was a Top100 recruit and ranked the #4 transfer lineman this cycle. Terez Davis is projected at the other tackle spot, but three other Power 4 transfers will compete.

DEFENSE

Kiffin's first three defenses averaged #43 of 68 Power 4 in my opponent-adjusted metric. Golding took over in 2023 and his second unit finished ranked #9. Heading into 2025, Kiffin put most resources into the offensive side of the transfer portal, but Golding made sure to load up on defense this cycle.

Ole Miss signed an incredible *eight* four-star transfer defenders. Yes, they lost a pair of All-SEC stars to Kiffin -- linebacker TJ Dottery and edge Princewill Umanmielen – but Golding has stacked the roster heading into 2026.

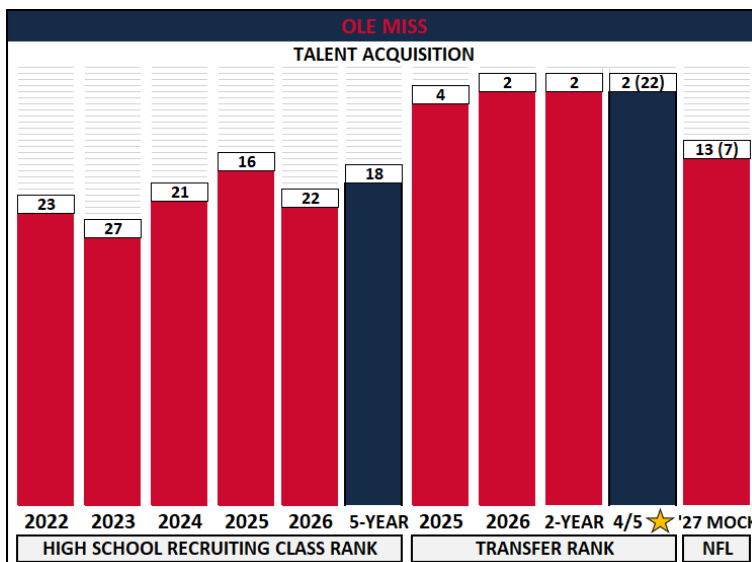
First-team All-SEC defensive tackle Will Echoles is back after leading Power 4 tackles with 39 quarterback pressures. Kam Franklin is another returning starter at end, and then Ole Miss signed the top haul of defensive linemen with *four* four-stars incoming. Blake Purchase (Oregon) and Jordan Renaud (Alabama) look to replace Umanmielen's production off the edge, while Jehiem Oatis (Colorado) and Michai Boireau (Florida) pack the interior. Boireau even had an athletic, game-winning interception to beat Mississippi State last year. Jonathan Maldonado (Nevada) earned All-Mountain West last year.

Do-it-all Suntarine Perkins returns as a hybrid linebacker, edge rusher and is poised for an All-American run in his final season. Though they lose Golding's so-called "quarterback of the defense" Dottery, they landed a trio of Power 4 starters. Keaton Thomas (Baylor) was All-Big 12 and

OLE MISS	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 6	*L'VILLE (NASH.)
S. 12	CHARLOTTE
S. 19	LSU
S. 26	@ Florida
O. 3	--- BYE ---
O. 10	@ Vanderbilt
O. 17	MISSOURI
O. 24	@ Texas
O. 31	AUBURN
N. 7	GEORGIA
N. 14	@ Oklahoma
N. 21	WOFFORD (FCS)
N. 27	MISS. STATE

OLE MISS		RANK / 68
All-Time Wins	732	30
All-Time Win %	0.568	33
Wins (Last 100)	628	20
Wins (Last 50)	318	37
Wins (Last 25)	173	38
Wins (Last 10)	77	22
Wins (Last 5)	52	7
Game Grader (10 yr)	57.5	20
Game Grader (5 yr)	69.3	7
Game Grader (3 yr)	74.3	6
Draft Picks s' 2000	72	31
Draft Picks s' 2010	52	24
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		21
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		19

OLE MISS				GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)						
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
74.8 (8)	82.6 (2)	65.4 (16)	60.7 (20)	63.1 (15)	52.5 (30)	44.2 (43)	42.5 (56)	42.3 (49)	47.2 (40)	57.5 (20)



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LSU

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#5

SEC

#12

OVERALL



LSU				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
14	(B) Kansas St	(CG) Georgia	ALABAMA	FLORIDA
13	ARKANSAS	TEXAS A&M	OLE MISS	ALABAMA
12	ALABAMA	Florida State	Florida State	TEXAS A&M
11	OLE MISS	(B) Purdue	(B) Wisconsin	USC
10	KENTUCKY	UAB	TEXAS A&M	(B) Baylor
9	AUBURN	ARKANSAS	GA State	OKLAHOMA
8	UCLA	ALABAMA	FLORIDA	VANDERBILT
7	TEXAS A&M	OLE MISS	Army	W. Kentucky
6	UL-Monroe	FLORIDA	AUBURN	ARKANSAS
5	FLORIDA	AUBURN	MISSOURI	S. CAROLINA
4	MISS ST	New Mexico	ARKANSAS	SE LA (FCS)
3	C. Michigan	MISS ST	MISS ST	FLORIDA
2	McNeese (FCS)	Southern (FCS)	Grambling (FCS)	LA Tech
1			Nicholls (FCS)	Clemson
2021		2022	2023	2024
ORGERON		BRIAN KELLY		

LSU				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
CLEMSON W 17-10	95	-1	77.9	
LA TECH W 23-7	211	-1	70.2	
FLORIDA W 20-10	-50	4	69.9	
SE LA (FCS) W 56-10	326	0	75.8	
OLE MISS L 19-24	-226	1	31.6	
S. CAROLINA W 20-10	103	-1	81.1	
VANDERBILT L 24-31	-74	0	35.2	
TEXAS A&M L 25-49	-148	2	17.7	
ALABAMA L 9-20	-112	-1	26.9	
ARKANSAS W 23-22	50	3	55.6	
W. KENTUCKY W 13-10	176	0	55.3	
OKLAHOMA L 13-17	-195	2	35.5	
(B) HOUSTON L 35-38	-93	-1	33.9	
OVERALL: 39th / 68 SEC: 11th / 16 51.3				

LSU		UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK	NATIONAL		
(of 16)	TOP 15		
QUARTERBACK	7		
RUNNING BACKS	7		
RECEIVERS & TE	4	8	
OFFENSIVE LINE	6		
DEFENSIVE LINE	4	10	
LINEBACKERS	7	12	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	6	12	

LSU		RANK	
Scoring Offense	22.8 ppg	103	
Points per Play	0.36	95	
Total Offense	334 ypg	111	
Yards per Play	5.3	100	
Rushing Offense	104 ypg	126	
Yards per Carry	3.6	114	
O-Line Run Push	3.6	130	
Explosive Rush	5.2	74	
Passing Offense	230 ypg	63	
Yards / Attempt	6.7	93	
QB Rating	134	69	
TD / INT Ratio	2.9	35	
Sacks / Attempt	7%	83	
Explosive Pass	4.6	129	
Return. Production	61%	43	
Returning Snaps	14,752	15	
23.5 SECONDS/PLAY #5 of 68 P4			
KIFFIN (2025 OLE MISS) FAST			

It started with a fake Southern accent and ended four years later with a five-minute, midseason, farewell meeting. Brian Kelly never fit the LSU job.

His first team made the SEC title game and then Jayden Daniels won the Heisman in 2023, but the two sides of the ball couldn't match up. First, the roster was too young, then the defense collapsed so he hired Blake Baker, then the offense collapsed.

2025 was set to be the big payoff season and after wins over #4 Clemson and Florida, LSU surged to #3 in the AP. The offense broke down and they lost to Ole Miss (-230 yardage margin), then again to Vanderbilt as they settled for four field goals in a seven-point decision. The loss to Texas A&M, with a 35-7 second half blowout, was the final straw.

"Our fan base should be upset, that second half was unacceptable on any level," said Kelly. He was fired the next day.

The team went 2-3 with interim Frank Wilson but the focus quickly shifted towards the coaching carousel and LSU's spot in the Lane Kiffin Sweepstakes. In a controversial split, Ole Miss did not allow Kiffin to coach his team through the postseason, but that gave The Portal King more time to start building the foundation here in Baton Rouge.

Kiffin did it again. After several Top 3 transfer hauls at Ole Miss, Kiffin led LSU to the #1 overall transfer class this cycle complete with an insane 17 four/five-stars – the next closest had 12. LSU signed the best from each of the sport's most important positions: #1 quarterback, #1 offensive tackle, #1 edge rusher.

In total, the transfer class featured 11 starters off Power 4 teams, three more were all-conference at the Non-AQ level, and 10 were former Top200 recruits. Speaking of recruiting, LSU signed another 11 blue-chippers in the 2026 high school class and on a per-player average they ranked #8 nationally.

OFFENSE

Kiffin has had sustained success at building elite, explosive, high-scoring offenses. He uses tempo and wide spacing to create personnel mismatches. And every so often they'll hit a wide-open vertical shot downfield.

All six of his Ole Miss offenses finished in the Top 20 of my opponent-adjusted metric, joining Ohio State, Oregon, and Louisville as the only other programs to go six for six over that span. Charlie Weis took over as the full coordinator in 2024 and his two surged up to #3 and #7.

Kiffin brought Weis with him to LSU and these two offensive masterminds assembled an all-time transfer haul this cycle.

Sam Leavitt was ranked the #1 transfer quarterback after leading Arizona State on their surprise Big 12 title run in 2024. Leavitt used his legs even more in 2025 and willed ASU to some victories before suffering a season-ending foot injury. He ranked fourth in the Big 12 in QB Rating in 2024 with 24 touchdowns and just six picks, but fell to 13th in QB Rating last year. Leavitt also missed spring ball due to injury rehab, though last year Kiffin and Weis got Trinidad Chambliss up to speed without spring.

LSU signed 2025 five-star Husan Longstreet (USC) as a potential quarterback of the future here, or a blue-chip insurance policy if Leavitt's injury returns.

Caden Durham and Harlem Berry split carries last year and both return. Berry was a five-star and the #1 running back of the 2025 recruiting class and surged to the top spot here in spring. Dilin Jones joins the rotation after splitting carries at Wisconsin last year.

The receiver room is a total roster transfusion: 10 guys out, 10 guys in. As usual, Kiffin added an insane amount of firepower on the outsides. Jayce Brown (Kansas State) was All-Big 12 last year, Eugene Wilson (Florida) is a multi-year SEC starter, and Winston Watkins (Ole Miss) actually took

LSU		OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	53	11	1	16	41	51	1	42	20	4	8th
F	SLOAN	DENBROCK	PEETZ	ENSMINGER	CANADA	CAMERON					
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
D	BAKER	HOUSE	JONES	PELINI	ARANDA						
E	13	44	56	8	37	66	10	5	16	2	19th
F											

LSU		RANK	
Scoring Defense	19.8 ppg	23	
Points per Play	0.3	23	
Total Defense	329 ypg	27	
Yards per Play	5.0	32	
3rd Down Conv%	34%	26	
Rushing Defense	124 ypg	32	
Yards per Carry	3.7	39	
Negative Play %	8%	76	
Explosive Rush	6.4	65	
Passing Defense	205 ypg	42	
Yards / Attempt	6.4	27	
QB Rating	117	24	
Completion %	59.7%	39	
Explosive Pass	4.7	27	
Return. Production	60%	35	
Returning Snaps	13,241	24	

LSU		RANK / 68
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play		
Offense Overall		53
Rushing Offense	(0.4)	52
Passing Offense	3.8	41
Defense Overall		13
Rushing Defense	1.0	17
Passing Defense	22.4	12

staff signed TJ Dottery (Ole Miss) who Pete Golding called his “quarterback of the defense” last year. This looks like a three-man rotation for the two spots of the 4-2-5.

Kiffin brought All-SEC edge rusher Princewill Umanmielen from Ole Miss. He led with nine sacks last year and was rated the #1 defender in this portal cycle. Jordan Ross (Tennessee) has less experience but was a five-star in the 2024 class, and then LSU signed the nation’s #1 edge recruit this class Lamar Brown (Erwinville, LA). Yes, that’s a triple five-star edge rush trio.

Five-star Dominick McKinley is back at tackle and now moves into the starting lineup along with Auburn starter Malik Blocton. Stephiylan Green was a four-star transfer, plus they signed the two of the top four 2026 interior linemen: five-star Richard Anderson (Edna Karr HS, LA) and Top100 Deuce Geraldts (Suwanee, GA).

OUTLOOK

Transition season or not, this is viewed as a Playoff or Bust roster.

Kiffin has a proven track record building elite offenses, and no one has succeeded more with the transfer portal. The nation’s #1 transfer haul instantly moves LSU up from the SEC’s mid-tier to the crowded Playoff tier. LSU is my pick for #5 in the league, but with the added ninth conference game I do not see a repeat of 2025 when the SEC landed five Playoff bids (four of the seven at-large spots).

LSU		RANK / 68
All-Time Wins	859	12
All-Time Win %	0.654	13
Wins (Last 100)	727	12
Wins (Last 50)	403	15
Wins (Last 25)	241	6
Wins (Last 10)	89	10
Wins (Last 5)	42	18
Game Grader (10 yr)	63.8	12
Game Grader (5 yr)	58.8	21
Game Grader (3 yr)	61.3	21
Draft Picks s' 2000	168	4
Draft Picks s' 2010	119	4
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		47
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		52

over the top spot in spring with his scheme familiarity and four-star potential. Two more earned all-league honors at the non-AQ level: Jackson Harris (Hawaii) and Tre’ Brown (Old Dominion). All five guys were rated as four-star transfers making this the top portal unit in the country. It’s also worth noting that Jayce Brown, Harris, and Tre’ Brown all ranked in their league’s top three in yards/catch – a much-needed boost to LSU’s poor pass explosiveness last year (#124). 2026 signee Corey Barber is another near-five star.

Their best pass-catcher is actually at tight end with athletic freak Trey’Dez Green returning after an All-SEC campaign. The 6’7 Green is a mismatch nightmare who will thrive in this offense.

LSU signed the nation’s top transfer lineman in five-star, All-Big 12 Jordan Seaton (Colorado) who is an instant starter at left tackle. Aliou Bah (Maryland) started 24 straight games in the Big Ten and did not allow a single sack last year. The staff convinced center Braelin Moore to delay his NFL bid, Bo Bordelon rose to a starting guard spot this spring, and Top100 Weston Davis held his spot at tackle despite some freshman growing pains last year. Devin Harper (Ole Miss) and Sean Thompkins (Baylor) are both excellent additions who could push in fall camp.

DEFENSE

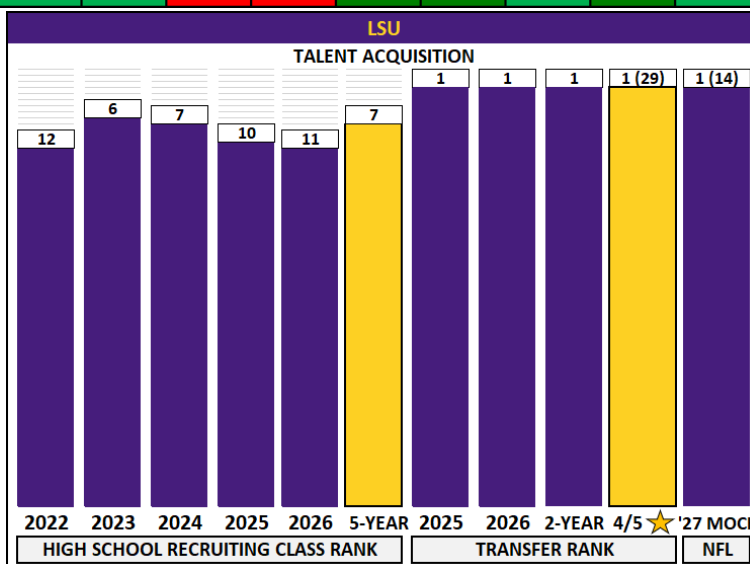
This side of the ball was the team strength -- #13 in opponent-adjusted defense – so Kiffin kept ace coordinator Blake Baker.

LSU returns five starters from the back seven, and then added four starters off other SEC defenses. All-SEC defensive backs AJ Haulcy and Mansoor Delane were drafted in April, but safeties Tamarcus Cooley and Dashawn Spears return along with the corner duo of DJ Pickett and PJ Woodland. Five-star Pickett had a breakout true freshman season and could earn All-SEC hype. The staff added a pair of four-star transfers with first-team All-Mountain West Ty Benefield (Boise State) and 2025 Top50 Faheem Delane (Ohio State).

Do-it-all Harold Perkins went pro, but Whit Weeks and Davhon Keys are back at linebacker. Keys led the team in tackles, Weeks was injured and is looking for a bounce-back season, and then the

LSU	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	CLEMSON
S. 12	LA TECH
S. 19	@ Ole Miss
S. 26	TEXAS A&M
O. 3	McNEESE (FCS)
O. 10	@ Kentucky
O. 17	MISS. STATE
O. 24	@ Auburn
O. 31	--- BYE ---
N. 7	ALABAMA
N. 14	TEXAS
N. 21	@ Tennessee
N. 28	@ Arkansas

LSU				GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)						
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
51.3 (39)	63.4 (17)	69.3 (15)	64.6 (17)	45.2 (46)	43 (43)	97.6 (2)	69.2 (8)	61.4 (20)	73.3 (8)	63.8 (12)





TEXAS A&M

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#6

SEC

#13

OVERALL



TEXAS A&M				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13				
12	LSU	AUBURN	(B) OK State	(B) USC
11	OLE MISS	FLORIDA	LSU	TEXAS
10	MISS ST	OLE MISS	OLE MISS	AUBURN
9	ARKANSAS	S. CAROLINA	TENNESSEE	S. CAROLINA
8	PV A&M (FCS)	ALABAMA	Alabama	Notre Dame
7	AUBURN	MISS ST	Miami FL	New Mexico St
6	S. CAROLINA	App State	Abilene (FCS)	LSU
5	MISSOURI	LSU	MISS ST	MISSOURI
4	ALABAMA	UMass	S. CAROLINA	MISSOURI
3	New Mexico	ARKANSAS	ARKANSAS	ARKANSAS
2	Colorado	Miami	AUBURN	Bowling Green
1	Kent St	Sam H. St (FCS)	UL-Monroe	FLORIDA
			New Mexico	McNeese (FCS)
	2021	2022	2023	2024
	JIMBO FISHER		MIKE ELKO	

TEXAS A&M				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
UTSA	W 42-24	26	0	67.9
UTAH ST	W 44-22	304	0	80.2
NOTRE DAME	W 41-40	59	0	70.9
AUBURN	W 16-10	237	-1	86.0
MISS. ST	W 31-9	260	1	86.1
FLORIDA	W 34-17	98	1	87.7
ARKANSAS	W 45-42	-30	0	44.7
LSU	W 49-25	148	-2	101.3
MISSOURI	W 38-17	180	1	106.1
S. CAROLINA	W 31-30	115	-3	65.3
Samford (FCS)	W 48-0	398	-2	75.8
TEXAS	L 17-27	-60	-2	31.1
(P) MIAMI	L 3-10	48	-2	47.4
OVERALL: 9th / 68 SEC: 3rd / 16 73.1				

TEXAS A&M	UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK	NATIONAL	
(of 16)	TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	4	12
RUNNING BACKS	10	
RECEIVERS & TE	2	4
OFFENSIVE LINE	7	
DEFENSIVE LINE	6	14
LINEBACKERS	12	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	4	6

TEXAS A&M	RANK	
Scoring Offense	33.8 ppg	19
Points per Play	0.48	27
Total Offense	445 ypg	23
Yards per Play	6.4	21
Rushing Offense	185 ypg	30
Yards per Carry	4.8	32
O-Line Run Push	4.5	30
Explosive Rush	6.0	42
Passing Offense	260 ypg	32
Yards / Attempt	8.3	22
QB Rating	144	40
TD / INT Ratio	1.9	79
Sacks / Attempt	5%	29
Explosive Pass	8.1	31
Return. Production	67%	21
Returning Snaps	14,653	16
27.8 SECONDS/PLAY #52 of 68 P4		
WIGGINS (2025 TEXAS A&M)		

the rivalry to Kyle Field, but with a win-and-in scenario for their first SEC title game appearance, they came up short. Reed tossed two picks in the fourth quarter to end his Heisman bid and flip the game back to Texas.

Even with the loss, the resume was strong enough to host their first-ever Playoff game in College Station, but another late interception in the endzone finished off a defensive struggle: Miami 10, Texas A&M 3.

In his second season, Mike Elko got A&M its first Playoff bid, its best start in 30+ years, and now has some lessons learned from their 0-2 finish.

This time, A&M has a double coordinator switch, seven new starters on the lines of scrimmage, and must replace a school-record 10 NFL draft picks.

OFFENSE

Ace offensive coordinator Collin Klein took the head coaching job at his alma mater Kansas State, but Elko promoted from within to continue what worked here last season. He picked receivers coach

Holmon Wiggins who will be a first-time playcaller but has proven to be an elite receiver coach. Wiggins spent five years on Nick Saban's Alabama staff and coached *five* first-rounders and Heisman winner DeVonta Smith. Then here at Texas A&M he was pivotal in signing their two key transfers KC Concepcion and Mario Craver – two moves that undoubtedly changed their season outlook.

These two formed the only Power 4 pair of 900+ yard receivers and their elusiveness in the screen game helped Reed average 10+ yards/pass on throws behind the line of scrimmage. Concepcion was picked in the first round this April, but Craver returns in the slot as an All-SEC headliner. Ashton Bethel-Roman played his best ball down the stretch and averaged 20+ yards/catch over the final seven. The staff added Alabama starter Isaiah Horton who was ranked the #7 transfer receiver this cycle. The 6'4 Horton had eight touchdowns last year and is the solution to A&M's redzone issue. Terry Bussey is a former five-star, and Top100 Aaron Gregory was noted as the best freshman this spring.

Reed returns after placing in the SEC's top five in yards/attempt, touchdowns, and the all-encompassing QB Rating. On top of that he added 493 rushing yards and six more scores on the ground. The lasting memory for most will be the redzone interceptions in the two losses, but Reed was a legit Heisman contender into November and is one of the most proven leaders returning in the SEC.

It's a complete rebuild for the rest of the offense.

Last year A&M returned all five offensive linemen and they were a solid unit ranking in the Top 30 of both my OL Run Push and Pass Protection. But now four starters are gone. All four were drafted and three – Trey Zuhn, Chase Bisontis, and Ar'maj Reed-Adams – were All-SEC picks.

Mark Nabou is the lone returning starter at center, and the staff attacked the transfer portal to round out the 2026 starting five. They signed four starters off other SEC lines with 54 combined starts. Wilkin Formby (Alabama) and Tyree Adams (LSU) both earned four-star transfer grades and were Top200 blue-

TEXAS A&M										OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)	
O	9	32	33	45	39	22	38	9	36	16	21st
F	KLEIN		PETRINO		DICKEY		MAZZONE				
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
D	BATEMAN		DURKIN		ELKO		CHAVIS				
E	22	28	17	15	7	12	18	28	25	38	14th
F											

TEXAS A&M		RANK	
Scoring Defense	21 ppg	36	
Points per Play	0.35	46	
Total Defense	307 ypg	18	
Yards per Play	5.1	34	
3rd Down Conv%	23%	1	
Rushing Defense	131 ypg	40	
Yards per Carry	4.2	68	
Negative Play %	14%	3	
Explosive Rush	8.8	130	
Passing Defense	177 ypg	16	
Yards / Attempt	6	12	
QB Rating	120	31	
Completion %	56.2%	16	
Explosive Pass	5.4	56	
Return. Production	63%	18	
Returning Snaps	16,715	6	

TEXAS A&M		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		9	
Rushing Offense	0.9	15	
Passing Offense	19.0	17	
Defense Overall		22	
Rushing Defense	0.2	48	
Passing Defense	19.9	14	

next backer up in case Sanford's spring injury lingers.

The secondary is packed with returning talent and proven transfers. All three safeties are back – Dalton Brooks, Marcus Ratcliffe, and Bryce Anderson – with Big 12 honorable mention Tawfiq Byard (Colorado) added to the rotation. Will Lee went pro, but starting corner Dezz Ricks returns. Rickey Gibson (Tennessee) was originally an All-SEC candidate before a season-ending injury.

OUTLOOK

Normally a double coordinator switch, seven linemen lost, and a school-record outbound NFL Draft class would be enough to sink a program. But Texas A&M has been a consistent Top 10 recruiter and landed a Top 10 transfer haul to make this a "reload" instead of the expected "rebuild."

Last year on their 11-0 start, they faced seven of the bottom nine SEC teams. The schedule heats up in 2026 and they now draw five of the top eight. Texas A&M remains a Playoff contender but are projected a spot or two outside the bracket.

chippers before that. Coen Echols (LSU) surged up the depth chart to start eight games as a redshirt freshman, and Trovon Baugh (South Carolina) is a multi-year starter. A&M also has a pair of backup tackles who were highly-touted recruits in Robert Bourdon and 2025 five-star Lamont Rogers.

Le'Veon Moss was the original starting running back but after a midseason injury, Rueben Owens took over and finished with 639 yards (5.4 per carry). Owens is back and four-star Jamarion Morrow will be his number two.

The top three tight ends are gone with Nate Boerkircher and Amari Niblack graduated, and Theo Melin Ohrstrom off to SMU. Fifth-year vet Micah Riley was named a team captain and will be joined by All-AAC Houston Thomas (UTSA).

DEFENSE

Elko's 4-2-5 defense was as aggressive as ever last year. Texas A&M ranked #3 in Negative Play rate which tracks how frequently a defense disrupt plays at or behind the line of scrimmage. They were also #1 nationally on third down conversions (23%). But with that aggressive scheme, they were over-exposed to explosive plays especially long-yardage runs (#130).

It helped having a unanimous All-American coming off the edge. Cashius Howell was the SEC Defender of the Year, was second in the league in sacks with 11.5 and even became the first FBS player in a decade to record three sacks on three straight plays.

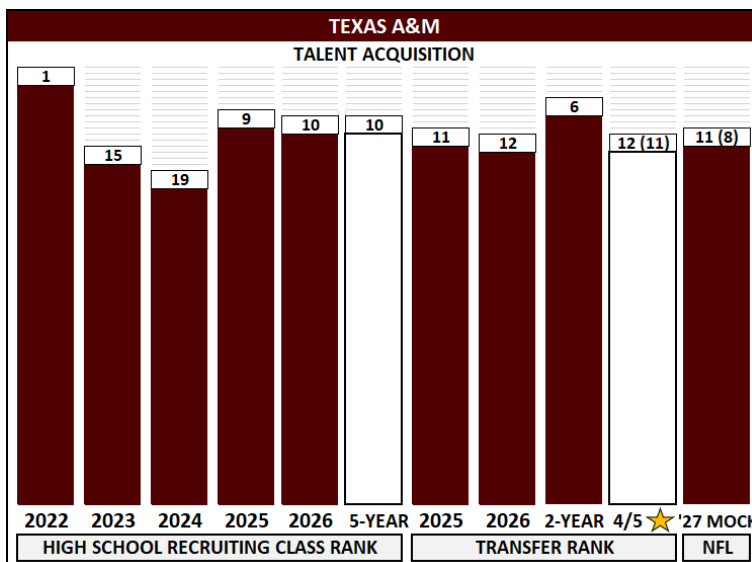
Howell, and tackles Albert Regis and Tyler Onyedim were all drafted, and the staff added some key transfers to help the reload. Anto Saka (Northwestern) was All-Big Ten and is drawing some legit first-round buzz as a physical pass rusher. Saka joins returning starting end TJ Searcy and Top200 Marco Jones. On the inside, five-star DJ Hicks moves up into a starting spot, CJ Mims (UNC) had a high 40 tackles last year, and Brandon Davis-Swain (Colorado) was a portal win.

Three-year starter and tackle-machine Taurean York and Scooby Williams both went pro, but Daymion Sanford returns as an excellent run stopper. The staff signed first-team All-AAC Ray Coney (Tulsa) who started the past three years and posted a league-best 128 tackles last year. Top100 Noah Mikhail is the

TEXAS A&M	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	MISSOURI ST
S. 12	ARIZONA ST
S. 19	KENTUCKY
S. 26	@ LSU
O. 3	ARKANSAS
O. 10	@ Missouri
O. 17	THE CITADEL (FCS)
O. 24	@ Alabama
O. 31	--- BYE ---
N. 7	@ South Carolina
N. 14	TENNESSEE
N. 21	@ Oklahoma
N. 27	TEXAS

TEXAS A&M		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	797	15	
All-Time Win %	0.605	19	
Wins (Last 100)	632	18	
Wins (Last 50)	392	17	
Wins (Last 25)	188	28	
Wins (Last 10)	80	17	
Wins (Last 5)	39	27	
Game Grader (10 yr)	59.1	15	
Game Grader (5 yr)	59.3	17	
Game Grader (3 yr)	64.1	12	
Draft Picks s' 2000	96	20	
Draft Picks s' 2010	64	17	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)	54		
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)	57		

TEXAS A&M		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
73.1 (9)	60.2 (23)	59.1 (23)	46 (48)	58.1 (25)	75.4 (6)	52.3 (29)	66.4 (16)	46.3 (43)	54.1 (28)	59.1 (15)	





TENNESSEE

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#7(TIE) #15

SEC

OVERALL



TENNESSEE				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13 (B) Purdue	S. CAROLINA	GEORGIA	(P) Ohio State	(B) Illinois
12 GEORGIA	GEORGIA	MISSOURI	GEORGIA	VANDERBILT
11 ALABAMA	(B) Clemson	ALABAMA	ARKANSAS	OKLAHOMA
10 OLE MISS	VANDERBILT	FLORIDA	VANDERBILT	ALABAMA
9 FLORIDA	MISSOURI	(B) Iowa	UTEP	GEORGIA
8 Pittsburgh	KENTUCKY	VANDERBILT	MISS ST	FLORIDA
7 VANDERBILT	UT-Martin (FCS)	UConn	KENTUCKY	NM State
6 S. Alabama	ALABAMA	KENTUCKY	ALABAMA	KENTUCKY
5 KENTUCKY	LSU	TEXAS A&M	FLORIDA	ARKANSAS
4 S. CAROLINA	FLORIDA	S. CAROLINA	OKLAHOMA	MISS ST
3 MISSOURI	Akron	UTSA	Kent State	UAB
2 TN Tech (FCS)	Pittsburgh	A. Peay (FCS)	NC State	ETSU (FCS)
1 Bowling Green	Ball State	Virginia	Chattanooga (FCS)	Syracuse
2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
JOSH HEUPEL				

Tennessee already had plenty of newcomers to their starting lineup heading into 2025. Then their five-star quarterback played contract hardball and left them after spring.

A transition season, plus the top drama/distraction of the entire offseason. That would normally be enough to sink any team but Josh Heupel still churned out another Top 10 offense and an eight-win season. Tennessee beat their unranked opponents, lost to four ranked teams but the 44-41 Georgia overtime loss and 33-27 Oklahoma loss were toss-ups.

Despite missing spring ball as a late transfer, Joey Aguilar picked up the offensive scheme and finished with the third-highest passing season in school history (3,565 yards). He led two late touchdown drives to beat Mississippi State, helped survive an Arkansas upset bid, and delivered Tennessee's first win in The Swamp since 2003.

One pass shifted the Alabama game and passed the cigars back to Tide fans. Aguilar's throw at the goal-line just before halftime would have made it a three-point game, but it was picked off and returned 100 yards the other way for a 14-point swing.

TENNESSEE				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
SYRACUSE W 45-26	116	1	67.3	
E. Tenn ST (FCS) W 72-17	501	-1	77.1	
GEORGIA L 41-44	-6	0	54.6	
UAB W 56-24	116	0	69.1	
MISS. ST W 41-34	88	-1	60.0	
ARKANSAS W 34-31	-11	3	50.0	
ALABAMA L 20-37	37	0	37.5	
KENTUCKY W 56-34	28	2	77.3	
OKLAHOMA L 27-33	105	-1	56.4	
NM STATE W 42-9	73	0	66.2	
FLORIDA W 31-11	191	0	95.9	
VANDERBILT L 24-45	-200	2	17.5	
(B) ILLINOIS L 28-30	-139	-1	39.7	
OVERALL: 24th / 68	SEC: 9th / 16		59.1	

The three losses to eventual Playoff teams held them back from a return bid themselves. But then the season-finale blowout loss by Vanderbilt – in Knoxville – shifted the season's legacy.

Sometimes progress isn't linear. After stacking years of improvement and punching their first Playoff ticket in 2024, 2025 was a roster transition and step backwards.

Heupel moved quickly and fired longtime defensive coordinator Tim Banks and then hired one of the best in the sport: Jim Knowles.

The youth and inexperience of 2025 pays dividends into 2026 with 14 starters back, plus the #4 recruiting class of 2026, a Top 25 transfer haul, and arguably the top coordinator hire of the entire cycle.

OFFENSE

Aguilar exceeded all expectations and finished second in the SEC in QB Rating behind only Heisman runner-up Diego Pavia. He lost an appeal for a bonus year of eligibility, so now the starting quarterback job is up for grabs in fall camp.

TENNESSEE	UNIT RANKS
SEC RANK (of 16)	NATIONAL TOP 15
QUARTERBACK	13
RUNNING BACKS	9
RECEIVERS & TE	7
OFFENSIVE LINE	2
DEFENSIVE LINE	9
LINEBACKERS	3
DEFENSIVE BACKS	8

6'6 George MacIntyre was a Top200 recruit (#13 QB) in 2025 and despite having the full extra year of practice within the Heupel scheme, he emerged from spring in a virtual tie with true freshman Faizon Brandon. The 6'4 Brandon was a five-star signee, the #3 QB and #10 overall recruit. Per practice reports, Brandon won the scrimmages, MacIntyre won the spring game, but Brandon flashed that five-star upside. After seeing how well Aguilar picked up the offense in just a few months, the inexperience of Brandon is less of a hurdle and I think he'll eventually win the job.

Eight of the other ten starters are back from an offense that averaged 40 points/game and finished #14 in my per-play, opponent-adjusted stat.

That includes four full-time starting offensive linemen in a total boomerang from last preseason when they had to find four new starters. As a new line, they still ranked in the Top 40 of both my OL Run Push and Pass Protection stats and now they return as veterans. David Sanders was the #1 lineman recruit and rounded into form down the stretch as a true freshman. Sanders has All-SEC potential even as a true sophomore this fall. Wendell Moe graded out well at guard, and center Sam Pendleton and guard Jesse Perry both started all year. The lone departure was Lance Heard who was third-team All-SEC but surprised and left for Kentucky. Tennessee added two Power 4 linemen to compete for that vacancy: former four-star Ory Williams (LSU) and Donovan Haslam (West Virginia).

DeSean Bishop emerged from a crowded rotation to lead with 1,076 yards and 16 scores. The former walk-on was a high school legend at Karns, TN and earned second-team All-SEC. The other two Peyton Lewis and Star Thomas are gone, so Bishop is projected to go over a thousand yards again.

Heupel doesn't rotate his receivers. The key to his offense is finding three legit receiving weapons, and making the defense "pick its poison" – you can't cover all three at once. Chris Brazzell, Braylon Staley, and Mike Matthews were the big three last year and they each had breakout games. Brazzell was the leader and went pro, but SEC Freshman of the Year Staley and Matthews are back after combining for

TENNESSEE	RANK
Scoring Offense 39.8 ppg	6
Points per Play 0.55	8
Total Offense 466 ypg	7
Yards per Play 6.5	20
Rushing Offense 173 ypg	51
Yards per Carry 4.6	51
O-Line Run Push 4.4	40
Explosive Rush 5.5	56
Passing Offense 293 ypg	6
Yards / Attempt 8.7	15
QB Rating 155	15
TD / INT Ratio 2.6	44
Sacks / Attempt 5%	39
Explosive Pass 7.3	49
Return. Production 58%	53
Returning Snaps 11,242	47
22.4 SECONDS/PLAY #4 of 68 P4	
HEUPEL (2025 TENNESSEE)	FAST

TENNESSEE					OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	14	35	12	2	4	53	30	55	65	10				
F														17th
F	HALZLE		GOLESH		CHANEY		HELTON	SCOTT	DeBORD					
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016				10-YEAR
D	BANKS					ANSLEY		SHERRER	SHOOP					
E	50	6	16	22	35	35	21	30	45	48				25th
F														

TENNESSEE		RANK	
Scoring Defense	28.8 ppg	92	
Points per Play	0.4	85	
Total Defense	397 ypg	92	
Yards per Play	5.6	67	
3rd Down Conv%	41%	88	
Rushing Defense	152 ypg	73	
Yards per Carry	4.1	61	
Negative Play %	9%	32	
Explosive Rush	6.7	75	
Passing Defense	245 ypg	113	
Yards / Attempt	7.2	75	
QB Rating	136	83	
Completion %	66%	117	
Explosive Pass	5.5	59	
Return. Production	65%	13	
Returning Snaps	15,498	7	

TENNESSEE		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		14	
Rushing Offense	0.3	25	
Passing Offense	18.0	19	
Defense Overall		50	
Rushing Defense	(0.0)	52	
Passing Defense	(1.4)	48	

absolutely packed.

Original starting corners Rickey Gibson and Jermod McCoy were knocked out with injuries but Colton Hood and true freshman Ty Redmond both stepped up to earn All-SEC honors. Redmond is back as a top corner, and the staff added Auburn starter Kayin Lee who earned a four-star transfer grade. Edrees Farooq returns at one safety spot, TJ Metcalf (Michigan) and Qua Moss (Kansas State) are both Power 4 starters, and DeJuan Lane followed the staff from Penn State.

Two starters are back on the line with tackle Daevin Hobbs and end Tyree Weathersby. Then Knowles brought a Penn State starter with him in four-star transfer Xavier Gilliam who was ranked the #7 transfer tackle.

OUTLOOK

Heupel's got another Top 25 team here, but to move up to the Playoff tier there are two major uncertainties for 2026. Jim Knowles is one of the best defensive minds in the sport, but his complex scheme usually takes a few seasons to start paying dividends. Second, the quarterback battle, where both guys are young and inexperienced – but super-talented – and Heupel has never had an issue getting his signal-callers up to speed.

1,650 yards and 10 scores. Heupel has three blue-chippers to choose from for the third spot: Radarious Jackson, Top100 Travis Smith, and five-star TK Keys (Hattiesburg, MS) who was ranked the #1 receiver in the entire 2026 class.

It's another top duo at tight end with a pair of former Top100's DaSaahn Brame and returning starter Ethan Davis.

Last offseason Heupel and offensive coordinator Joey Halzle tinkered with their scheme a bit. We saw less of their super-wide, sideline-to-sideline spread formations, and instead it was more bunched and way more throws over the middle of the field. They showed the ability to adapt and still churned out an elite passing attack. Heupel's got as good a track record as you'll find.

DEFENSE

Tennessee fell from the Top 10 to #50 of 68 Power 4 on defense. They regressed in all 17 of my stat categories but the 45-point, 582-yard collapse against Vanderbilt was the final straw.

Knowles is as proven as anybody and has built dominant defenses at Duke, Oklahoma State, and Ohio State. He's led six straight Top 40 defenses with three ranking in the Top 10. The 2021 Oklahoma State unit led the nation in sacks, while 2024 Ohio State led in several categories en route to a national title.

He runs a complex, 4-2-5 base scheme with three safeties that take away the quarterback's ability to make pre-snap reads and adjustments. Normally his scheme needs a full year or two to become elite, though this time around he brought several staffers from his 2025 Penn State defense with him and the install seems ahead-of-schedule. Per co-coordinator Anthony Poindexter: "we're light years ahead of a year ago."

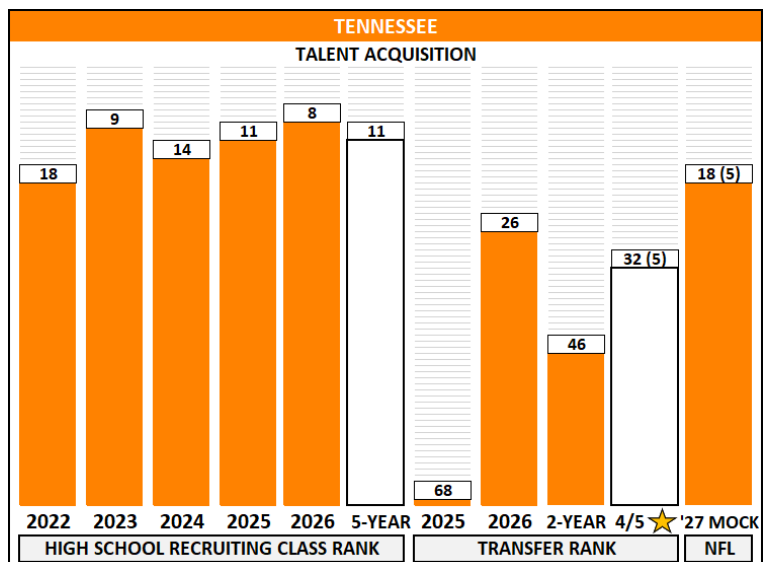
It also helps that Knowles brought Penn State starters with him, including his so-called "quarterback of the defense" middle backer Amare Campbell. In total, Tennessee returns six starters, added two Penn State starters, plus three more Power 4 starting defensive backs.

The linebacker room is stacked. All-SEC Arion Carter decided to forgo the early NFL bid and returned for a final season, Edwin Spillman led the team with 81 tackles and earned SEC All-Freshman, and Jeremiah Telander returns as a two-year starter. Throw in Campbell and this is

TENNESSEE	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	FURMAN (FCS)
S. 12	@ GA Tech
S. 19	KENNESAW ST
S. 26	TEXAS
O. 3	AUBURN
O. 10	@ Arkansas
O. 17	ALABAMA
O. 24	@ S. Carolina
O. 31	--- BYE ---
N. 7	KENTUCKY
N. 14	@ Texas A&M
N. 21	LSU
N. 28	@ Vanderbilt

TENNESSEE		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	883	11	
All-Time Win %	0.670	10	
Wins (Last 100)	753	9	
Wins (Last 50)	381	20	
Wins (Last 25)	175	37	
Wins (Last 10)	63	43	
Wins (Last 5)	45	13	
Game Grader (10 yr)	52.0	30	
Game Grader (5 yr)	64.0	10	
Game Grader (3 yr)	63.7	14	
Draft Picks s' 2000	105	15	
Draft Picks s' 2010	51	27	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		44	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		32	

TENNESSEE		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
59.1 (24)	67 (13)	65.1 (17)	76.8 (5)	52.2 (34)	34.9 (57)	48 (39)	34.2 (60)	27.5 (63)	55.4 (24)	52 (30)	





ALABAMA

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#7(TIE) #16

SEC

OVERALL



ALABAMA				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
15 (NC) Georgia				(P) Indiana
14 TEXAS A&M		(P) Michigan		(CG) Georgia
13 (P) Cincinnati		Texas		OKLAHOMA
12 (CG) GEORGIA	LSU	(CG) GEORGIA	OKLAHOMA	Florida St
11 AUBURN	(B) Kansas St	AUBURN	TENNESSEE	(P) Oklahoma
10 ARKANSAS	AUBURN	Chatt. (FCS)	VANDERBILT	AUBURN
9 NM State	A. Peay (FCS)	KENTUCKY	AUBURN	E Illinois (FCS)
8 LSU	OLE MISS	OLE MISS	Mercer (FCS)	LSU
7 TENNESSEE	MISS ST	TENNESSEE	LSU	S. CAROLINA
6 MISS ST	TEXAS A&M	ARKANSAS	MISSOURI	TENNESSEE
5 OLE MISS	ARKANSAS	TEXAS A&M	S. CAROLINA	MISSOURI
4 S. Miss	VANDERBILT	MISS ST	GEORGIA	VANDERBILT
3 FLORIDA	UL-Monroe	OLE MISS	Wisconsin	GEORGIA
2 Mercer (FCS)	Texas	USF	USF	Wisconsin
1 Miami	Utah State	Mid Tenn St	W. Kentucky	UL-Monroe
2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
NICK SABAN			KALEN DeBOER	

ALABAMA				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
FLORIDA ST L 17-31	-41	1	27.8	
UL-MONROE W 73-0	435	3	79.9	
WISCONSIN W 38-14	245	2	99.5	
GEORGIA W 24-21	40	1	76.2	
VANDERBILT W 30-14	153	1	104.2	
MISSOURI W 27-24	0	1	63.1	
TENNESSEE W 37-20	-37	0	80.7	
S. CAROLINA W 29-22	-8	0	66.4	
LSU W 20-9	112	1	87.7	
OKLAHOMA L 21-23	194	-3	75.9	
E. Illinois (FCS) W 56-0	505	-1	77.1	
AUBURN W 27-20	-131	2	58.4	
(CG) GEORGIA L 7-28	-88	-1	20.8	
(P) OKLAHOMA W 34-24	-102	1	68.3	
(P) INDIANA L 3-38	-214	-1	5.5	
OVERALL: 14th / 68	SEC: 6th / 16		66.1	

ALABAMA	UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK (of 16)	NATIONAL TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	9	
RUNNING BACKS	8	
RECEIVERS & TE	8	13
OFFENSIVE LINE	9	
DEFENSIVE LINE	8	
LINEBACKERS	10	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	3	5

ALABAMA	RANK	
Scoring Offense	29.5 ppg	49
Points per Play	0.45	44
Total Offense	368 ypg	84
Yards per Play	5.6	76
Rushing Offense	104 ypg	125
Yards per Carry	3.4	126
O-Line Run Push	3.8	118
Explosive Rush	3.6	123
Passing Offense	264 ypg	29
Yards / Attempt	7.6	50
QB Rating	147	32
TD / INT Ratio	6.4	4
Sacks / Attempt	6%	72
Explosive Pass	7.0	57
Return. Production	35%	119
Returning Snaps	7,543	89
27.7 SECONDS/PLAY #50 of 68 P4		
DeBOER (2025 ALABAMA)		

After a shocking loss at Florida State in the opener, Alabama refocused and rattled off eight straight wins to keep their playoff hopes alive.

They did so in historic fashion, too. First, Alabama went Between the Hedges and snapped Georgia's nation-best 33-game home win streak. Then the defense forced two key Diego Pavia turnovers in the 30-14 win. Alabama then snapped the second-longest home win streak at Missouri thanks to a fourth-and-goal touchdown pass from Ty Simpson to Daniel Hill. Cigar smoke returned to Bryant-Denny Stadium after Zabien Brown took back a 99-yard game-changing Pick Six to beat Tennessee.

Four straight weeks, four ranked opponents, four wins – the first in SEC history to do so.

The team's motto was "unbreakable" and in so many one-score, tight finishes they lived up to it.

Though they lost by two to Oklahoma, and lost the SEC title rematch with Georgia, Alabama's run of ranked wins was enough of a resume boost to earn an at-large bid in the Playoff.

They also got a revenge matchup in Norman, and this time Alabama was the one forcing the turnovers and leading a 17-point comeback. Brown struck again, this time with a 50-yard Pick Six, and Tim Keenan blocked a punt to spark the win.

A roller-coaster of a season with severe highs and lows hit the proverbial rock bottom in the Rose Bowl quarterfinal. Not only did Indiana win, but they physically dominated Alabama – a taste of their own medicine that Nick Saban dished out for the past 15 years. It was stunning.

The 38-3 final was Alabama's worst loss since 1998, and it leaves a confusing legacy for the 2025 team. The expectations for second-year Kalen DeBoer were "Playoff or Bust." He hit that goal, but the five-touchdown gap in the quarterfinal showed that there is still another tier to build towards.

Once again, Alabama signed an elite recruiting class and the current four classes on the roster were: #1, #2, #3, #3. However there are other key categories in the Talent Acquisition game – transfers and roster retention – and both were below Dynasty-Tier standards this cycle.

OFFENSE

Alabama fell to #14 in my overall ranking Game Grader, for their lowest finish since Saban's transition season back in 2007. It snapped their incredible 17-year streak of Top 10 teams.

The most critical issue was the line of scrimmage. Alabama simply was unable to run the ball. They mustered up just 104 yards/game which ranked #125 in FBS and was actually the lowest output in program history since they began keeping stats in 1946.

And that was with a line that featured two NFL draft picks, three All-SEC nominees, and five-stars packing the two-deep. The line was #118 in OL Run Push, and the per-carry average was even worse at #126.

The three top backs all averaged under four yards/carry and starter Jam Miller is off to the pros. Four Top100 backs will battle for carries with the veterans Daniel Hill and Kevin Riley joined by AK Dear and incoming five-star EJ Crowell (Jackson, AL) who ran for 300 yards in the state title game.

As for the offensive line? Four starters are gone and more reserves transferred out. The only starter returning is Michael Carroll, the nation's #1 lineman of the 2025 class, who earned SEC All-Freshman last year at guard. Former four-star William Sanders moves up into the other guard spot. The rest of the line will look completely new with transfers and young blue-chippers. At center, Racine Delgatty (Cal Poly) emerged as a starter in spring ball but is making the jump from the FCS to the SEC. Jayvin James (Mississippi State) is an experienced SEC starting tackle and Top100 redshirt freshman Jackson Lloyd was named the top left tackle early in spring. Two more Top100 2025 transfers pack the room: Nick Brooks (Texas) and Ty Haywood (Michigan).

Simpson passed for 3,567 yards, 28 touchdowns and just five picks, led all those close wins, and delivered the program's first Playoff win since 2021. He waited his time in Tuscaloosa and it paid off with a first-round selection. A quarterback battle between Austin Mack and Keelon Russell will extend into fall camp.

ALABAMA					OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)										
O	28	7	24	6	3	2	2	2	11	8	2nd				
F	GRUBB	SHERIDAN	REES	BILL O'BRIEN	STEVE SARKISIAN	MIKE LOCKSLEY GATTIS		DABOLL	KIFFIN						
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR				
D	KANE WOMMACK		STEELE	PETE GOLDING				JEREMY PRUITT							
E				CHARLES KELLY				TOSH LUPOI							
F	21	14	5	1	5	3	14	3	1	1	1st				

ALABAMA		RANK	
Scoring Defense	19.2 ppg	20	
Points per Play	0.32	34	
Total Defense	297 ypg	13	
Yards per Play	4.9	22	
3rd Down Conv%	37%	48	
Rushing Defense	127 ypg	37	
Yards per Carry	3.7	41	
Negative Play %	10%	28	
Explosive Rush	6.0	49	
Passing Defense	170 ypg	9	
Yards / Attempt	6.4	29	
QB Rating	124	43	
Completion %	62.1%	72	
Explosive Pass	4.4	13	
Return. Production	61%	32	
Returning Snaps	11,959	38	

ALABAMA		RANK / 68
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play		
Offense Overall		28
Rushing Offense	(0.5)	9
Passing Offense	24.1	56
Defense Overall		21
Rushing Defense	0.4	35
Passing Defense	9.3	26

Three-star Caleb Woodson (Virginia Tech) was an ACC starter and takes over one spot, while Cayden Jones and incoming five-star Xavier Griffin battle for the other one.

Former five-star Yhonzae Pierre emerged as a top pass rusher last year and returns at the outside backer, edge hybrid role. Qua Russaw left for Ohio State, but Alabama hopes to get back Jah-Marien Latham for a seventh season. Top100 Justin Hill got plenty of snaps here as a true freshman.

The secondary returns almost intact and is the clear strength of the 2026 team. Dijon Lee earned SEC All-Freshman and Mr. Pick Six Zabien Brown returns at the other corner. Both starting safeties are back with All-American Bray Hubbard and Keon Sabb. And then another round of five-stars pack the two-deep with an embarrassment of riches: Jorden Edmonds, Zavie Mincey, and Jireh Edwards.

OUTLOOK

It feels strange placing Alabama this low in the SEC projection. I launched *Pick Six Previews* in 2012 amidst the Saban dynasty, and no Alabama team has had this many preseason question-marks: the lines of scrimmage, school-worst run game, and star players transferring out.

Alabama placed #14 in Game Grader (#6 in SEC) last year due to *four* one-score survival wins, and the 2026 team looks like a downgrade in every position room aside from the elite secondary.

ALABAMA		RANK / 68
All-Time Wins	985	3
All-Time Win %	0.733	2
Wins (Last 100)	833	1
Wins (Last 50)	462	3
Wins (Last 25)	248	4
Wins (Last 10)	121	1
Wins (Last 5)	56	5
Game Grader (10 yr)	84.5	1
Game Grader (5 yr)	75.6	3
Game Grader (3 yr)	69.7	9
Draft Picks s' 2000	181	2
Draft Picks s' 2010	146	1
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		41
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		42

Mack has an additional year in this scheme having played for DeBoer and coordinator Ryan Grubb at Washington, and brings a 6'6 pocket passer frame. Five-star Keelon Russell was Alabama's highest-rated quarterback commit, has elite athleticism and makes highlight-reel throws off-schedule. With uncertainties along the line in front of them, look for Russell's elusive, scrambler skillset to eventually win him the job.

Leading receiver Germie Bernard went pro, touchdown-leader Isaiah Horton transferred out to Texas A&M, but Alabama returns a proven one-two punch with Ryan Williams and Lotzeir Brooks. They combined for 81 catches and 1,130 yards last year and were set to be joined by four-star transfer Noah Rogers (NC State) but a knee injury put his season in question. Instead, a pair of Top100 freshmen emerged at A-Day and both have 6'4 frames: Derek Meadows and Cederian Morgan.

Starting tight end Josh Cuevas was drafted and now three guys are rotating. Kaleb Edwards earned SEC All-Freshman last year, Marshall Pritchett is a threat in the pass game, and Josh Ford (Oklahoma State) was a Power 4 starter.

DEFENSE

Kane Wommack's defense ranked #21 in my opponent-adjusted rankings and made game-changing plays to earn the Playoff bid. However, the lasting memory was watching Indiana physically dominate and out-rush them by 200+ yards.

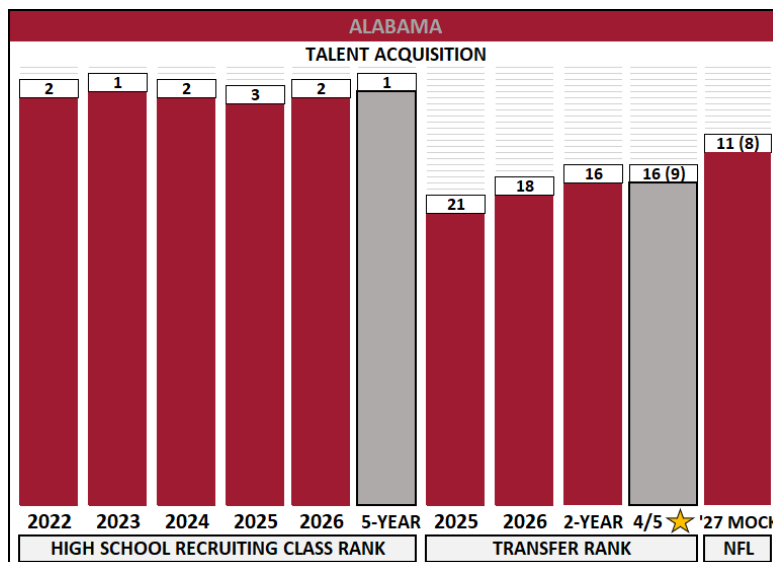
Fixing the run defense is the top priority, though they will have to do so with just one starter back in the front seven. All three defensive line starters are gone after LT Overton and Tim Keenan went pro and James Smith transferred out to Ohio State. Two more in the two-deep departed: Jordan Renaud (Ole Miss) and five-star Keon Keeley (Notre Dame).

The staff hit the portal and brought in USC starter Devan Thompkins and South Carolina's third end Desmond Umeozulu. At tackle, London Simmons is a rising star who earned SEC All-Freshman last year. Terrance Green (Oregon) earned four-star transfer grades, Edric Hill is a former Top200 prospect, and Jeremiah Beaman is back from injury.

Both starting inside backers Justin Jefferson and Deontae Lawson are gone, and so is their top backup.

ALABAMA	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	E. CAROLINA
S. 12	@ Kentucky
S. 19	FLORIDA STATE
S. 26	S. CAROLINA
O. 3	@ Miss. State
O. 10	GEORGIA
O. 17	@ Tennessee
O. 24	TEXAS A&M
O. 31	--- BYE ---
N. 7	@ LSU
N. 14	@ Vanderbilt
N. 21	CHATTANOOGA (FCS)
N. 28	AUBURN

ALABAMA		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
66.1 (14)	71.8 (9)	71.2 (10)	81.8 (4)	87 (2)	102.7 (1)	86.6 (4)	94.3 (2)	83.6 (4)	100.1 (1)	84.5 (1)	



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AUBURN

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#9

SEC

#26

OVERALL



AUBURN				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13	(B) Houston	(B) Maryland		
12	ALABAMA	ALABAMA	ALABAMA	ALABAMA
11	S. CAROLINA	MISS ST	NM State	VANDERBILT
10	MISS ST	ARKANSAS	OLE MISS	MISSOURI
9	TEXAS A&M	OLE MISS	LSU	GEORGIA
8	GEORGIA	GEORGIA	TEXAS A&M	MISSOURI
7	Penn State	LSU	ARKANSAS	TEXAS A&M
6	OLE MISS	Penn State	California	OKLAHOMA
5	ARKANSAS	W. Kentucky	TEXAS A&M	Mercer (FCS)
4	LSU	TEXAS A&M	UL-Monroe	ARKANSAS
3	GA State	MISSOURI	KENTUCKY	S. Alabama
2	AL State (FCS)	Samford (FCS)	New Mexico	Ball St
1	Akron	UMass	ALA&M (FCS)	Baylor
2021		2022	2023	2024
BRYAN HARSIN		HUGH FREEZE		

In 2013, Auburn pulled off their “Miracle at Jordan-Hare” and then the “Kick Six” within a three-week span. It’s almost as if they used up a decade’s worth of good fortune and are still paying off the debt.

Attempting to snap a five-year streak of losing seasons, the 2025 team appeared to be cursed.

Week after week they were on the short end of tight, one-score SEC losses. Oklahoma pulled off a controversial trick play and sacked Auburn nine times in a 24-17 finish. Auburn went 0/12 on third downs and lost by six at Texas A&M. Another controversial call at the goal-line ended up flipping the Georgia game, and then they lost in double-overtime to Missouri.

After that unlucky stretch, a 10-3 loss to Kentucky was the final straw for head coach Hugh Freeze who finished under .500 at 15-19 overall – 6-16 vs. the SEC – and was just the third Auburn coach in 75 years to post a losing record at Jordan-Hare.

It wasn’t just the losses. Freeze was picked as the offensive guru type hire, but his offense was still completely broken in his third year. And that was *with* a stockpile of five-star receivers and one of the SEC’s best offensive lines on paper.

The program is ready to put their 2025 campaign, and the six one-score losses, in the rear-view mirror and move forward with one of the sport’s most productive offensive coaches.

Auburn emerged from the most crowded coaching carousel in history with South Florida head coach Alex Golesh, and the offensive innovator is bringing most of his Top 5 offense with him.

OFFENSE

Many coaches call their offense “spread” but Golesh truly means it. He stretches the defense from sideline to sideline, with the receivers as wide as possible. He also operates at a hyper-fast tempo and his scheme has produced Top 5 offenses at UCF, Tennessee, and South Florida. The 2022 Tennessee offense led the entire nation with 46.1 points/game.

Alongside Josh Heupel and then again on his own at South Florida, Golesh has led offensive turnarounds at each stop. They certainly need a fix here, as Auburn hasn’t had a Top 25 offense since 2014.

“Quarterback play is so much about putting a system together that fits the quarterback,” said Golesh at his opening presser. No need to worry about system fit this year – he’s bringing his star with him.

Byrum Brown (USF) was the only quarterback in FBS to post 3,000 passing yards and 1,000 rushing yards. It’s such a rare feat that he became the 12th all-time. Auburn’s three starters Jackson Arnold, Ashton Daniels, and Deuce Knight all transferred out and Brown was ranked the #9 transfer quarterback after earning All-AAC honors last year.

In addition to Brown, Golesh brought five receivers, two offensive linemen, a tight end and a running back off his #5 ranked USF offense. The transition at receiver is most striking, as Auburn’s entire stockpile of five-star weapons all transferred out: Cam Coleman (Texas), Eric Singleton (Florida), Malcolm Simmons (Texas Tech), Horatio Fields (Ole Miss), and Perry Thompson (Minnesota).

Like a hockey line-change, Golesh reloaded the room with his USF starting rotation. Keshawn Singleton led USF in all stat categories, Jeremiah Koger was second and earned a four-star transfer grade, Christian Neptune impressed as a freshman, and Chas Nimrod is now the fastest player in the Auburn program. Those four combined for 149 catches, 2,275 yards, and 20 touchdowns last year, in this scheme, from this quarterback.

Tight end Jonathan Echols (USF) added three more scores and forms a solid duo with Power 4 veteran Jake Johnson (North Carolina).

AUBURN				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
BAYLOR	W 38-24	-68	0	55.2
BALL ST	W 42-3	427	0	76.9
S. ALABAMA	W 31-15	27	2	58.3
OKLAHOMA	L 17-24	-16	1	42.0
TEXAS A&M	L 10-16	-237	1	29.4
GEORGIA	L 10-20	-19	-1	38.9
MISSOURI	L 17-23	14	1	48.1
ARKANSAS	W 33-24	49	3	67.7
KENTUCKY	L 3-10	1	0	33.7
VANDERBILT	L 38-45	19	1	45.8
Mercer (FCS)	W 62-17	209	3	74.8
ALABAMA	L 20-27	131	-2	56.3
OVERALL: 38th / 68 SEC: 10th / 16 52.3				

AUBURN		UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK		NATIONAL	
(of 16)		TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	8		
RUNNING BACKS	6		
RECEIVERS & TE	13		
OFFENSIVE LINE	14		
DEFENSIVE LINE	10		
LINEBACKERS	4	9	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	9		

AUBURN		RANK	
Scoring Offense	26.8 ppg	74	
Points per Play	0.39	76	
Total Offense	374 ypg	79	
Yards per Play	5.5	82	
Rushing Offense	177 ypg	43	
Yards per Carry	4.7	41	
O-Line Run Push	4.8	14	
Explosive Rush	6.3	39	
Passing Offense	197 ypg	100	
Yards / Attempt	6.5	104	
QB Rating	124	98	
TD / INT Ratio	2.8	36	
Sacks / Attempt	12%	132	
Explosive Pass	4.8	127	
Return. Production	56%	62	
Returning Snaps	16,664	8	
21.4 SECONDS/PLAY	#1 of 68 P4		
GOLESH (2025 USF)	FAST		

AUBURN		OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	56	19	54	32	35	42	36	41	19	31	36th
F	NIX MONTGOM. KIESAU BOBO MORRIS DILLINGHAM LINDSEY LASHLEE										
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
D	DURKIN ROBERTS SCHMEDDING MASON STEELE										
E	17	19	35	24	24	37	4	19	3	12	9th
F											

AUBURN		RANK	
Scoring Defense	20.7 ppg	34	
Points per Play	0.31	30	
Total Defense	329 ypg	29	
Yards per Play	5.0	27	
3rd Down Conv%	35%	37	
Rushing Defense	99 ypg	10	
Yards per Carry	2.9	6	
Negative Play %	10%	18	
Explosive Rush	4.3	13	
Passing Defense	230 ypg	90	
Yards / Attempt	7.2	71	
QB Rating	131	59	
Completion %	62.5%	77	
Explosive Pass	5.3	53	
Return. Production	58%	41	
Returning Snaps	12,699	30	

AUBURN		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		56	
Rushing Offense	0.3	24	
Passing Offense	(12.4)	62	
Defense Overall		17	
Rushing Defense	1.7	4	
Passing Defense	6.1	29	

It's another complete rebuild in the trenches with all five starting offensive linemen gone. This unit was stacked on paper, and Connor Lew and Jeremiah Wright were drafted, but as a unit they collapsed in pass protection allowing a sack on 12% of attempts (#132). 17 new linemen joined the program this offseason and several spots are up for grabs heading into fall camp. Cole Best (USF) was All-AAC, Jo Simmons (James Madison) was All-Sun Belt, and tackle Stanton Ramil (Michigan State) was a Big Ten starter.

Finally a familiar face. Jeremiah Cobb is the lone returning starter on offense and earned third-team All-SEC after nearly hitting 1,000 yards. The staff packed the room with two starters who earned four-star transfer grades: Nykahi Davenport (USF) and the physical Bryson Washington (Baylor). Many overlook the run game in this up-tempo, spread scheme, but Golesh wants a downhill run game. USF ranked in the Top 20 in all rushing stat categories last year.

DEFENSE

Golesh retained defensive coordinator DJ Durkin, rewarding his work building a Top 20 defense per my opponent-adjusted rankings. They were #4 against the run, and as a unit they certainly held up their end of the bargain in SEC play but had no help from the offense.

Keeping Durkin here helped them retain five starters – none bigger than linebacker Xavier Atkins who becomes the first returning All-American defender here since Takeo Spikes in 1997. Atkins was also first-team SEC, a Bednarik semifinalist, and led the SEC with 17 tackles for loss. His co-star Robert Woodyard left for Missouri, but Elijah Melendez returns after earning SEC All-Freshman. Former Top100 Demarcus Riddick is back healthy after flashing as a true freshman in 2024.

The safety room is the next strongest position with returning starters Kaleb Harris and Eric Winters joined by two-year USF starter Fred Gaskin. AnQuon Fegans is another Top100 who could push for a starting role at nickelback.

Auburn lost their strong starting cornerback pair to the portal, as Jay Crawford (Ole Miss) and Kayin Lee (Tennessee) both went to other SEC programs. But Rayshawn Pleasant is back and he made the game-winning Pick Six in Auburn's only SEC win last year. Andre Jordan (UCLA) is projected at the other corner after earning All-Big Ten honors, while Top100 Blake Woodby is the third corner.

Like the offensive line, this side is a total rebuild as three were drafted and two more transferred out with high grades. Keldric Faulk and Keyron Crawford will especially be missed off the edges. The staff landed some four-star transfers of their own with tackles Cody Sigler (Arkansas State) and Walter Mathis (LSU) and end Da'Shawn Womack (Ole Miss) who got huge spring praise. Durkin was able to retain two of their prized 2025 signees with tackles Malik Autry and Jourdin Crawford both back. Dallas Walker is back at nose tackle and edge Chris Murray got a bonus year of eligibility.

OUTLOOK

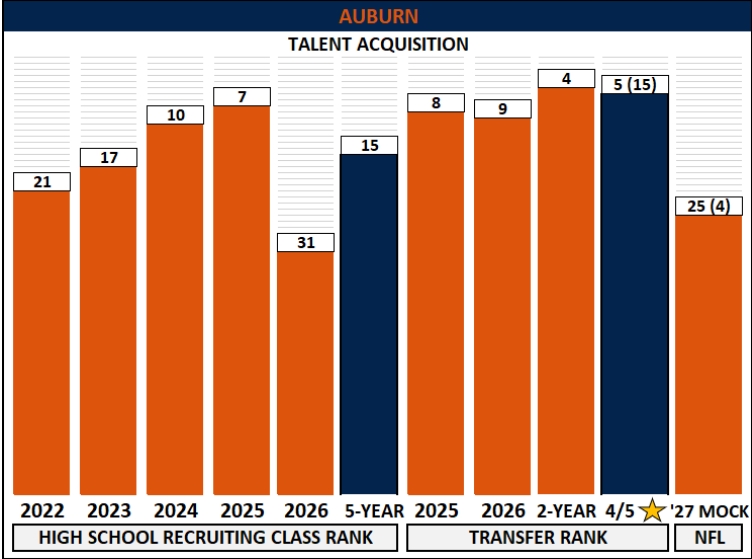
Auburn was better than their record showed the past two years – especially defensively. Golesh kept defensive coordinator Durkin, who was able to keep five starters off their Top 20 defense.

Then to fix the other side of the ball, Golesh swapped in ten players from his Top 5 USF offense including dynamic dual-threat Byrum Brown. Auburn should return to bowl season and may even post their first Top 25 offense in a decade.

AUBURN	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	*BAYLOR (ATL)
S. 12	SOUTHERN MISS
S. 19	FLORIDA
S. 26	VANDERBILT
O. 3	@ Tennessee
O. 10	--- BYE ---
O. 17	@ Georgia
O. 24	LSU
O. 31	@ Ole Miss
N. 7	ARKANSAS
N. 14	@ Miss. State
N. 21	SAMFORD (FCS)
N. 28	@ Alabama

AUBURN		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	809	14	
All-Time Win %	0.621	17	
Wins (Last 100)	662	16	
Wins (Last 50)	390	18	
Wins (Last 25)	199	21	
Wins (Last 10)	68	37	
Wins (Last 5)	27	59	
Game Grader (10 yr)	54.6	24	
Game Grader (5 yr)	47.3	44	
Game Grader (3 yr)	48.9	37	
Draft Picks s' 2000	98	19	
Draft Picks s' 2010	62	18	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		42	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		68	

AUBURN		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
52.3 (38)	51.2 (38)	43.2 (48)	39.1 (52)	50.9 (38)	52.4 (31)	64.3 (17)	55.4 (26)	77.3 (8)	60.4 (17)	54.6 (24)	



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MISSOURI

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#10(TIE) #27

SEC

OVERALL



MISSOURI				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13 (B) Army	(B) Wake	GEORGIA	S. CAROLINA	(B) Virginia
12 ARKANSAS	TENNESSEE	LSU	ALABAMA	OKLAHOMA
11 GEORGIA	KENTUCKY	(B) Ohio St	TEXAS A&M	TEXAS A&M
10 TEXAS A&M	FLORIDA	ARKANSAS	(B) Iowa	VANDERBILT
9 TENNESSEE	GEORGIA	FLORIDA	ARKANSAS	ALABAMA
8 BC	AUBURN	TENNESSEE	MISS ST	MISS ST
7 KENTUCKY	Kansas State	S. CAROLINA	OKLAHOMA	ARKANSAS
6 FLORIDA	ARKANSAS	KENTUCKY	AUBURN	AUBURN
5 S. CAROLINA	NM State	VANDERBILT	UMass	UMass
4 VANDERBILT	S. CAROLINA	Memphis	VANDERBILT	S. CAROLINA
3 North Texas	VANDERBILT	Kansas St	Boston Coll.	Louisiana
2 SE MO (FCS)	Abilene (FCS)	Mid Tenn St	Buffalo	Kansas
1 C. Michigan	LA Tech	S Dakota (FCS)	Murray St (FCS)	C. Ark (FCS)
2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
ELI DRINKWITZ				

MISSOURI				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
C. Ark (FCS) W 61-6	333	2	77.7	
KANSAS W 42-31	341	0	78.0	
LOUISIANA W 52-10	485	-1	85.2	
S. CAROLINA W 29-20	163	-1	84.5	
UMASS W 42-6	397	0	75.8	
ALABAMA L 24-27	0	-1	52.6	
AUBURN W 23-17	-14	-1	63.7	
VANDERBILT L 10-17	111	0	57.0	
TEXAS A&M L 17-38	-180	-1	14.3	
MISS. ST W 49-27	93	1	76.8	
OKLAHOMA L 6-17	25	-2	40.1	
ARKANSAS W 31-17	101	-1	71.1	
(B) VIRGINIA L 7-13	-48	0	39.0	
OVERALL: 21st / 68	SEC: 7th / 16		62.8	

MISSOURI	UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK	NATIONAL	
(of 16)	TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	11	
RUNNING BACKS	1	1
RECEIVERS & TE	10	
OFFENSIVE LINE	10	
DEFENSIVE LINE	13	
LINEBACKERS	8	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	10	

MISSOURI	RANK	
Scoring Offense 30.2 ppg	44	
Points per Play 0.43	51	
Total Offense 416 ypg	32	
Yards per Play 5.9	46	
Rushing Offense 228 ypg	8	
Yards per Carry 5.3	14	
O-Line Run Push 4.7	22	
Explosive Rush 7.6	10	
Passing Offense 188 ypg	104	
Yards / Attempt 6.8	87	
QB Rating 128	84	
TD / INT Ratio 1.4	100	
Sacks / Attempt 8%	103	
Explosive Pass 5.1	123	
Return. Production 59%	51	
Returning Snaps 15,832	12	
26.3 SECONDS/PLAY #32 of 68 P4		
DRINKWITZ (2025 MISSOURI)		

"Good, not great" was how head coach Eli Drinkwitz summed up the 2025 season. Simple, but accurate.

Missouri's eight wins came against teams that finished with losing records. Against winning teams, they went 0-5. It was the same split based off their opponent's ranking – 0-5 vs. ranked, 8-0 vs. unranked.

Good, not great. It's an extension of Drinkwitz's six-year career here with a 26-24 record against the SEC, but a league-worst 0-16 mark against SEC teams that finished with winning league records.

Even with the struggles against the elite tier, Drinkwitz has certainly raised the floor of the program as they notched three-straight eight-win seasons for the first time since 2009-11.

Missouri beat Kansas 42-31 in the first "Border War" played in over a decade, Beau Pribula led a fourth-quarter win over South Carolina, then an overtime win over Auburn. Ahmad Hardy was the engine of the offense and won the Power 4 rushing title with 1,649 yards.

Corey Batoon's defense reloaded and posted a Top 10 finish in my opponent-adjusted ranking, as well as top ten marks in several other national stat categories.

But ultimately their lack of a serious passing threat was a limitation against their ranked opponents. Missouri ranked #131 (third-worst in Power 4) in QB Rating against teams with winning records.

Missouri heads into 2026 focused on rebuilding their passing attack – with a new quarterback, coordinator, and quarterbacks coach – and reloading nearly the entire starting lineup.

OFFENSE

Only four starters return to the entire team, but their best one returns in the backfield. Hardy earned consensus All-America honors after posting a school-record rushing season. He pinballed off tacklers all season and actually rushed for over 1,000 yards after contact.

His running mate Jamal Roberts also returns to form one of the best running back pairs in America. Last year Hardy (1,649) and Roberts (753) were one of just four Power 4 duos to run for 750+ yards joining Indiana, Michigan, and Texas Tech.

Missouri went run-heavy last year, especially when Pribula missed time with injuries. It wasn't just quantity, but quality on a per-play basis. Missouri had the biggest difference in passing/rushing rankings per my opponent-adjusted stats: #8 Rushing, #65 Passing of 68 Power 4.

Kirby Moore left to become the head coach at Washington State, and Drinkwitz hired journeyman Chip Lindsey to take over the offense. This will be Lindsey's eighth school in the past 12 seasons and his stat impact has been mixed. The most recent two stops – UNC and Michigan – produced below average passing offenses despite featuring Drake Maye and #1 overall recruit Bryce Underwood.

Drinkwitz also hired Garrett Riley who helped lead TCU to the national title game in 2022, but also underwhelmed the past few seasons at Clemson.

Pribula added a dynamic layer to the run game, broke Chase Daniel's school record with 21 straight completions, but also struggled with turnovers. Pribula transferred out to Virginia, backup Matt Zollers returned after starting a few games as a freshman (53% completion, 4 touchdowns, 2 picks), but their announced starter is incoming transfer Austin Simmons (Ole Miss). The lefty was the original starter for the first two games (60%, 4 TD, 5 INT) before being unseated by DII phenom Trinidad Chambliss. Simmons has a strong arm, enough mobility to create plays, and earned a four-star transfer grade as the #10 quarterback this cycle.

Missouri lost three of their top four receivers when Kevin Coleman went pro and Marquis Johnson and Joshua Manning left for other Power 4 programs. Donovan Olugbode was a Top100 super-recruit and played like it right away, posting 30 catches for 401 yards as a true freshman. The staff signed two other starters from the portal, with four-star transfer Cayden Lee (Ole Miss) and Caleb Goodie (Cincinnati). Lee will start in the slot, has experience with Simmons at Ole Miss, and put up 106 catches for 1,623 yards in his three seasons there. Goodie is a vertical threat on the outside, and speedy four-star Shaun Terry is next in the rotation.

MISSOURI										
OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)										
O	33	44	17	54	43	50	58	19	10	24
F	MOORE		DRINKWITZ*		DOOLEY		HEUPEL		34th	
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
D	BATOON		BAKER		WILKS		WALTERS		10-YEAR	
E	8	46	14	10	59	43	30	27	44	57
F									31st	

MISSOURI		RANK	
Scoring Defense	18.9 ppg	17	
Points per Play	0.31	25	
Total Defense	277 ypg	8	
Yards per Play	4.5	8	
3rd Down Conv%	36%	42	
Rushing Defense	104 ypg	13	
Yards per Carry	3.2	14	
Negative Play %	11%	9	
Explosive Rush	4.5	15	
Passing Defense	174 ypg	11	
Yards / Attempt	5.9	8	
QB Rating	116	23	
Completion %	56.7%	19	
Explosive Pass	4.6	20	
Return. Production	40%	107	
Returning Snaps	7,195	93	

MISSOURI		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		33	
Rushing Offense	1.2	8	
Passing Offense	(18.0)	65	
Defense Overall		8	
Rushing Defense	1.3	10	
Passing Defense	19.4	16	

Trotter, the staff signed an All-SEC backer in Robert Woodyard (Auburn). They have recruited this position well and have three former four-stars loaded in the two-deep: Dante McClellan, Jeremiah Beasley, and Brian Huff.

All five starters are gone from the secondary with four graduations plus a transfer shocker by Marvin Burks (Wisconsin). Batoon has plenty of former blue-chippers to pick from in this reload. At corner, Chris Graves (Ole Miss) started nine games last year for the Rebels, Jahlil Florence (Oregon) is a former Top200 and Sione Laulea (Oregon) was the #1 JUCO corner back in 2024. Santana Banner got partial starter reps at safety, Trajen Greco and Kensley Louidor-Faustin (Auburn) are both former Top200 recruits. Elijah Dotson (Michigan) is another Top100 guy who earned a four-star transfer grade and is projected at the "star" position.

OUTLOOK

Drinkwitz has elevated the recruiting profile and the program's floor, but there is too much change to call for 2026 to be their breakthrough season. It's a full rebuild on defense with all 11 starters gone.

Their power run game is enough to get them back to bowl season, but Drinkwitz is still 0-16 against teams with SEC winning records and they draw five of the top six this fall.

Brett Norfleet returns for a fourth season as the starting tight end.

The offensive line made a major improvement in my OL Run Push stat boosting all the way up to #22, but pass protection fell to #103 though some of that blame was shared by the inexperienced quarterbacks. Keagen Trost and Cayden Green earned All-SEC honors, but Trost and 48-game starting center Connor Tollison are gone. Three starters are back, with Green as the anchor at left tackle, and Curtis Peagler and Dom Giudice on the interior. Tristan Wilson is next in line at center, Logan Reichert is a former four-star, and Johnnie Jones was a Top100 signee this class. The staff signed three Power 4 starters from the portal in Josh Atkins (Arizona State), and a pair from Mississippi State: Luke Work and Zach Owens. All were graded as three-star transfers.

DEFENSE

Batoon has done an excellent job continuing the success of Blake Baker and the 2025 unit was their best yet at #8 in my opponent-adjusted stat.

2026 will be his toughest test yet as all 11 starters are gone.

That includes three elite stars from the front seven. Defensive end Damon Wilson transferred out to Miami as a Top 10 overall transfer, end Zion Young and linebacker Josiah Trotter went pro, and that's a trio of All-SEC talent gone.

Young and Wilson were both in the SEC's top three of QB Pressures, and departing starting tackles Chris McClellan and Sterling Webb combined for 68 tackles, 11.5 for loss, and 8 sacks. Missouri also lost their prized Top50 2025 recruit Javion Hilson who left for Virginia Tech.

Darris Smith returns at end and for a third rusher he posted a productive 5.5 tackles for loss and four sacks. Former DII Langden Kitchen, Top200 Daeden Hopkins, and four-star transfer Kamaurn Morgan (Baylor) round out the two-deep. In the middle, Jalen Marshall and Marquis Gracial rise to the starting spots.

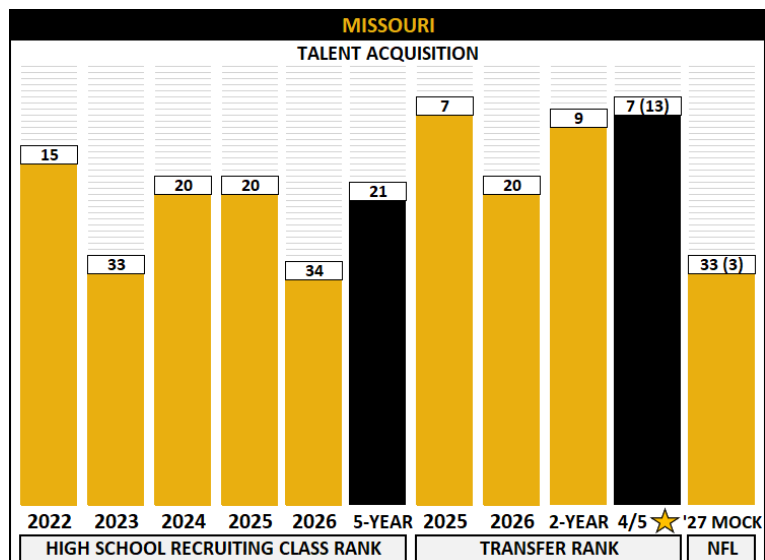
Three of the four-man linebacker rotation are gone. Nicholas Rodriguez is the lone returner and he started a few games in 2025. To replace the impact of

MISSOURI	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 3	ARK-PB (FCS)
S. 11	@ Kansas
S. 19	TROY
S. 26	@ Miss. State
O. 3	FLORIDA
O. 10	TEXAS A&M
O. 17	@ Ole Miss
O. 24	--- BYE ---
O. 31	@ Arkansas
N. 7	TEXAS
N. 14	@ Georgia
N. 21	KENTUCKY
N. 28	OKLAHOMA

MISSOURI		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	732	30	
All-Time Win %	0.550	42	
Wins (Last 100)	572	36	
Wins (Last 50)	306	44	
Wins (Last 25)	189	27	
Wins (Last 10)	71	32	
Wins (Last 5)	41	23	
Game Grader (10 yr)	52.3	29	
Game Grader (5 yr)	55.6	24	
Game Grader (3 yr)	64.6	11	
Draft Picks s' 2000	67	36	
Draft Picks s' 2010	49	30	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		18	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		28	



MISSOURI		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
62.8 (21)	58.2 (27)	72.8 (9)	48 (45)	36.2 (58)	42.6 (44)	49.9 (34)	65 (17)	50.1 (35)	37.9 (53)	52.3 (29)	





SOUTH CAROLINA #10_(TIE) #28

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SEC

OVERALL



SOUTH CAROLINA 5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13	Clemson	(B) Notre Dame	Clemson	(B) Illinois
12	MISSOURI	FLORIDA	TEXAS A&M	ALABAMA
11	TEXAS A&M	MISSOURI	MISSOURI	OLE MISS
10	TENNESSEE	GEORGIA	FLORIDA	LSU
9	KENTUCKY	ARKANSAS	TENNESSEE	Clemson
8	GEORGIA	Clemson	GEORGIA	Wofford (FCS)
7	(B) UNC	TENNESSEE	UNC	MISSOURI
6	AUBURN	VANDERBILT	VANDERBILT	VANDERBILT
5	FLORIDA	TEXAS A&M	TEXAS A&M	OKLAHOMA
4	VANDERBILT	KENTUCKY	OKLAHOMA	C. Carolina
3	Troy	SC State (FCS)	Jax State	KENTUCKY
2	E. Carolina	Charlotte	MISS ST	SC State (FCS)
1	E. Illinois (FCS)	GA State	Furman (FCS)	VA Tech
2021 2022 2023 2024 2025				
SHANE BEAMER				

South Carolina has had worse seasons on paper than their 2025 4-8 campaign. But paired with their all-time high preseason expectations, AP Top 15 ranking, and Playoff hype... this was certainly their most *disappointing* season ever.

It started with old-fashion "Beamer Ball" with Vicari Swain returning three punts for touchdowns over the first two games, including an 80-yarder against Virginia Tech to help Shane Beamer beat the program where his dad became a legend.

Beamer's special teams didn't get enough help from the offense and the offensive line rated as a bottom five unit in sacks allowed and tackles-for-loss. South Carolina got blown out by Vanderbilt to end their 16-game series streak, lost close decisions to Missouri and LSU, and blew a lead in the final two minutes against Alabama.

A lost season had one last glimmer of hope as South Carolina surged to a 30-3 lead at #3 Texas A&M. Beamer said "we're not surprised, we beat this team by 24 points last year" before celebrating towards the South Carolina section as he ran into the tunnel. A&M responded with

a 28-0 second half. Since 2004, teams were 286-0 in SEC play when leading by 27+ points, but South Carolina made it 286-1.

The loss to Clemson's worst team in over a decade was one last sting.

This completes a three-year boomerang for South Carolina: #54 of 68 Power 4 in Game Grader, then up to #12 in 2024, and then back down to #44 for the third-largest year-over-year decline.

Beamer made quick work this offseason. He fired his offensive line coach in October, fired offensive coordinator Mike Shula in November, then hired a proven offensive mind in Kendal Briles to take over the unit. South Carolina lost six starters to the transfer portal, but they punched back by signing six Power 4 starters of their own in their #19 ranked class.

Most importantly, they retained dual-threat phenom quarterback LaNorris Sellers, and beefed up their offensive line by adding veteran, multi-year starters.

OFFENSE

With Shula at coordinator, South Carolina averaged just 15 offensive points per game and ranked in the bottom ten of my opponent-adjusted offense ranking. There was a clear uptick in the games after he was fired – 29 offensive points per game and a top ten rank in the same metric.

Maybe there was more raw talent bottled up than what was shown on the stat sheet.

Briles has made improvements almost everywhere he's been and showed he can adapt his scheme to fit the personnel on hand. At Arkansas he went run-heavy with his 6'6 quarterback KJ Jefferson, and went pass-heavy at TCU to play to the strengths of pocket-passer Josh Hoover.

At his best, Briles operates the offense at hyper-tempo with wide spread formations, and a heavy dose of RPO and quarterback-run. His best units featured dual-threats like Robert Griffin III, D'Eriq King, and Jefferson.

Sellers certainly fits that skillset. The third-year starter looks to bounce back after falling in every stat category, most importantly placing 10th in QB Rating in the SEC after a 3rd place finish in 2024. The offense was one-dimensional and it limited his rushing production from his 674-yard (4.1 average) 2024 season down to just 270 yards (1.8 average) last year. Late-game moments hurt too, with multiple wide-open passes overthrown late in the Missouri loss, as well as a costly fumble in the Alabama loss.

A bright spot was their explosiveness in the pass game (#29 nationally) and the vertical threat is back on the outside. Nyck Harbor was a former five-star athlete and last year he was tracked as the fastest player in FBS. Harbor led with 618 yards and six touchdowns, plus an SEC-best 20.6 per-catch average. #2 receiver Vandrevius Jacobs transferred out to Miami with four-star grades, Brian Rowe left for UCLA, but Jayden Sellers is back in the slot. The staff signed former Top100 Nitro

SOUTH CAROLINA				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
VA TECH W 24-11	-8	2	60.3	
SC State (FCS) W 38-10	-17	1	56.0	
VANDERBILT L 7-31	5	-3	25.7	
MISSOURI L 20-29	-163	1	26.9	
KENTUCKY W 35-13	109	4	84.4	
LSU L 10-20	-103	1	28.2	
OKLAHOMA L 7-26	-95	-2	21.1	
ALABAMA L 22-29	8	0	43.8	
OLE MISS L 14-30	-187	-1	18.7	
TEXAS A&M L 30-31	-115	3	50.6	
C. CAROLINA W 51-7	359	1	83.9	
CLEMSON L 14-28	7	-3	33.0	
OVERALL: 48th / 68 SEC: 14th / 16 44.4				

SOUTH CAROLINA UNIT RANKS		
SEC RANK (of 16)	NATIONAL TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	6	
RUNNING BACKS	15	
RECEIVERS & TE	12	
OFFENSIVE LINE	11	
DEFENSIVE LINE	7	
LINEBACKERS	13	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	11	

SOUTH CAROLINA			RANK
Scoring Offense	22.7 ppg	104	
Points per Play	0.36	96	
Total Offense	336 ypg	109	
Yards per Play	5.4	95	
Rushing Offense	111 ypg	119	
Yards per Carry	3.2	129	
O-Line Run Push	4.1	89	
Explosive Rush	4.6	103	
Passing Offense	225 ypg	67	
Yards / Attempt	7.9	39	
QB Rating	134	71	
TD / INT Ratio	1.2	113	
Sacks / Attempt	13%	134	
Explosive Pass	8.2	29	
Return. Production	76%	2	
Returning Snaps	18,381	3	
24.6 SECONDS/PLAY #13 of 68 P4			
BRILES (2025 TCU)			FAST

SOUTH CAROLINA										OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	34	34	40	40	52	57	57	23	44	64									
F	SHULA	LOGGAINS	SATTERFIELD	BOBO	McCLENDON	ROPER													57th
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016									10-YEAR
D	WHITE					ROBINSON													
E	28	13	28	38	42	59	27	21	22	29									24th
F																			

SOUTH CAROLINA		RANK	
Scoring Defense	22.1 ppg	44	
Points per Play	0.33	39	
Total Defense	353 ypg	52	
Yards per Play	5.3	44	
3rd Down Conv%	40%	68	
Rushing Defense	137 ypg	49	
Yards per Carry	3.8	48	
Negative Play %	8%	79	
Explosive Rush	5.5	38	
Passing Defense	216 ypg	59	
Yards / Attempt	7	58	
QB Rating	124	42	
Completion %	60.3%	46	
Explosive Pass	5.5	61	
Return. Production	61%	30	
Returning Snaps	9,361	72	
SOUTH CAROLINA		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		34	
Rushing Offense	(0.8)	64	
Passing Offense	10.1	33	
Defense Overall		28	
Rushing Defense	0.6	29	
Passing Defense	14.4	23	

Tuggle who is a big-play threat and started for Purdue. They also added a wildcard in Top200 Jayden Gibson (Oklahoma) who had a solid 2023 but has battled injuries since. 6'5 tight end Brady Hunt enters his third season here and should have an expanded role.

Rahsul Faison and Oscar Adaway graduated, Matt Fuller returns after rushing for 260 yards as a freshman, and the staff added a pair of former four-stars in Christian Clark (Texas) and Jabree Coleman (Penn State). Clark rushed for 105 yards and a score in Texas' bowl win, and Coleman followed running backs coach Stan Drayton.

The offensive line has been a limiting factor for several seasons here and 2025 was no different. They joined Stanford as the only Power 4 lines ranked in the bottom ten in both OL Run Push and Pass Protection, and allowed a sack on 13% of pass attempts. And that was with the elusive Sellers behind them. It's a total restart here after the midseason coach firing and the addition of eight transfer linemen. Beamer wanted a more veteran line and he got it.

Shed Sarratt is the only returning starter after stepping up as a true freshman last fall. Josiah Thompson is also back but will miss the 2026 season with an injury. Two starters left for Power 4 programs but the staff signed plenty of starters themselves. Jacarrius Peak (NC State) is a five-star transfer, the #2 lineman in the entire portal, and earned All-ACC honors after starting 32 straight games. Similarly, four-star transfer Emmanuel Poku (East Carolina) was All-AAC, started 26 straight, and allowed zero sacks over 977 snaps. Carter Miller (UCF) and Hank Purvis (Purdue) combined to start 15 games last year.

DEFENSE

Clayton White's defense fell in every stat category from 2024 to 2025 but still remained above average.

Their clear MVP Dylan Stewart missed some time with injuries but still earned a second-team All-SEC honor after his All-Freshman 2024 season. Stewart is a legit All-American candidate and first-round projection off the edge. Their next two edges and two starting tackles are all gone, but they

leveraged the portal for a reload. Tomiwa Durojaiye (Illinois) earned a four-star grade after starting in the Big Ten last year, Kelby Collins (Alabama) has been a rotational tackle in the SEC for three years, and they will join former five-star Gabriel Brownlow-Dindy on the interior. Caleb Herring (Tennessee) is projected at the end spot opposite of Stewart.

Three linebackers share the two spots in the 4-2-5 base, and all three are back for 2026: Justin Okoronkwo, Fred Johnson, and Shawn Murphy.

South Carolina lost three stars in the secondary with All-SEC Jalon Kilgore, second-round draft pick Brandon Cisse, and DQ Smith all departing. Judge Collier and punt return weapon Vicari Swain are back at corner, Peyton Williams returns at safety, and the staff signed Kentucky's starter Quay'Sheed Scott to take the nickel spot. Gerald Kilgore will battle Top100 J'Zavien Currence (South Pointe, SC) for the other safety job.

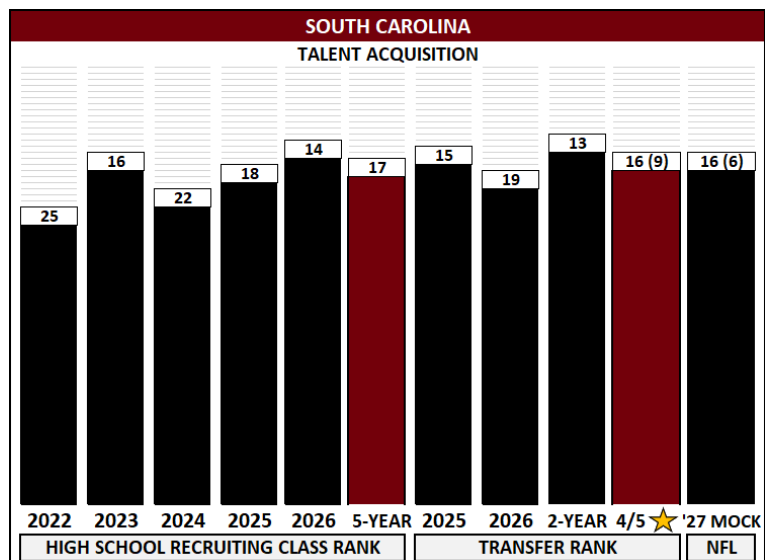
OUTLOOK

After finishing 14th in the SEC in Game Grader, South Carolina made a solid offensive coordinator hire and landed enough transfer talent to bounce back to the SEC's mid-tier. They also draw four of the bottom five teams in the league.

SOUTH CAROLINA	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	KENT STATE
S. 12	TOWSON (FCS)
S. 19	MISS. STATE
S. 26	@ Alabama
O. 3	KENTUCKY
O. 10	@ Florida
O. 17	--- BYE ---
O. 24	TENNESSEE
O. 31	@ Oklahoma
N. 7	TEXAS A&M
N. 14	@ Arkansas
N. 21	GEORGIA
N. 28	@ Clemson

SOUTH CAROLINA		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	648	47	
All-Time Win %	0.510	54	
Wins (Last 100)	540	47	
Wins (Last 50)	310	43	
Wins (Last 25)	173	38	
Wins (Last 10)	61	47	
Wins (Last 5)	33	39	
Game Grader (10 yr)	43.6	51	
Game Grader (5 yr)	48.1	41	
Game Grader (3 yr)	50.5	32	
Draft Picks s' 2000	86	23	
Draft Picks s' 2010	58	22	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		12	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		55	

SOUTH CAROLINA		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
44.4 (48)	68.3 (12)	38.9 (51)	49.2 (40)	39.8 (54)	30 (60)	37.9 (52)	43.4 (54)	48.3 (39)	35.7 (57)	43.6 (51)	





FLORIDA

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#12

SEC

#29

OVERALL



FLORIDA				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13 (B) UCF	(B) Oregon St		TEXAS	
12 MISSOURI	FSU	FSU	GEORGIA	TENNESSEE
11 S. CAROLINA	VANDERBILT	MISSOURI	TENNESSEE	OLE MISS
10 GEORGIA	GEORGIA	LSU	TEXAS A&M	KENTUCKY
9 LSU	LSU	ARKANSAS	Miami	GEORGIA
8 KENTUCKY	TENNESSEE	GEORGIA	(B) Tulane	TEXAS A&M
7 ALABAMA	KENTUCKY	KENTUCKY	FSU	Miami
6 FSU	S. CAROLINA	Utah	OLE MISS	LSU
5 Samford (FCS)	TEXAS A&M	S. CAROLINA	LSU	USF
4 VANDERBILT	MISSOURI	VANDERBILT	KENTUCKY	FSU
3 TENNESSEE	E. Wash (FCS)	Charlotte	UCF	MISS ST
2 USF	USF	TENNESSEE	MISS ST	TEXAS
1 FAU	Utah	McNeese (FCS)	Samford (FCS)	LIU (FCS)
2021		2022		
MULLEN		BILLY NAPIER		

FLORIDA				
2025 RESULTS				
		Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE
LIU (FCS)	W 55-0	365	2	77.7
USF	L 16-18	-36	-1	44.5
LSU	L 10-20	50	-4	39.5
MIAMI	L 7-26	-203	1	19.0
TEXAS	W 29-21	116	0	92.6
TEXAS A&M	L 17-34	-98	-1	23.9
MISS. ST	W 23-21	-16	0	43.8
GEORGIA	L 20-24	-80	1	45.5
KENTUCKY	L 7-38	-154	0	6.8
OLE MISS	L 24-34	-212	0	24.5
TENNESSEE	L 11-31	-191	0	15.2
FLORIDA ST	W 40-21	33	1	81.4
OVERALL: 50th / 68 SEC: 15th / 16 42.9				

FLORIDA		UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK		NATIONAL	
(of 16)		TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	15		
RUNNING BACKS	5	14	
RECEIVERS & TE	3	6	
OFFENSIVE LINE	12		
DEFENSIVE LINE	11		
LINEBACKERS	9		
DEFENSIVE BACKS	15		

FLORIDA		RANK	
Scoring Offense	21.6 ppg	111	
Points per Play	0.34	106	
Total Offense	341 ypg	104	
Yards per Play	5.4	92	
Rushing Offense	137 ypg	91	
Yards per Carry	4.3	75	
O-Line Run Push	4.5	29	
Explosive Rush	4.4	110	
Passing Offense	205 ypg	93	
Yards / Attempt	6.6	98	
QB Rating	126	89	
TD / INT Ratio	1.3	105	
Sacks / Attempt	5%	44	
Explosive Pass	6.0	96	
Return. Production	55%	66	
Returning Snaps	12,931	30	
26.3 SECONDS/PLAY #32 of 68 P4			
FAULKNER (2025 GA TECH)			

When Billy Napier was hired here in 2021 he stressed patience, and how he wanted an “army of staffers” to expand their recruiting operations and build the program from the high school ranks.

Napier became Florida’s first head coach with back-to-back losing seasons since 1979, and then his third season 2024 was off to another poor start. Athletic director Scott Strickland issued a public vote of confidence to quell the hot seat pressure, and Florida surged with a 4-0 finish to get to 8-5.

After all the patience, 2025 was the year to cash in. Napier’s roster was veteran, with handpicked players that he and his staff had recruited and developed, and they had a five-star quarterback entering his second season.

Instead of a breakthrough, it was an even worse collapse. Questionable play-calling, poor time management, lack of discipline – it was a comedy of errors and Florida lost to USF 18-16. That loss was bad enough, but then DJ Lagway threw *five* interceptions in the loss to LSU, Miami held Florida to 0/13 on third downs and their lowest yardage since 1999, and then Texas A&M made it 0-14 for Napier in road ranked games.

Patience had run out and there was no sign of improvement. Florida fired Napier, their first head coach since the 1940s with a career losing record.

After getting caught up in the Lane Kiffin Sweepstakes, they found a winner in Tulane’s Jon Sumrall.

Sumrall took his team to the conference title game in his first four seasons -- twice with Troy, and twice with Tulane – the only FBS coach to do so with different schools. He brings a 42-12 record, a Playoff bid, and urgency to win right away.

OFFENSE

Napier was the play-caller and continued to double-down on his role, ignoring the boosters’ guidance to delegate. His offense collapsed last year, ranking outside the Top 100 in both explosive rushing and passing, and scored just 18.5 points/game against FBS opponents.

Sumrall is a defensive-minded coach, but in his opening presser he said his offense will be “aggressive, explosive, with mixed tempos.” Back to Florida’s roots.

He hired Georgia Tech’s Buster Faulkner who won *FootballScoop’s* 2025 Coordinator of the Year for helping build Tech’s power run offense around Heisman nominee Haynes King. Faulkner improved Tech 100 spots in scoring offense. His Tech offenses were run-heavy to highlight their personnel strengths but he showed he can design potent passing attacks at prior stops and even comes from the epicenter of the Air Raid Valdosta State.

Lagway was the former #1 overall recruit but regressed in his second season, tossing an SEC-worst 14 picks. He left for Baylor, and Faulkner brought his Tech backup Aaron Philo with him. Philo was rated a four-star transfer and the #12 QB this cycle, and in high school he broke Trevor Lawrence’s GA state record for passing yards (13,922). Philo has shown pocket poise, and can be a physical runner if needed. Former Top250 Tramell Jones was Lagway’s backup last year and will make it a fall camp battle.

Jadan Baugh closed 2025 with an exclamation point. His 266-yard game to beat Florida State was the second-most in UF history and put him over the thousand-mark as UF’s tenth all-time. Baugh decided to return for 2026 and is one of Sumrall’s “Fab Five” retentions. The staff also added East Carolina starter London Montgomery and two-year Cincinnati vet Evan Pryor.

The receiver room was stocked enough to withstand some departures and remain a top unit. Florida has a pair of five-stars in Vernell Brown and Dallas Wilson. Brown was the top receiver and earned SEC All-Freshman as a WR, all-purpose, and return specialist, while Wilson’s year was cut short by an injury but he shined in the Texas upset win. Eric Singleton (Auburn) was ranked the #9 transfer

FLORIDA					OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	42	18	31	27	19	5	7	14	45	58				16th
F	CALLAWAY		SALE		MULLEN*		JOHNSON		GONZALES/HEVESY		NUSSMEIER			
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016				10-YEAR
D	ROBERTS		ARMSTRONG		TONEY		GRANTHAM		SHANNON		COLLINS			
E	40	22	64	39	31	42	24	25	43	5				27th
F														

FLORIDA		RANK	
Scoring Defense	24 ppg	60	
Points per Play	0.36	58	
Total Defense	377 ypg	70	
Yards per Play	5.7	83	
3rd Down Conv%	44%	119	
Rushing Defense	154 ypg	77	
Yards per Carry	4.0	54	
Negative Play %	8%	95	
Explosive Rush	5.4	36	
Passing Defense	223 ypg	76	
Yards / Attempt	8	116	
QB Rating	138	91	
Completion %	63.9%	98	
Explosive Pass	6.4	89	
Return. Production	77%	1	
Returning Snaps	13,128	25	

FLORIDA		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		42	
Rushing Offense	0.3	27	
Passing Offense	(2.4)	46	
Defense Overall		40	
Rushing Defense	0.3	39	
Passing Defense	5.5	31	

star Corman McClain finally had a breakout season last year and returns at corner, while original starter Dijon Johnson is back from injury. Bryce Thornton returns at strong safety, and the staff added Power 4 starters in DJ Coleman (Baylor) and Cam Dooley (Kentucky). Two Top100's stack the two-deep: safety Lagonza Hayward and corner CJ Bronaugh.

There are no questions at linebacker and this is the strength of Sumrall's transition-year defense.

Myles Graham led the team with 76 tackles, Jaden Robinson and Aaron Chiles both had 50+, and the trio is a top unit. Ty Jackson is another Top100 prospect in the room.

OUTLOOK

To Florida fans skeptical of hiring another Non-AQ winner like Napier, Sumrall noted that Urban Meyer and Curt Cignetti followed similar paths: "judge me for who I am, I'm a winner, we're going to win."

With that said, there are some concerns with the transition season. Usually a coaching hire brings a highly-touted transfer haul but Florida is still ranked dead last in the SEC in the two-year transfer average. The lines of scrimmage lost several starters and need to be strengthened before Florida can return to SEC contention. Bowl season would be a win here with four swing games all on the road: Auburn, Missouri, Kentucky, and Florida State in the non-conference.

receiver this cycle, is rumored to have 4.2 40 speed, and put up two 700-yard seasons in Faulkner's offense at Georgia Tech. That is an elite starting trio, plus they signed near-five-star Davian Groce (Frisco, TX) who posted an insane high school stat line of 3,300 receiving yards and 2,400 rushing yards. Micah Mays (Wake Forest) and speedy Jaylen Lloyd (Oklahoma State) add more Power 4 depth.

Florida lost both starting tight ends and backfilled from the portal with Georgia Tech starter Luke Harpring and James Madison starter Lacota Dippre.

The offensive line loses three starters, most notably All-American center Jake Slaughter and NFL draft pick left tackle Austin Barber. Two starters return – Knijeah Harris and Caden Jones – but the other three will be fall camp battles decided by ace line coach Phil Trautwein. Three transfers have starting experience with Harrison Moore (Georgia Tech), TJ Shanahan (Penn State) and Emeka Ugorji (Stanford). Former Top100 Jason Zandamela will challenge Moore at center, and Eagan Boyer (Penn State) is a contender at tackle. This unit remains an uncertainty given the loss of star power.

DEFENSE

Sumrall hired Kentucky defensive coordinator Brad White who built consistently above-average defenses there with three Top 25 units in seven years, and just one ranked outside the Top 40.

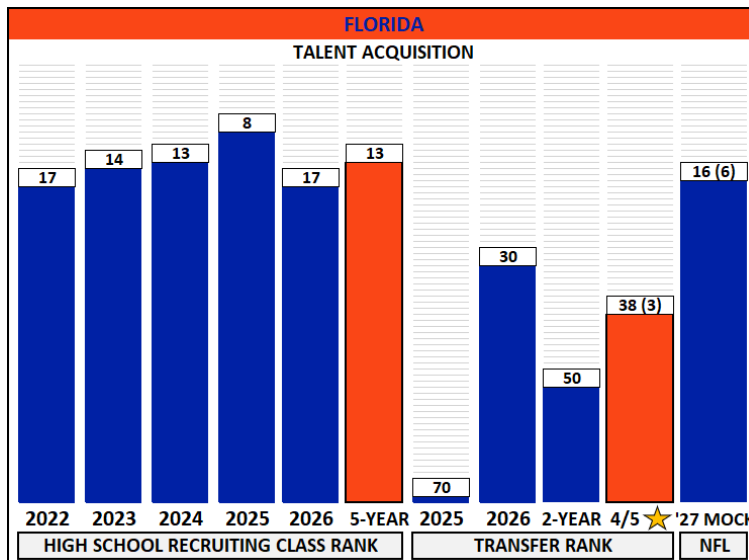
Two more stars were drafted from the defensive line – Caleb Banks and end George Gumbs – and starting nose tackle Michai Boireau transferred out to Ole Miss. The new-look starting line is packed with potential, with SEC All-Freshman Jayden Woods off the edge and former five-star LJ McCray back from injury at defensive tackle. Kamran James tied for the team lead in sacks and he's joined by first-team All-CUSA Emmanuel Oyebadejo (Jacksonville State) at end. Brendan Bett moves up into the starting spot at nose tackle.

The secondary is also down several starters with top corner Devin Moore going pro, and Jordan Castell (Kentucky) and Sharif Denson (Ole Miss) both landing on other SEC rosters. Former five-star Corman McClain finally had a breakout season last year and returns at corner, while original starter Dijon Johnson is back from injury.

FLORIDA	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	FAU
S. 12	CAMPBELL (FCS)
S. 19	@ Auburn
S. 26	OLE MISS
O. 3	@ Missouri
O. 10	S. CAROLINA
O. 17	@ Texas
O. 24	--- BYE ---
O. 31	*GEORGIA (ATL)
N. 7	OKLAHOMA
N. 14	@ Kentucky
N. 21	VANDERBILT
N. 27	@ Florida State

FLORIDA		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	772	20	
All-Time Win %	0.624	16	
Wins (Last 100)	677	15	
Wins (Last 50)	414	13	
Wins (Last 25)	208	17	
Wins (Last 10)	71	32	
Wins (Last 5)	29	51	
Game Grader (10 yr)	55.2	23	
Game Grader (5 yr)	48.9	40	
Game Grader (3 yr)	47.5	40	
Draft Picks s' 2000	149	5	
Draft Picks s' 2010	99	5	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		43	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		65	

FLORIDA		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
42.9 (50)	54.9 (30)	44.6 (42)	48.4 (43)	53.6 (33)	69.4 (13)	72.5 (11)	67.8 (13)	40.4 (52)	57.7 (20)	55.2 (23)	



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MISSISSIPPI STATE #13 #43

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SEC

OVERALL



MISSISSIPPI STATE 5-YEAR WIN TREND

13	(B) Texas Tech	GEORGIA		(B) Wake
12	OLE MISS	ALABAMA	OLE MISS	OLE MISS
11	ARKANSAS	KENTUCKY	TEXAS A&M	MISSOURI
10	ALABAMA	LSU	KENTUCKY	MISSOURI
9	LSU	(B) Illinois	AUBURN	GEORGIA
8	Memphis	OLE MISS	ALABAMA	TEXAS
7	Tenn St (FCS)	ETSU (FCS)	S. CAROLINA	FLORIDA
6	AUBURN	AUBURN	LSU	TEXAS A&M
5	KENTUCKY	ARKANSAS	S. Miss	TENNESSEE
4	VANDERBILT	TEXAS A&M	ARKANSAS	ARKANSAS
3	TEXAS A&M	Bowling Green	W. Michigan	N. Illinois
2	NC State	Arizona	Arizona	Alcorn St (FCS)
1	LA Tech	Memphis	SE LA (FCS)	Arizona St
				S. Miss.
	2021	2022	2023	2024
	MIKE LEACH		ARNETT	JEFF LEBBY

MISSISSIPPI STATE

2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE
S. MISS. W 34-17	164	0	66.4
ARIZONA ST W 24-20	12	2	63.7
Alcorn St (FCS) W 63-0	353	2	77.7
N. ILLINOIS W 38-10	185	1	70.8
TENNESSEE L 34-41	-88	1	34.3
TEXAS A&M L 9-31	-260	-1	8.8
FLORIDA L 21-23	16	0	51.5
TEXAS L 38-45	17	0	45.9
ARKANSAS W 38-35	-45	-1	43.5
GEORGIA L 21-41	-245	0	14.8
MISSOURI L 27-49	-93	-1	17.3
OLE MISS L 19-38	-105	-1	22.2
(B) WAKE FOREST L 29-43	-43	1	26.6
OVERALL: 53rd / 68	SEC: 16th / 16		41.8

MISS. STATE

UNIT RANKS

SEC RANK	NATIONAL
(of 16)	TOP 15
QUARTERBACK	10
RUNNING BACKS	11
RECEIVERS & TE	14
OFFENSIVE LINE	16
DEFENSIVE LINE	15
LINEBACKERS	11
DEFENSIVE BACKS	12

MISSISSIPPI STATE

RANK

Scoring Offense	30.4 ppg	42
Points per Play	0.42	56
Total Offense	399 ypg	56
Yards per Play	5.5	79
Rushing Offense	158 ypg	68
Yards per Carry	3.7	106
O-Line Run Push	4.3	59
Explosive Rush	5.1	78
Passing Offense	241 ypg	54
Yards / Attempt	8.1	31
QB Rating	143	47
TD / INT Ratio	2.2	57
Sacks / Attempt	12%	131
Explosive Pass	8.7	21
Return. Production	44%	99
Returning Snaps	10,272	60
22.3 SECONDS/PLAY	#2 of 68 P4	
LEBBY (2025 MS STATE)	FAST	

When Jeff Lebbly was hired he vowed to bring an exciting, explosive brand of football to Starkville. In the second week of the season, he fulfilled his promise.

Trailing #11 Arizona State in the final thirty seconds, Blake Shapen heaved a bomb to Brenen Thompson who ran in for the game-winning score. Fans poured onto the field to celebrate the program's first non-conference Top 15 win since 1991. "What an atmosphere, what an evening ... that is Davis Wade Stadium at its finest," Lebbly said.

Mississippi State got to 4-0 for the first time since the Dak Prescott 2014 season, but when they hit SEC play they fumbled through multiple blown opportunities. MSU led Tennessee by seven with two minutes left but then lost in overtime, lost to Florida by two points with a controversial referee decision on a field goal, and then blew a 31-14 lead to Texas. Close but no cigar.

Finally some late-game magic broke their way, as Shapen led a final-minute drive to beat Arkansas 38-35 and snap the program's 16-game SEC losing streak. The defense collapsed down the stretch allowing Georgia and Missouri to both rush for 300+ yards in blowout losses, Ole Miss won the Egg Bowl by 19, and then with a bonus bowl invitation despite the 5-7 record Wake Forest won 43-29.

Lebbly is off to a 7-18 start – 1-15 in SEC play – and has been part of the program's worst three-year stretch in decades. Entering his third season, Lebbly remains optimistic: "we have great young players in our locker room who are excited to be here and continue to grow this thing the right way."

Far from just coach-speak, the statement held true as Mississippi State did a nice job retaining their starters – only the offensive line had defections. They won the Player Retention portion of the offseason, found a dual-threat quarterback to build around, and brought back a familiar face to fix the defense.

OFFENSE

Lebbly's offensive scheme was as-advertised. Mississippi State ranked #21 in my explosive passing category, #31 in yards per attempt, and #30 of 68 Power 4 in my opponent-adjusted passing stat.

Shapen bounced back from his 2024 injury and led the offense well with a 64% completion rate, 15 touchdowns (8 picks) and a #9 finish in SEC QB Rating. Entering the season finale, Lebbly made the tough decision to bench Shapen in favor of true freshman Kamario Taylor, the highest-rated quarterback commit in school history.

The Noxubee County legend was used in some packages throughout the season, but in his first full start against Ole Miss, Taylor exploded for 173 rushing yards on 20 carries including a scramble and highlight-reel touchdown run. Taylor finished slightly ahead of Shapen in QB Rating and added in the rushing threat with 458 yards and eight touchdowns on the ground.

With Shapen graduated, Taylor is now the face of the program. The staff added former Vanderbilt and App State starter AJ Swann plus a wildcard in former Top100 Jaden Rashada (Sacramento State).

Fluff Bothwell was the lead back with 677 yards, 4.8 per carry, and returns as the clear #1 for 2026. Davon Booth graduated, so former four-star Xavier Gayten moves up to the #2 spot.

Thompson's 58-yard game-winner against Arizona State was indicative of his entire season. He averaged a high 18.5 yards/catch which ranked second-best in the SEC, and his 1,054 yards broke Makai Polk's single-season school record. Thompson graduated but the room remains a strength with the return of Anthony Evans -- 67 catches, 831 yards – and former Top100 Ayden Williams. Sanfrisco Magee was a spring hero and surged up into the top rotation. Plus, the staff signed Missouri's #3 receiver Marquis Johnson who earned a four-star transfer grade, and speedy blue-chipper Zion Ragins (Oklahoma). Johnson will step into Thompson's role as the downfield vertical threat.

Tight end Seydou Traore graduated and Mississippi State is now relying on four-star true freshman Zayion Cotton or Oregon State backup Riley Williams.

MISSISSIPPI STATE	OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	45	25	61	43	42	62	27	28	35	30
F	LEBBY*	BARBAY	LEACH*	GETSY	GONZALES / HEVESY					49th
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
D	HUTZLER	BROCK	ARNETT	SHOOP	GRANTHAM	SIRMON				
E	56	65	21	14	36	13	52	1	23	53
F										30th

MISSISSIPPI STATE		RANK	
Scoring Defense	30.2 ppg	106	
Points per Play	0.44	103	
Total Defense	409 ypg	107	
Yards per Play	6.0	106	
3rd Down Conv%	41%	94	
Rushing Defense	186 ypg	117	
Yards per Carry	4.9	117	
Negative Play %	6%	125	
Explosive Rush	7.6	110	
Passing Defense	223 ypg	78	
Yards / Attempt	7.3	80	
QB Rating	135	79	
Completion %	60.4%	51	
Explosive Pass	6.5	95	
Return. Production	52%	69	
Returning Snaps	11,872	39	

MISSISSIPPI STATE		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		45	
Rushing Offense	(0.5)	55	
Passing Offense	11.8	30	
Defense Overall		56	
Rushing Defense	(0.3)	57	
Passing Defense	1.0	43	

The offensive line struggled last year by allowing 40 sacks and ranking in the national bottom five in Pass Protection (#131). Their success in the run game was not much better, with a #106 rank in yards/carry and #59 mark in my OL Run Push. Taylor's athleticism should help mitigate these issues but this remains an area of uncertainty.

It was also the only position group that got hit with transfer portal departures. Four linemen that started games last year transferred out and all landed on Power 4 rosters. Center Canon Boone is the only returning starter but they do get back right tackle Blake Steen who was an original starter injured in the first game. From there, it's Pick Your Transfer as they added *seven* from Power 4 programs plus two top JUCO's. LJ Prudhomme was projected as an Arkansas starting guard before the move, DJ Chester and Tyler Miller are both former Top200 LSU transfers, and Chester has 14 starts under his belt.

DEFENSE

Lebby fired coordinator Coleman Hutzler and then made the shocking move to hire back his predecessor Zach Arnett. After the initial shock wore off, Arnett does fit the role well. Remember, he led three strong defenses here from 2020-22 that ranked #13, #36, and #14 in my opponent-adjusted numbers. His 2023 season as the head coach was a flop, but his three coordinator seasons before do the talking.

Arnett runs a 3-3-5 base scheme that is aggressive yet disciplined at the same time. In his three coordinator seasons, Mississippi State ranked in the SEC's top five in both turnovers and limiting explosive plays.

That's exactly what the doctor ordered after the 2025 unit failed in pass rush (#125 Negative Play Rate) with just 21 sacks, failed to stop the run (#117 yards/carry), and couldn't contain explosive plays (#105).

Mississippi State brings back the bulk of their front six, with 10 of the top 14 linemen and linebackers returning. Will Whitson is back from an ACL injury and should be the top pass rusher along with former Top200 Amaree Williams edge (Florida State). Jaray Bledsoe and Trevion Williams are back at defensive tackle, Calvin Dinkins and 6'5 350-pounder Diesel Moye return at nose tackle. The staff signed another Top200 tackle Dealyn Evans (Texas A&M) who should elevate the room.

Arnett's linebackers led the SEC in tackles in consecutive seasons and he inherits another strong core here with middle backer Jalen Smith and weakside backer Zakari Tillman both returning. Tyler Lockhart was the top recruit of their 2025 signing class and lived up to the hype by earning SEC All-Freshman last year.

Isaac Smith was again the face of the defense and he returns for a third season. Smith led the SEC in tackles in 2024, starred again in 2025 as a backer/safety hybrid, and given the exodus of graduating senior safeties it appears Smith will stay in the backfield. The staff added a pair of SEC veterans Jardin Gilbert (LSU) and Kendel Dolby (Oklahoma) who combined for 31 starts. Kelley Jones earned third-team All-SEC at corner and was getting NFL Draft buzz but decided to return for a final season. Quentin Taylor (Iowa State) started six games there last year due to injuries ahead of him, and he'll battle former Top200 Jamroc Grimsley (Florida) here.

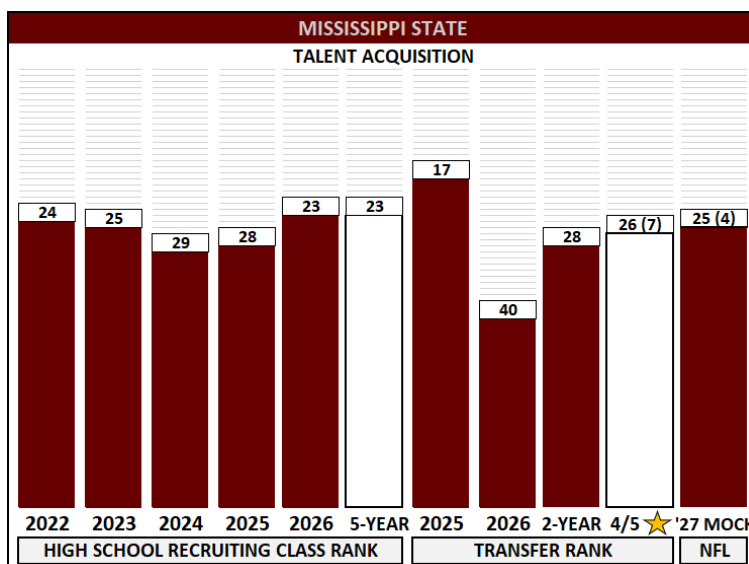
OUTLOOK

Mississippi State has some momentum heading into 2026 with a revamped defense, a proven coordinator who knows how to build a defense in Starkville, and solid player retention. Now it's all about whether their home-grown, top-rated quarterback can rise to stardom and elevate the program back to bowl season.

MISSISSIPPI STATE	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	UL-MONROE
S. 12	@ Minnesota
S. 19	@ S. Carolina
S. 26	MISSOURI
O. 3	ALABAMA
O. 10	--- BYE ---
O. 17	@ LSU
O. 24	OKLAHOMA
O. 31	@ Texas
N. 7	VANDERBILT
N. 14	AUBURN
N. 21	TENN. TECH (FCS)
N. 27	@ Ole Miss

MISSISSIPPI STATE		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	601	57	
All-Time Win %	0.490	61	
Wins (Last 100)	494	56	
Wins (Last 50)	275	54	
Wins (Last 25)	145	53	
Wins (Last 10)	61	47	
Wins (Last 5)	28	55	
Game Grader (10 yr)	48.1	41	
Game Grader (5 yr)	44.6	54	
Game Grader (3 yr)	34.6	65	
Draft Picks s' 2000	63	39	
Draft Picks s' 2010	47	31	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		65	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		64	

MISSISSIPPI STATE		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
41.8 (53)	26.5 (65)	35.5 (55)	60.5 (21)	58.6 (24)	40.2 (52)	42.1 (47)	68 (12)	63.2 (18)	44.7 (44)	48.1 (41)	



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KENTUCKY

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#14 #45

SEC OVERALL



KENTUCKY				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13	TENNESSEE	(B) Iowa	(B) Clemson	
12	MISS ST	GEORGIA	S. CAROLINA	Louisville
11	GEORGIA	VANDERBILT	ALABAMA	Louisville
10	(B) Iowa	TENNESSEE	TENNESSEE	VANDERBILT
9	Louisville	S. CAROLINA	MISSOURI	TENNESSEE
8	NM State	OLE MISS	GEORGIA	TEXAS
7	VANDERBILT	Louisville	Louisville	GEORGIA
6	LSU	MISSOURI	MISS ST	VANDERBILT
5	FLORIDA	MISS ST	FLORIDA	OLE MISS
4	S. CAROLINA	N. Illinois	VANDERBILT	S. CAROLINA
3	Chatt. (FCS)	Y'town St (FCS)	Akron	TN Tech (FCS)
2	MISSOURI	FLORIDA	EKU (FCS)	FLORIDA
1	UL-Monroe	Miami (OH)	Ball St	AUBURN
			Ohio	E. Michigan
			Southern Miss	Toledo
2021 2022 2023 2024 2025				
MARK STOOPS				

KENTUCKY				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
TOLEDO W 24-16	-24	-1	58.6	
OLE MISS L 23-30	-96	2	37.2	
E. MICHIGAN W 48-23	31	1	62.5	
S. CAROLINA L 13-35	-109	-4	15.7	
GEORGIA L 14-35	-155	0	18.3	
TEXAS L 13-16	216	-1	77.6	
TENNESSEE L 34-56	-28	-2	23.7	
AUBURN W 10-3	-1	0	68.4	
FLORIDA W 38-7	154	0	104.5	
Tenn. Tech (FCS) W 42-10	204	1	69.9	
VANDERBILT L 17-45	-289	-2	5.1	
LOUISVILLE L 0-41	-300	-2	0.3	
OVERALL: 46th / 68 SEC: 13th / 16 45.1				

KENTUCKY		UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK	NATIONAL		
(of 16)	TOP 15		
QUARTERBACK	14		
RUNNING BACKS	13		
RECEIVERS & TE	11		
OFFENSIVE LINE	8		
DEFENSIVE LINE	16		
LINEBACKERS	14		
DEFENSIVE BACKS	14		

KENTUCKY		RANK	
Scoring Offense	23 ppg	101	
Points per Play	0.35	104	
Total Offense	341 ypg	105	
Yards per Play	5.1	111	
Rushing Offense	139 ypg	86	
Yards per Carry	3.9	100	
O-Line Run Push	4.2	68	
Explosive Rush	3.2	130	
Passing Offense	202 ypg	96	
Yards / Attempt	6.6	99	
QB Rating	123	100	
TD / INT Ratio	1.1	123	
Sacks / Attempt	8%	105	
Explosive Pass	5.5	110	
Return. Production	40%	112	
Returning Snaps	11,938	41	
27.5 SECONDS/PLAY #46 of 68 P4			
STEIN (2025 OREGON)			

Coming off a 4-8 season, Kentucky was alive for bowl eligibility with two shots to get their sixth win. They lost both by a combined 86-17 score: a 484-yard passing day by Diego Pavia and then a 41-0 demolition by Louisville.

It was enough to end Mark Stoops' 13-year tenure in Lexington. Stoops is the winningest coach in Kentucky history and built physical, competitive teams but a few catalysts caused the downfall.

2022 had the look of a potential dream season, but their ace offensive coordinator left for the NFL and Kentucky couldn't get past the 4-0 start. Stoops almost took the Texas A&M job after the 2023 season, and then throughout the 2024 season he often complained about NIL funding, telling fans to "Pony Up." His right-hand man Vince Marrow left for rival Louisville.

All the while, the NIL/Portal system was a bad match for what worked best for Stoops. He and his staff were excellent at finding under-recruited gems in the Midwest and developing them over four or five years. That model was flipped on its head with the transfer portal, and

Kentucky lost its strategic edge.

Less than 24 hours later, Kentucky announced Will Stein as their new head coach. Stein quarterbacked Trinity High School (Louisville) to three KY state titles before walking on at Louisville. But Stein and his family were UK diehards: "growing up in Kentucky and sitting in the stands at UK games as a kid ... this is truly a dream come true."

Stein rose to the top of the coaching carousel after posting four straight Top 15 offenses at UTSA and Oregon, with four different quarterbacks, with a simple motto: "Feed The Studs."

Stein's offense can do it all – creative play-calling, fast tempo, RPO, pro-style concepts – but he gears the scheme towards his personnel and forces the ball to his best playmakers.

The 36-year-old didn't want to hear any excuses regarding budgets or funding. Stein went out and signed the #11 transfer class, #4 in the SEC, and stacked the roster with former blue-chip recruits. Of the 11 "must-keep" players, Kentucky retained seven of them.

OFFENSE

The offense really struggled the past two years under Bush Hamdan with #47 and #59 (of 68 Power 4) finishes in my opponent-adjusted metric. Stein's three Oregon offenses: #3, #5, and #5.

Yes, Oregon is a consistent top five recruiter but Kentucky signed an impact class of transfers to jump-start the rebuild.

Seventh-year quarterback Zach Calzada struggled and was injured, then freshman Cutter Boley stepped up to post the #6 QB Rating among Power 4 freshmen with an SEC All-Freshman honor. Boley left for Arizona State, but Stein pulled off a transfer flip by stealing Kenny Minchey (Notre Dame) away from his Nebraska commitment. Minchey was a four-star recruit and then earned a four-star transfer grade after nearly beating out CJ Carr for the Notre Dame starting job. Minchey has a dual-threat skillset with explosive runs and off-platform throws, and was a significant win for the new Stein staff.

The thunder-and-lightning pair of Dante Dowdell and Seth McGowan have moved on, but the staff signed two former super-recruits in CJ Baxter (Texas) and Jovantae Barnes (Oklahoma). Baxter starred in 2023, Barnes posted 500+ yard seasons in 2022 and 2024, but both are looking to bounce back from injury-filled careers.

Kentucky retained two of their most promising receivers in Hardley Gilmore and DJ Miller who flashed breakout potential last year. Nic Anderson (LSU) transferred in and looks to bounce back to 2023 form when he posted 798 yards, 10 touchdowns, and a top-five 21 yards/catch at Oklahoma. Shane Carr (Southern Utah) was a productive FCS receiver, and Top200 Kenny Darby was a signing day flip from LSU.

KENTUCKY					OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	59	47	18	50	24	59	25	44	37	25				
F														
F	HAMDAN	COEN	RICH SCAN.	COEN				GRAN						45th
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016				10-YEAR
D														
E														
F	33	34	22	21	48	25	36	24	59	54				35th

KENTUCKY		RANK	
Scoring Defense	26.4 ppg	75	
Points per Play	0.4	81	
Total Defense	374 ypg	67	
Yards per Play	5.6	79	
3rd Down Conv%	40%	77	
Rushing Defense	134 ypg	45	
Yards per Carry	3.7	31	
Negative Play %	9%	51	
Explosive Rush	5.0	23	
Passing Defense	240 ypg	105	
Yards / Attempt	8	115	
QB Rating	137	87	
Completion %	61.7%	66	
Explosive Pass	6.8	105	
Return. Production	52%	70	
Returning Snaps	9,942	63	
KENTUCKY		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		59	
Rushing Offense	(0.2)	46	
Passing Offense	(7.4)	54	
Defense Overall		33	
Rushing Defense	1.1	13	
Passing Defense	0.6	45	

Kentucky hasn't had a tight end eclipse the 400-yard mark since Jacob Tamme in 2007, but Stein loves getting his tight ends involved, especially when they are the so-called Studs. He's got two good ones here with potential All-SEC Willie Rodriguez and former Top200 Mikkel Skinner. Look for that 20-year drought to be snapped.

At the peak of the Stoops era, Kentucky was defined by their physical offensive line. After consecutive years of poor line play, Stein hit the portal and may have just rebuilt their Big Blue Wall. This is one of the best OL transfer hauls in America with *three* four-star transfers that were multi-year Power 4 starters.

Lance Heard (Tennessee) earned All-SEC last year and the former five-star tackle is looking to bolster his NFL draft resume. Coleton Price (Baylor) is a three-year starting center, and Tegra Tshabola (Ohio State) was a starter on two Playoff teams. Mark Robinson (UTEP) earned All-CUSA honors, and two more were high school blue-chippers with limited college experience: Max Anderson (Tennessee) and Olaus Alinen (Alabama). Malachi Wood took over the right tackle spot in spring.

DEFENSE

Brad White built consistently above-average defenses here with three Top 25 units in seven years, and just one ranked outside the Top 40. He landed at Florida after the coaching change.

Stein's aggressive playcalling on offense carries over to what he wants from his defense: "I'm not a bend-don't-break guy." It's a contrast from White's main focus on limiting explosive plays, even if it meant allowing consistent short gains underneath.

He hired Jay Bateman who led Texas A&M to #22 and #28 finishes in my opponent-adjusted rankings. Mike Elko was calling the plays at A&M so Bateman takes on that new role here after some mixed results back during his UNC tenure.

From the defensive line two-deep, two graduated, two more transferred out, but the staff was able to retain two potential breakout candidates in ends Tavion Gadson and Mi'Quise Humphrey-Grace.

Last year Humphrey-Grace posted 31 tackles, 7 for loss, and 3.5 sacks and has star potential. Jamarrion Harkless (Purdue) is an instant starter at nose tackle.

Linebackers Daven Rayner and Alex Afari combined for 130 tackles and both graduated. Grant Godfrey earned some starts down the stretch and returns as the lead inside backer. The staff signed two former blue-chippers Tavion Wallace (Arkansas) and Top100 Elijah Barnes who got a four-star transfer rating and is projected to start alongside Godfrey.

The secondary lost two starters – Cam Dooley (Florida) and Quay'sheed Scott (South Carolina) – to other SEC rosters but they pulled in two of their own. Jordan Castell (Florida) started 35 games and his teammate Aaron Gates came to Lexington with him. Castell will start at safety, Gates is at nickel, and the staff retained their best player in All-SEC safety Ty Bryant who led the league in interceptions last year. The cornerbacks were crushed with injuries last year but Terhyon Nichols is back healthy and Bateman called him the MVP of spring ball. Hasaan Sykes (Western Carolina) was a top FCS corner who picked Kentucky over Illinois.

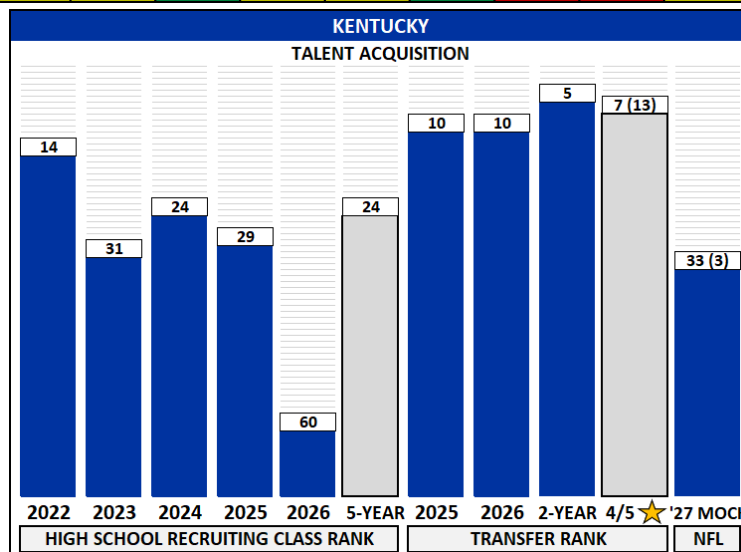
OUTLOOK

Stein's no-excuses attitude is refreshing and Kentucky's #11 transfer haul is an instant boost to the rebuilding project -- especially in the trenches with a beefed up offensive line. It's a solid start but their overall roster talent still projects them in the SEC's lower tier.

KENTUCKY	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	Y'TOWN ST (FCS)
S. 12	ALABAMA
S. 19	@ Texas A&M
S. 26	S. ALABAMA
O. 3	@ S. Carolina
O. 10	LSU
O. 17	@ Oklahoma
O. 24	VANDERBILT
O. 31	--- BYE ---
N. 7	@ Tennessee
N. 14	FLORIDA
N. 21	@ Missouri
N. 28	LOUISVILLE

KENTUCKY		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	662	43	
All-Time Win %	0.500	57	
Wins (Last 100)	493	57	
Wins (Last 50)	264	56	
Wins (Last 25)	143	55	
Wins (Last 10)	70	34	
Wins (Last 5)	33	39	
Game Grader (10 yr)	48.5	39	
Game Grader (5 yr)	48.9	39	
Game Grader (3 yr)	44.6	49	
Draft Picks s' 2000	55	44	
Draft Picks s' 2010	41	34	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		46	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		53	

KENTUCKY				GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)						
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR
45.1 (46)	39.2 (55)	49.3 (38)	49.5 (39)	61.4 (19)	44.3 (40)	54.2 (27)	60.8 (20)	37.9 (55)	42.8 (46)	48.5 (39)





VANDERBILT

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#15

SEC

#46

OVERALL



VANDERBILT				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13				
12	TENNESSEE	TENNESSEE	TENNESSEE	TENNESSEE (B) Iowa
11	OLE MISS	S. CAROLINA	S. CAROLINA	TEXAS
10	KENTUCKY	MISSOURI	AUBURN	ALABAMA
9	MISSOURI	GEORGIA	OLE MISS	TENNESSEE
8	MISS ST	OLE MISS	GEORGIA	KENTUCKY
7	S. CAROLINA	ALABAMA	FLORIDA	AUBURN
6	FLORIDA	Wake Forest	MISSOURI	MISSOURI
5	GEORGIA	FLORIDA	KENTUCKY	LSU
4	Stanford	KENTUCKY	UNLV	Utah State
3	ETSU (FCS)	N. Illinois	Wake Forest	GA State
2	UConn	Elon (FCS)	ALA&M (FCS)	S. CAROLINA
1	Colorado St	Hawaii	Hawaii	VA Tech
	2021	2022	2023	2024
	2025			
	CLARK LEA			

VANDERBILT				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
Charl S. (FCS)	W 45-3	346	2	76.8
VA TECH	W 44-20	242	-1	82.0
S. CAROLINA	W 31-7	-5	3	88.1
GEORGIA ST	W 70-21	345	1	79.4
UTAH ST	W 55-35	150	0	70.3
ALABAMA	L 14-30	-153	-1	20.1
LSU	W 31-24	74	0	77.0
MISSOURI	W 17-10	-111	0	58.2
TEXAS	L 31-34	-5	-1	51.1
AUBURN	W 45-38	-19	-1	63.7
KENTUCKY	W 45-17	289	2	96.5
TENNESSEE	W 45-24	200	-2	102.6
(B) IOWA	L 27-34	19	1	46.6
OVERALL: 11th / 68		SEC: 4th / 16	70.2	

VANDERBILT	UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK	NATIONAL	
(of 16)	TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	12	
RUNNING BACKS	14	
RECEIVERS & TE	15	
OFFENSIVE LINE	13	
DEFENSIVE LINE	12	
LINEBACKERS	15	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	13	

VANDERBILT	RANK	
Scoring Offense	38.5 ppg	8
Points per Play	0.62	4
Total Offense	463 ypg	9
Yards per Play	7.5	1
Rushing Offense	176 ypg	47
Yards per Carry	5.6	6
O-Line Run Push	4.8	10
Explosive Rush	8.1	4
Passing Offense	288 ypg	10
Yards / Attempt	9.3	5
QB Rating	169	3
TD / INT Ratio	3.8	15
Sacks / Attempt	6%	63
Explosive Pass	8.8	17
Return. Production	38%	115
Returning Snaps	12,371	34
29.4 SECONDS/PLAY	#62 of 68 P4	
BECK (2025 VANDERBILT)	SLOW	

When Clark Lea returned to Nashville to take over his alma mater, a program suffering through a seven-year losing season streak, he set out a "ten-year plan" to get Vanderbilt competitive.

Lea has achieved unthinkable heights in just half the time.

After his third team collapsed with a 2-10 (0-8 SEC) season, he took a chance on an under-recruited bunch from New Mexico State. He brought their offensive coaches, their 5'9 JUCO quarterback, and the tight end.

Then Vanderbilt finally secured the long overdue financial commitment, modernized their stadium, and got a signature win in 2024 by upsetting Alabama. The goalposts were carried out by celebrating fans and tossed in the Cumberland River.

But that New Mexico State core led an offensive explosion here in 2025 and finished as the #1 ranked unit in my opponent-adjusted metrics. Eli Stowers won the Mackey Award and Diego Pavia placed second in the Heisman race.

Vanderbilt started 5-0 thanks to the offense scoring 30+ points in the first five games – a school-best in 110 years. Pavia and the offense grinded out last-minute wins against LSU (first since 1990), Missouri, and an overtime shootout at Auburn.

Then Pavia exploded in November to become the first SEC player *ever* with four consecutive 400-yard games. He kept striking the Heisman pose, but kept backing it up game after game, drive after drive. In the season finale Vanderbilt cashed in on their shot at the first-ever 10-win season in school history by blowing out rival Tennessee 45-24 – in Knoxville – behind Pavia's 433 yards.

"He's the best player in the country, the best competitor and teammate I've ever met in my life," said Lea.

While they came up a few spots short of a Playoff berth, and Pavia placed second behind eventual national champion Fernando Mendoza, this was an all-time season for Vanderbilt football. The Ten-Year Plan turned out a Ten-Win season, shifted the culture and expectations, brought a national spotlight to Vanderbilt, and laid the groundwork for the future.

OFFENSE

Just days later, Vanderbilt signed the #1 overall recruit in the nation. Yes, Vanderbilt flipped a five-star quarterback from his commitment to Dynasty-Tier Georgia. How's that for a succession plan post-Pavia?

Jared Curtis (Nashville Christian) said the 2025 breakout season changed his opinion and that he wanted to be part of the growth of his local program. This is Vanderbilt's first-ever five-star commit, much less the #1 overall national recruit.

The 6'4 Curtis brings a big frame, pocket mobility, and he showed off his arm with a spring game toss that went 65+ yards in the air. Curtis enrolled early to practice in bowl season, was the clear #1 in spring, and will be a true freshman starter this fall.

Tim Beck's offense ranked in the national top 10 in 13 of my 17 stat categories, none more impressive than the #1 rank in my opponent-adjusted number. How much of that was the Pavia Effect?

Pavia put up 3,593 passing yards, 9.4 per attempt, with 29 touchdowns. He was the leading rusher with 862 yards and eight scores, and had more carries than the top two running backs combined. He was also invincible in the pocket, scrambling away from countless would-be sacks.

The absence of Pavia – even with a super-recruit taking over – and the loss of four starting linemen are major uncertainties for 2026.

Cade McConnell is the only returning starting lineman, but the staff brought in three impact transfers and all are projected starters. Beau Johnson (North Dakota State) was an FCS All-American last year at tackle, Lyndon Cooper (Pittsburgh) is a multi-year starting center, and Micah DeBose (Alabama) was a Top200 recruit in the 2025 cycle. Orion Irving and Clinton Azubuike battle at the other tackle spot.

VANDERBILT									
OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)									
O	1	51	59	55	67	66	65	20	43
F	51	59	55	67	66	65	20	43	59
F	BECK		LYNCH		RAIH		FITCH		LUDWIG
	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017
D	GREGORY	LEA*	HOWELL		MINTER	ROOF	TARVER		MASON*
E	51	60	66	68	65	68	68	44	48
F	51	60	66	68	65	68	68	44	48
									35
									68th

VANDERBILT		RANK	
Scoring Defense	22.8 ppg	48	
Points per Play	0.35	52	
Total Defense	358 ypg	58	
Yards per Play	5.5	62	
3rd Down Conv%	43%	110	
Rushing Defense	108 ypg	18	
Yards per Carry	3.7	34	
Negative Play %	10%	21	
Explosive Rush	6.5	70	
Passing Defense	249 ypg	118	
Yards / Attempt	7.1	69	
QB Rating	140	100	
Completion %	66.6%	124	
Explosive Pass	4.5	15	
Return. Production	49%	80	
Returning Snaps	16,832	4	

VANDERBILT		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		1	
Rushing Offense	1.5	6	
Passing Offense	33.6	3	
Defense Overall		51	
Rushing Defense	0.6	26	
Passing Defense	(11.3)	58	

Vanderbilt's first two-way player in the modern era – he grabbed four interceptions along with seven receptions on offense.

The safety room is absolutely loaded. CJ Heard was very involved in the run game and led the team in tackles. The staff landed the school's first-ever all-conference transfer in Ricardo Jones (Clemson) who led the ACC with six interceptions last year. Dontae Carter was Lea's highest-ranked signee before landing Curtis this cycle, plus a pair of incoming four-stars could play right away: Davin Chandler and Carson Lawrence.

OUTLOOK

Longwell coined the term "misfits" to describe Vanderbilt's collection of under-recruited, chip-on-the-shoulder roster. They even had t-shirts made. Along with Indiana's dream season, Vanderbilt was America's underdog team of 2025.

The defense ranked third-worst in the SEC last year, and the offense now has to move on without do-it-all Pavia. Five-star Curtis will have a bright future but this is a tough act to follow, especially for a true freshman. With the league's lowest talent profile, Post-Pavia, Vanderbilt is set for a rebuilding season.

Stowers was far and away the most productive SEC tight end and was selected in the second round in April. Cole Spence returns as a starter in Vanderbilt's 12-personnel, and the staff signed four-star transfer Jayvontay Conner (East Carolina) who will be another receiving threat.

Vanderbilt had a pair of 800-yard receivers with Tre Richardson and Junior Sherrill, but their vertical deep-threat Richardson transferred out to Louisville. A pair of transfers will join Sherrill in the new starting rotation. Four-star transfer Ja'Cory Thomas (Old Dominion) put up 719 yards with an explosive 17.5 yard/catch average last year, and Cole Adams (Alabama) was a former blue-chipper stuck in a crowded room. Tristen Brown also returns to compete with Adams in the slot.

Sedrick Alexander and Makhilyn Young both return at running back and they will get a bigger workload without Pavia taking 10-15 carries per game. Together they combined for 981 yards and 17 scores with Young posting a high 9.0 per-carry average. They also signed Kentucky's Gatorade Player of the Year four-star Evan Hampton.

DEFENSE

The defense was strong against the run but overall checked in at #51 of 68 Power 4 in my opponent-adjusted ranking. They do benefit from more roster continuity on this side of the ball, and added in three starters off other Power 4 defenses for an instant boost.

Vanderbilt returns three defensive line starters and also gets back a legit NFL prospect in defensive tackle Yilanan Ouattara who only played in one game before an injury. Khordae Sydnor will be missed but Miles Capers returns at the other edge spot. The staff added five transfer linemen, most notably Power 4 starter Edwin Kolenge (Boston College) and Brian Allen (Iowa) who drew a four-star transfer grade. CJ Jackson (LSU) was a four-star in the 2024 class.

Langston Patterson's eligibility appeal was declined, but Bryan Longwell returns for a third year as the starting inside backer. Bryce Cowan and Nick Rinaldi move up the depth chart.

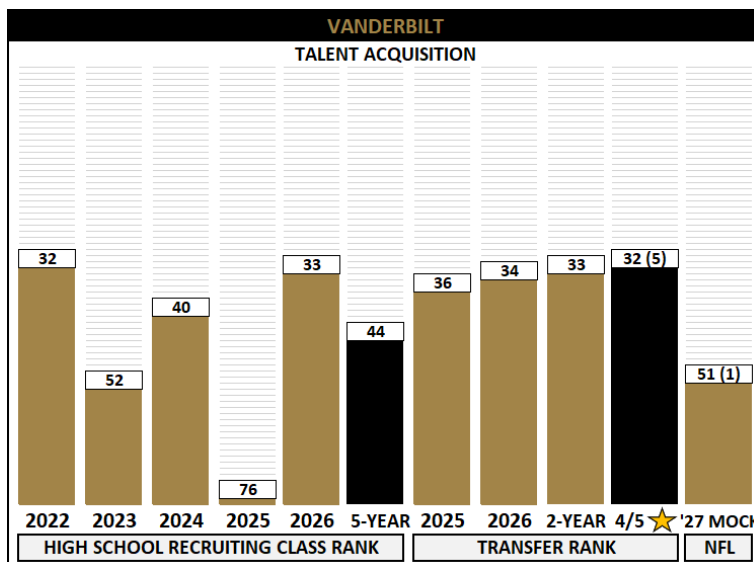
The starting corner pair returns and they showed some improvement late in the season. Jordan Matthews surged up the depth chart and now looks like the #1 cover corner and a possible star. Martel Hight became

VANDERBILT	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	AUSTIN PEAY (FCS)
S. 12	DELAWARE
S. 19	NC STATE
S. 26	@ Auburn
O. 3	@ Georgia
O. 10	OLE MISS
O. 17	ARKANSAS
O. 24	@ Kentucky
O. 31	--- BYE ---
N. 7	@ Miss. State
N. 14	ALABAMA
N. 21	@ Florida
N. 28	TENNESSEE

VANDERBILT		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	635	54	
All-Time Win %	0.486	62	
Wins (Last 100)	427	66	
Wins (Last 50)	187	68	
Wins (Last 25)	110	67	
Wins (Last 10)	46	65	
Wins (Last 5)	26	61	
Game Grader (10 yr)	34.5	66	
Game Grader (5 yr)	37.1	64	
Game Grader (3 yr)	44.9	47	
Draft Picks s' 2000	31	64	
Draft Picks s' 2010	19	65	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		63	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		50	



VANDERBILT		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
70.2 (11)	46.3 (46)	18.3 (68)	32.3 (58)	18.4 (68)	18.8 (66)	18.2 (67)	45.5 (48)	35 (57)	41.6 (48)	34.5 (66)	





ARKANSAS

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#16

SEC

#58

OVERALL



ARKANSAS				
5-YEAR WIN TREND				
13	ALABAMA	MISSOURI	MISSOURI	MISSOURI
12	AUBURN	LSU	TEXAS	TEXAS
11	OLE MISS	Liberty	OLE MISS	MISS ST
10	GEORGIA	MISS ST	MISS ST	LSU
9	(B) Penn St	ALABAMA	ALABAMA	MISS ST
8	MISSOURI	TEXAS A&M	OLE MISS	AUBURN
7	LSU	(B) Kansas	TEXAS A&M	TEXAS A&M
6	MISS ST	OLE MISS	LSU	TENNESSEE
5	Ark. PB (FCS)	AUBURN	BYU	Notre Dame
4	TEXAS A&M	BYU	FIU	Memphis
3	Georgia So.	Missouri St (FCS)	FLORIDA	OLE MISS
2	Texas	S. CAROLINA	Kent State	Arkansas St
1	Rice	Cincinnati	W Carolina (FCS)	AL A&M (FCS)
2021 2022 2023 2024 2025				
SAM PITTMAN				

Trey Biddy's "Walk & Talk" postgame reaction segments are well-known in the SEC footprint and his video following the season finale spoke volumes. He turned 360 degrees showing an empty, but state-of-the-art DWR Razorback Stadium – "look at this place, this is home to a two-win football team, two and ten, in this place."

The frustration was palpable.

Not only was this Arkansas' third 0-8 SEC season since 2018, this one had an extra layer of pain given their *five* one-score losses. They missed two field goals and lost to Ole Miss by six, fumbled the ball at the goal-line with a minute left when a field goal would have beaten Memphis, and lost another shootout against Texas A&M.

The offense posted Top 10 stats and moved the ball well but froze up in the red zone and in crunch time. Arkansas held fourth-quarter leads against Auburn and Mississippi State but lost them both. Against Auburn, the offense had turnovers on the final four drives. They actually went backwards, negative 15 total yards, on the final three drives against Mississippi State.

ARKANSAS				
2025 RESULTS	Yard +/-	TO +/-	GRADE	
Ala. A&M (FCS) W 52-7	317	2	76.8	
ARKANSAS ST W 56-14	345	0	86.7	
OLE MISS L 35-41	51	-1	54.3	
MEMPHIS L 31-32	11	-1	41.8	
NOTRE DAME L 13-56	-276	-2	1.1	
TENNESSEE L 31-34	11	-3	50.0	
TEXAS A&M L 42-45	30	0	56.6	
AUBURN L 24-33	-49	-3	32.4	
MISS. ST L 35-38	45	1	43.8	
LSU L 22-23	-50	-3	46.4	
TEXAS L 37-52	22	-2	36.6	
MISSOURI L 17-31	-101	1	25.7	
OVERALL: 44th / 68 SEC: 12th / 16 46.0				

A day after suffering a 56-13 blowout by Notre Dame, Arkansas fired Sam Pittman. He delivered three winning seasons, a Top 25 nine-win season in 2021, an emotional win over Texas, but ended up below .500 with a 32-34 overall record (14-29 vs. SEC).

For all the good moments and lovable quotes, Pittman's tenure extended the program's decade-long drought without a winning season in SEC play. Player retention was a recurring issue. Each offseason, star players left for bigger deals which caused an over-reliance on reloading the roster via the transfer portal.

Bobby Petrino took over as the interim but they went 0-7 to close the season.

In the most crowded coaching carousel the sport has ever seen, Arkansas emerged with Memphis head coach Ryan Silverfield. In six years there, Silverfield went 50-25 overall – 29-9 in the last three years – with two bowl wins over Power 4 opponents. His Memphis squad even stole a last-minute win over Arkansas in September.

OFFENSE

Hidden behind a 2-10 record, this was an extremely productive and explosive offense. In my opponent-adjusted rankings, Arkansas was the #2 offense in Power 4 and #1 in rushing. Petrino's scheme opened up wide-open running lanes, dynamic Taylen Green ripped off explosive scrambles, and they found themselves in plenty of shootouts.

The problem was executing in crunch time. They blew *four* fourth-quarter leads, and went 0-6 in games decided in the final frame. Green accumulated 27 total touchdowns, 3,400+ total yards, but failed to deliver a single fourth-quarter win.

Green went pro, their 1,000-yard back Mike Washington graduated, and it will be a nearly full rebuild in Silverfield's transition. On offense, four starters are back and he signed seven Non-AQ starters plus three more transfers who were former Top200 blue-chippers.

Arkansas' first quarterback battle since 2019 will continue into the fall. KJ Jackson was Green's backup last year and started the season-finale against Missouri. He apparently has a slight lead over AJ Hill, the 6'5 Top200 redshirt freshman who followed Silverfield from Memphis.

Braylen Russell rushed for 286 yards here last year and is joined by Memphis starter Sutton Smith and Top200 Jasper Parker (Michigan). Smith went for 669 yards (6.6 per carry) and brings elusiveness and home-run ability, like he flashed on his 64-yard touchdown to beat Arkansas.

Starting receivers O'Mega Blake and Raylen Sharpe graduated, Jalen Brown was thrown off the team in April, leaving CJ Brown as the lone 2025 returner. Ismael Cisse was poised to earn a starting job last spring before an injury knocked him out – look for a bounce-back season in 2026. Courtney Crutchfield was a Top100 super-recruit who still has potential for a breakout. The staff added three Non-AQ starters led by Chris Marshall (Boise State) who earned a four-star transfer grade after placing second in the Mountain West with an explosive 19.1 per-catch average.

ARKANSAS	UNIT RANKS	
SEC RANK (of 16)	NATIONAL TOP 15	
QUARTERBACK	16	
RUNNING BACKS	16	
RECEIVERS & TE	16	
OFFENSIVE LINE	15	
DEFENSIVE LINE	14	
LINEBACKERS	16	
DEFENSIVE BACKS	16	

ARKANSAS	RANK	
Scoring Offense 32.9 ppg	23	
Points per Play 0.5	21	
Total Offense 455 ypg	13	
Yards per Play 6.9	7	
Rushing Offense 192 ypg	28	
Yards per Carry 5.7	4	
O-Line Run Push 5.2	1	
Explosive Rush 9.5	1	
Passing Offense 263 ypg	30	
Yards / Attempt 8.3	23	
QB Rating 143	44	
TD / INT Ratio 2.0	67	
Sacks / Attempt 8%	101	
Explosive Pass 8.8	20	
Return. Production 55%	67	
Returning Snaps 13,074	29	
26.9 SECONDS/PLAY #42 of 68 P4		
SILVERFIELD (2025 MEMPHIS)		

ARKANSAS					OFFENSE & DEFENSE, vs. OPPONENT AVERAGE (RANK / 68)					
O	2	13	65	14	20	31	47	65	28	29
F	PETRINO		ENOS		BRILES		CRADDOCK		ENOS	
F	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
D	WILLIAMS			ODOM			CHAVIS		RHOADS	SMITH
E	61	38	44	59	32	19	62	42	67	62
F										60th

ARKANSAS		RANK	
Scoring Defense	33.8 ppg	129	
Points per Play	0.5	126	
Total Defense	425 ypg	122	
Yards per Play	6.3	121	
3rd Down Conv%	45%	121	
Rushing Defense	186 ypg	116	
Yards per Carry	4.7	103	
Negative Play %	8%	78	
Explosive Rush	8.5	124	
Passing Defense	239 ypg	104	
Yards / Attempt	8.5	127	
QB Rating	152	125	
Completion %	62.8%	81	
Explosive Pass	8.8	131	
Return. Production	55%	59	
Returning Snaps	11,524	46	

ARKANSAS		RANK / 68	
Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play			
Offense Overall		2	
Rushing Offense	2.0	1	
Passing Offense	10.3	32	
Defense Overall		61	
Rushing Defense	(0.2)	56	
Passing Defense	(10.0)	55	

transfers are all starter-caliber with Top100's Jamonta Waller (Auburn) and Charlie Collins, plus Kentucky starter Steven Soles.

With Xavian Sorey and Stephen Dix gone, Bradley Shaw moves up to the starting middle linebacker role and incoming Ja'Quavion Smith (FCS Howard) was a spring hero.

Khmori House (North Carolina) earned All-ACC honorable mention as a linebacker but the staff moved him to their hybrid "star" role. Safety Miguel Mitchell is the only starter back in the secondary, and the staff added three Power 4 starters – Carter Stoutmire (Colorado), Christian Harrison (Cincinnati) and La'Khi Roland (Maryland) – plus a four-star transfer in All-AAC Jahiem Johnson (Tulane).

OUTLOOK

This is a textbook rebuilding year for Arkansas. Silverfield's transfer strategy on offense centered on production from lower tiers, while the defense signed high-upside recruits who lack game experience.

Next recruiting and transfer cycle will be a key indicator for Arkansas moving forward, because in the NIL era they have struggled in both categories as well as player retention.

ARKANSAS		RANK / 68	
All-Time Wins	748	24	
All-Time Win %	0.571	32	
Wins (Last 100)	624	24	
Wins (Last 50)	336	30	
Wins (Last 25)	155	47	
Wins (Last 10)	47	64	
Wins (Last 5)	29	51	
Game Grader (10 yr)	41.4	56	
Game Grader (5 yr)	50.4	34	
Game Grader (3 yr)	45.5	43	
Draft Picks s' 2000	79	26	
Draft Picks s' 2010	50	28	
Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26)		55	
Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)		62	



All-SEC tight end Rohan Jones is gone but Jaden Platt surged late in the season. Matt Adcock (Memphis) caught three touchdowns last year, and Ty Lockwood (Boston College) still has untapped potential.

The offensive line was dominant in the run game, finishing #1 nationally in my OL Run Push metric. Petrino mixed gap and zone schemes, while Silverfield's spread offense will be almost exclusively zone blocking. Their pass protection remained a liability, with consecutive finishes outside the Top 100 in Sack Rate. The left side of the line was the strength, with All-SEC tackle Fernando Carmona and guard Corey Robinson, but both graduated. E'Marion Harris also transferred out to Oklahoma with high transfer marks.

Caden Kitler and Kobe Branham are returning starters and the staff added five non-Power 4 linemen via the portal. Bryant Williams (Louisiana) is the headliner and was ranked a Top 10 tackle transfer this cycle and Malachi Breland (Memphis) was a starting guard for this staff last year. Recruiting rankings aren't everything, but it's worth noting that Arkansas has zero former four-star prospects on the line two-deep: 0/10.

DEFENSE

Arkansas couldn't stop anybody last year. The defense posted bottom ten marks in almost every stat category, most importantly in scoring (#129), QB Rating (#125), and both explosive rushing (#124) and passing (#131).

Silverfield hired Ron Roberts to install his 3-4 base scheme. Roberts has 17 years of coordinator experience – most recently at Florida (below average rankings), Auburn, and Baylor (Top 10 in 2021) – and is credited with innovations like the disguised blitzes and simulated pressures that have been so effective recently.

Just two starters return, and on this side of the ball the staff focused more on adding high-upside, though unproven, former blue-chip transfers.

The defensive line is packed with seven former Top200 prospects, including All-SEC Quincy Rhodes, Hunter Osborne (Virginia), Carlon Jones (USC), and Xadavien Sims (Oregon). Off the edge, three

ARKANSAS	
2026 SCHEDULE	
S. 5	N. ALABAMA (FCS)
S. 12	@ Utah
S. 19	GEORGIA
S. 26	TULSA
O. 3	@ Texas A&M
O. 10	TENNESSEE
O. 17	@ Vanderbilt
O. 24	--- BYE ---
O. 31	MISSOURI
N. 7	@ Auburn
N. 14	S. CAROLINA
N. 21	@ Texas
N. 28	LSU

ARKANSAS		GAME GRADER (RANK / 68)									
2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	10-YEAR	
46 (44)	53 (33)	37.6 (52)	53.5 (30)	61.9 (17)	42.1 (45)	22.6 (65)	23.1 (66)	28.5 (61)	45.2 (42)	41.4 (56)	

